

בֵּית הַשְּׂדֵתִין = בֵּית הָאֲשֵׁדִתִין, “House of the Demonesses” (derogative) — אֲשֵׁדִתִין is like שִׁדְתִין, the plural Aramaic form of שִׁדָּה (fem.), “demoness,” with a prosthetic *’alef*. Regarding שְׂדֵה, see #1, 1:3; #38, 9:1.

Finally, in these suggestions, **בֵּית** and the next noun seem to be compound toponyms. However, if they are common nouns, then the translations should not be capitalized. Some of above suggested places might have been named after their pools, pits, or cisterns. Regarding toponyms with dual formation, cf. **יְרוּשָׁלַיִם**, Jerusalem, **שֹׁהַ קִרְיָתַיִם**, Shaveh-kiriathaim (see #40, 9:7).

כְּבֹאֵתָךְ (= כְּבֹאֵךְ) can also be read as כְּבֹאֵתָךְ (= כְּבֹאֵךְ) or כְּבִיאָתָךְ; all having essentially the same meaning. Since in these cases the idiom “as you (sg.) come” is followed by a number of cubits, the measurement refers to distance, rather than depth (see #16, 4:3).

The text reads, לִיִּם יַמּוֹת שְׁלוֹ, "to its (masc.) basin of (the) basins." Else-

21 Allegro, 53, 165-67 n. 282; Allegro^{rev}, 26.

22 Milik, 297-98, 234 B-19e, 245 C-74, 271 D-44; Milik^E, 142.

23 Greenfield, 139b.

24 Thorion, 171.

25 Wise, 197.

26 Lurie, 121-22; Wolters, 52-53; Pixner, 356; Garcia Martinez, 463; Beyer, 230, 232; Vermes, 377.

where, *לְיַמּוֹלִיָּם* means “to (the) sea/river/basin” or “westward” (see #40, 9:7). *יָם* (BH, MH; pl. *יַמִּים*), “sea, pool,” is masculine. *יַמּוֹת* is the assumed plural of *יָמָה* (MH) “lake,” a feminine formation of *יָם* (masc.). E.g.,

The tribes have no rights to catch fish *שֶׁל מִיָּמָה שְׁל טְבֵרְיָא* (from the Lake of Tiberias) because it is the allotment of Naphtali, not only that, but it is given to him (i.e., Naphtali) *יָם מְלֵא הָבֵל לְדְרוֹמָה שְׁל יָם* (a full district to the south of the Sea) (t. B.Q. 8:18; cf. Sifri Berakhah 23).²⁷

יַמּוֹת יָם literally, “sea of (the) seas” or “basin of (the) basins,” means, “the most important sea/basin.” It indicates that in this place there were several basins. Cf. *הַבֵּל הַבְּלִיאַ* (Trg. *הַבֵּל הַבְּלִיאַ*, “Vanity of (the) vanities” (Eccl. 1:2), which is explained by Rashi as, *הַבֵּל שְׁבֵה־בְּלִים*, “A vanity among the vanities,” and by Sforno, *הַבֵּל יוֹתֵר מִשְׁאֵר הַהֲבִלִים*, “A vanity that is more than any other vanities”; *שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים*, “Song of the Songs,” i.e., the most beautiful song (Songs 1:1; see Rashi *Šeror Hammor*, *Mešudat Zion*). Accordingly, *בָּאֲשִׁיתִּי וּבָאֲשִׁיתִּי וּבָאֲשִׁיתִּי וּבָאֲשִׁיתִּי בְּבוֹאֲתְךָ וּבְכַבּוֹאֲתְךָ לְיַמּוֹת שְׁלֹו* means, “in/at/by the pool as you (sg.) come/go to its (masc.) basin of (the) basins,” i.e., as you (sg.) enter its most important basin.

On the other hand, the first letter of *יַמּוֹת* or *יַמּוֹת*, a *waw/yod*, may be a scribal error for an *alef*, or being a cursive *alef*; cf. *יַצְלַם* or *יַצְלַם* for *אֲצַלַם* (11:1,4). Also, a *šin* may be missing after *שְׁלֹו*; cf. the missing *ayin* of *<ע>* in this line, and of *הַמְעַרְב* (12:1, alt.). Thus, the reading would be, *אַמּוֹת שְׁלֹו-שׁ*, “thr<ee> cubits”; cf. *אַמּוֹת שְׁלוֹשׁ*, “three cubits” (4:7). There are several misspelled cases of *אַמּוֹת* in the Scroll (10:6, 10:9, 10:13; also 9:8 in Baker^{dr} and Milik^{dr}). This suggestion is supported by the phrases, *בְּאֲשִׁיתִּי וּבָאֲשִׁיתִּי וּבָאֲשִׁיתִּי וּבָאֲשִׁיתִּי בְּבוֹאֲתְךָ וּבְכַבּוֹאֲתְךָ לְסִמּוּלֵי אַמּוֹת עֶסֶר*, “in/at/by a/the pool ... as you (sg.) come/go toward its left ten cubits” (see #46, 10:5-6); and *בְּאֲמָאֵבְאֵמָא ... בְּבוֹאֲתְךָ וּבְכַבּוֹאֲתְךָ אַמּוֹת אַרְבַּע [יֵין וְאַחַת]*, “In/at/by a/the canal ... as you (sg.) come/go for[ty on]e cubits” (see #16, 4:3-4).

“(there are) *כְּלִי־כְלִי דְמַעַ* <ע> *לֵאח* (= *לח*) *דְּמַעַ סִירָא בְּתִכּוּבְתָּבְנָן אֲצִלָּן* (11:14) *dedic<ated> vessels (and) dedicated pots*, with their lists next to them (or their notes are next to them),” or “(there are) a *dedic<ated> vessel (and) a dedicated pot*, with their lists next to them (or their notes are next to them).” For further discussion, see Appendix D and Appendix E.

²⁷ *יָמָה* is mentioned again in this Tosephta, as well in the Talmudim and Midrashim (e.g., b. B.B. 74b; Yalqut Ps. 697; see AC 4, 134b-136b). Jastrow (579b) vocalizes *שֶׁל יָמָה* *טְבֵרְיָא* (masc.), and renders “the Lake of Tiberias.” Yet Jastrow sees the feminine *יָמָה* in *לְיַמּוֹתִי*, “for my *yammah*” (i.e., sea; y. Sheq. 5:1 [19a]). Ben-Yehuda (3, 2057b) lists *יָמָה* (masc.) from the Introduction of *Sefer ha’Agron* by Sa’adiah Ga’on, but not *יָמָה*. Even-Shoshan classifies *יָמָה* (fem.), “lake,” as Modern Hebrew (ESH^{dic} 3, 964b). Perhaps, these scholars consider *יָמָה* as an Aramaism; e.g., *יָמָה דְּטְבֵרְיָא*, “Lake of Tiberias” (y. Ket. 12:3 [59b]; etc.).

ITEM 56

11:16 במבא די[רת] בית המשכב המערבי
 11:17 טיף על מ[...] תשע מאות
 12:1 זהב ככ 5 ככרין ששין ביאתו מן הכרכ
 12:2 תחת האבן השחורא כוזין תחת סף
 12:3 הכוך ככרין 42

- 11:16 At the alley of the watchman's quar[ter of] the western tomb
- 11:17 (there is) a brook along [...], (there are) nine hundred
- 12:1 gold (shekels), 5 s(ilver) k(arsh, and) sixty (unspecified) talents. Its entrance is from the city.
- 12:2 Under the black stone (there are an undisclosed number of) jugs. Under the threshold
- 12:3 of the burial niche (are) 42 (unspecified) talents.

COMMENTARY

The small lacuna of two-three letter spaces in line 11:16 can be restored with a high degree of certainty. However, the large lacuna of about ten letter spaces in line 11:17 is highly problematic. Line 12:1, the longest in the Scroll, consists of 25 letters plus five vertical lines (i.e., numeral 5). Depending on one's interpretation, this item describes either two or three deposits. It can be subdivided into #56a (11:16-12:2a) and #56b (12:2b-12:3); or into #56a (11:16-12:1), #56b (12:2a), and #56c (12:2b-12:3). MILIK, PIXNER, WOLTERS, GARCIA MARTINEZ, VERMES, and WISE divide these lines into three items, while for ALLEGRO, LURIE, and BEYER it is a single item. Most likely it is a single item describing several deposits.

(11:16) במבא די[רת] בית המשכב המערבי, "In/at/by the alley of the watchman's quar[ter of] the western tomb" — ALLEGRO¹⁷: "In the window of (?) the western dormitory" (i.e., במבארי בית משכב המערבי). מבארי is dubious; it may be another unattested form of באר, "well," or from "explain, make clear," thus "window (?)." Although a gap follows, but probably nothing missing. ALLEGRO: במכארו[ת] בית המשכב המערבי, "In the hewn out chamber of the western tomb." מכארות, a variant of מכורות, "hewing out"; cf. כרתי (2 כרה ... משכב, "origin," Ezek. 16:3, etc.), מכרתת (Mesha 25), מכורה

Chron. 16:14, etc.). ALLEGRO^{rev}: "In the entrance of the western lodging (?) of the House of Rest."¹ MILIK: **בְּמִבְּא דִּיןֶרֶת** **בֵּית הַמִּשְׁכָּב הַמַּעֲרָבִי**, "at the western entrance to the lodg[ing] of the triclinium." In a Nabatean inscription (see below) **בֵּית מִשְׁכָּב** means "triclinium," rather than "tomb."² LURIE: **בְּמִבְּא רִו** [בֵּית הַמִּשְׁכָּב הַמַּעֲרָבִי], "In the entrance [...] to the western grave"; the second word cannot be restored.³ PIXNER (follows Milik): "at the western entrance to the lodge of the hostel." An Essene hostel near the Bethesda Pool in Jerusalem located in an area that may be associated with the family of Jesus.⁴ BENDAVID: **בֵּית הַמִּשְׁכָּב**, "gathering place to eat" (BH), vs. **טְרִיקְלִין** (MH of Greek origin).⁵ SHARVIT: **מִשְׁכָּב**, "grave" (BH, Isa. 57:2; Ezek. 32:25).⁶ WOLTERS: **בֵּית הַמִּשְׁכָּב הַמַּעֲרָבִי** [בְּמִבְּא רִו], "In the entry-way of the [...] the western grave chamber." **דִּירָה**, "lodge," is one of those words that Milik recognizes as Mishnaic, but reads mistakenly. **רִוִּבְדָּ**, "platform, ledge," as in 2:3, is a "plausibly alternative."⁷ GARCIA MARTINEZ: "at the West entrance of the sepulchre room."⁸ BEYER: **בְּמִבְּא רִוִּבְדָּ בֵּית הַמִּשְׁכָּב**, "At the entrance to the terrace of the western sleeping room."⁹ VERMES: "at the western entrance of the tomb."¹⁰ WISE: "At the entryway to the terr[ace] of the western mausoleum."¹¹

מִבְּא is a defective spelling of **מָבֹא**, the construct state of **מָבֹא** (masc., from the root **בוא**, "to come," with a prefixed locative *mem*), "place of entry," i.e., "entrance."¹² E.g., **אֶת מָבֹא הָעִיר**, "the entrance of the city" (Judg. 1:24-25); **דֶּרֶךְ מָבֹא הַסּוּסִים בֵּית הַמֶּלֶךְ**, "way of the entrance of the horses of the king's palace" (2 Kgs 11:16); **וְאֶת מָבֹא הַמֶּלֶךְ הַחִיצוֹנָה**, "and the outer entrance for the king" (2 Kgs 16:18); **מָבֹא פִתְחִים**, "entrance of portals" (Prov. 8:3); **אֶל מָבֹא שַׁעַר הַסּוּסִים בֵּית הַמֶּלֶךְ**, "toward the entrance of the gate of the horses of the king's palace" (2 Chron. 23:15); **לְמָבֹא הַבַּיִת**, "toward the entrance of the Temple" (Ezek. 44:5); **אֶל מָבֹא הַשְּׁלִישִׁי אֲשֶׁר**, "the third entry which is in the House of the Lord" (Jer. 38:14).

1 Allegro, 53, 167 nn. 286-87; Allegro^{rev}, 26.

2 Milik, 297-98, 248-49 C-107-08, 272 D-45; Milik^E, 142, 154.

3 Lurie, 122-23 and nn. 1-2.

4 Pixner, 357 and n. 48.

5 Bendauid, 1, 98-99.

6 "Iyyunim," 130 and n. 24.

7 "Vocabulary," 487, 490 #40; Wolters, 52-53.

8 Garcia Martinez, 463.

9 Beyer, 230, 232.

10 Vermes, 377.

11 Wise, 197.

12 Thorion (164, 170) says that the vocal "o" in **מִבְּא** is written defectively. Since he does not list **בְּמִבְּא דִּיןֶרֶת בֵּית הַמִּשְׁכָּב הַמַּעֲרָבִי** among the construct states consisting of several nouns, apparently Thorion does not accept Milik's restoration. Qimron in his discussion of the term **מָבֹא** in the Dead Sea Scrolls does not mention the Copper Scroll (*The Hebrew of the Dead Sea Scroll* [1986], 35).

The latter is an absolute form. In Mishnaic Hebrew מְבוֹי means “entrance” of a group of courtyards, “alley, lane” (e.g., m. Shab. 15:1).

The restoration of בֵּית הַמְּשָׁכָב [דִּינִרָת], is quite certain. דִּינִרָת is the construct state of דִּירָה (fem., MH, JA), “dwelling” (from the root דוּר, “to dwell,” BH, MH, JA); e.g., צֵא מִדִּירָת קִבְעֵ וּשְׁב בְּדִירָת אֶרְצִי, “go out from the steady dwelling and dwell in a temporary dwelling” (b. Suk. 2a). דִּירָה is a shortened form of בֵּית דִּירָה, “house of dwelling,” i.e., “dwelling place”; e.g.,

All chambers in the Temple are exempt from *mezuzah* except the chamber of the counselors, because it is דִּירָה לְכוֹהֵן גָּדוֹל (a dwelling for the high priest) for seven days a year. Rabbi Judah said, “There are no other בֵּית דִּירָה (dwelling) (in the Temple) only this?” Rather (the Sages) said, “every (chamber that is) בֵּית דִּירָה (a dwelling) requires (*mezuzah*), every (chamber that is) not בֵּית דִּירָה (a dwelling) is exempt (from *mezuzah*)” (t. Yoma 1:2).

בֵּית דִּירָה also means “watchman’s quarter” (a synonym of שׁוּמְרָה, “watchman’s hut”); e.g., הַגִּינָה ... וּבִלְבָד שִׁיחָא בָּהּ שׁוּמְרָה אוּ בֵּית דִּירָה, “the garden ... but must be in it a watchman’s hut or quarter” (m. ‘Eruv. 2:5). In the Mishnaic era many structures, among them tombs and graves, used to have בֵּית דִּירָה. E.g., וּגְשָׁרִים וּנְפֻשׁוֹת שִׁישׁ בֵּת דִּירָה, “and bridges and tombs which have watchman’s quarter” (m. ‘Eruv. 5:1); הַקֶּבֶר וְהַגֶּשֶׁר שִׁישׁ לָהֶן בֵּית דִּירָה, “the grave and the bridge which have watchman’s quarter” (t. ‘Eruv. 6:4).¹³ Moreover, דִּין (= דִּיר, *nun-reš* interchange), “cattle shed, storehouse,” a masculine formation of דִּירָה, occurs as an alternate reading in the Scroll (see #37, 8:14). Regarding בֵּית, see #7, 2:3.

Both the Hebrew מְשָׁכָב and the Aramaic מְשַׁכְבָּאֻמְשַׁכְבָּא (בֵּית) (masc., from the root שכב, “to lie,” with a locative *mem*) mean “resting place, bed, grave, tomb.” E.g.,

וַיִּקְבְּרוּהוּ ... וַיִּשְׁכַּב אָסָא (and [King] Asa rested) with his fathers and died ... וַיִּקְבְּרוּהוּ (and they buried him in his own graves) which he had hewn out for himself in the City of David, וַיִּשְׁכְּבוּהוּ בַּמְּשָׁכָב (and they laid him in the tomb) (2 Chron. 16:13-14).¹⁴

וַיִּקְבְּרוּ יְתִיָּה ... וַיִּשְׁכַּב אָסָא (and [King] Asa rested) with his fathers and died ... וַיִּקְבְּרוּהוּ (and they buried him in his own cemetery) which he had prepared for himself in the City of David, וַיִּשְׁכְּבוּהוּ בַּמְּשָׁכָבָא and they laid him in the tomb (Targum for the above).

וְשׁוּכָב אֲנִי בְּאֶרְוֹן זֶה וּבְקֶבֶר זֶה (= וּשְׁכַב אֲנִי בַחֲלֹת זֶה וּבְקֶבֶר זֶה) and I rest in this coffin and in this grave ... וְכָל אָדָם אֵל יִפְתַּח (= וְכָל אָדָם אֵל יִפְתַּח אֶת מְשָׁכָב זֶה) and no man shall open this tomb; Phoenician, Eshmunezer 3-4).¹⁵

13 Many of these terms occur in the Scroll: נֶפֶשׁ, קֶבֶר, גִּינָה, גְּבוּהָ, עֵשֶׂרָה, בָּהּ, and כְּהֵן גְּדוֹל.

14 Allegro (167 n. 287) says that in this verse מְשָׁכָב means “grave,” and also attempts to identify the grave.

15 KAI 1, 3; 2, 19 (#14:3-4).

[...]הַמִּשְׁכָּב הַזֶּה שֶׁל חֵס[...]; Hebrew, Second Temple era).¹⁶

זֶה מִשְׁכְּבוֹ שֶׁל (this is the tomb of) Judah ben Levi ... may מִשְׁכְּבוֹ (his tomb) be in peace (Hebrew, Tannaic era).¹⁷

דָּנָא מִשְׁכְּבָא (this is the tomb) which is reserved for Animo the strategos son of Demasippos (Nabatean).¹⁸

The sages taught (in a baraita), "One shall honor (his father) while he is alive and honor him when he is dead, ... He shall not say, 'So said my father,' rather 'So said my father, my master, may I be כִּפְּרַת מִשְׁכְּבוֹ (an expiation for his rest'" (b. Qid. 31b).¹⁹

The term **בֵּית הַמִּשְׁכָּב** is like **הֶחָדָר מִשְׁכָּב**, "bedroom" (e.g., Exod. 7:28); both can be compared to **בְּבֵיתוֹ עַל מִשְׁכְּבוֹ**, "in his house upon his bed" (2 Sam. 4:11). Many biblical nouns having locative *mem* occur in Mishnaic Hebrew as **בֵּית (ה־)**, and in Aramaic as **בֵּית א-**, "place of (the)." E.g., **מְנוּסָמָנוּס** (BH, CS) vs. **בֵּית מְנוּס** (MH), "refuge" (see #5, 1:13); **מְקַדְשִׁיקוּדֶשׁ** (BH, MH) vs. **בֵּית הַמְקַדֶּשׁ** (MH), **בֵּית קוּדְשָׁא** (A), "Temple."²⁰ Similarly, the above discussed **בֵּית דִּירָה** – **דִּירָה** vs. **מְדוּר** (MH) and **מְדוּר** (BA), "dwelling place" (e.g., m. Oho. 8:9 and Dan. 4:22, respectively). Thus, **בֵּית הַמִּשְׁכָּב** is a typical Mishnaic Hebrew formation. Moreover, **שָׁכַב** (H, A, "to rest") and **קָבַר** (H, A, "to bury") often have the same meaning. Likewise, the nouns **מִשְׁכָּב**, **בֵּית הַמִּשְׁכָּב**, **קָבַר**, **קְבוּרָה**, **בֵּית קְבוּרָה**, **בֵּית הַקְּבֻרָה** (in Hebrew), as well as **מִשְׁכְּבָא**, **בֵּית מִשְׁכְּבָא**, **מִשְׁכְּבַתָא**, **קָבַר**, **קִיבְרָא**, **קְבֻרָא**, **בֵּית קְבוּרָא**, **בֵּית קְבוּרַתָא** (in Aramaic) are synonyms ("grave" or "cemetery").

The masculine **הַמַּעֲרָבִי** (masc.) refers to **בֵּית הַמִּשְׁכָּב** (masc.), i.e., "the western tomb." This indicates the presence of other tombs at this location. **הַמַּעֲרָבִי** appears several times in the Scroll (3:10; 6:12; 10:8; 10:13).

Since **בֵּית הַמִּשְׁכָּב** and **מִשְׁכָּן** are synonyms, **בֵּית הַמִּשְׁכָּב** **בְּמִבּוֹא דִּיןִּת** resembles the phrase **בְּמִשְׁכָּן הַמֶּלֶכָא בְּצִדֵּי הַמַּעֲרָבִי**, "In/at/by a/the tomb of the queen, at/by the western side" (see #27, 6:11-12).

Finally, the first three of the four nouns of the phrase **בְּמִבּוֹא דִּיןִּת** **בֵּית הַמִּשְׁכָּב** are in a construct state.²¹

16 E.Y. Kutscher, "הכתובות העבריות והארמיות בירושלים מימי הבית השני" in *Hebrew and Aramaic Studies* (1977), 354. Lurie quotes this inscription.

17 **בְּשׁוֹלָם** is instead of **בֵּית שְׁלֹמֹה** (*Beth She'arim* 3, 236-39); cf. **הַבּוֹאֵת** instead of **הַבּוֹאֵת**; see #1, 1:2.

18 From El-Hejra, CIS #234 (see H. Ingholt, "Palmyrene — Hatran — Nabataean," *An Aramaic Handbook*, 1967, Part I/1, 50 (vocalization assumed). This inscription is quoted by Milik, where he explains **מִשְׁכְּבָא** as "seat," rather than "tomb," and by Lurie, who renders **מִשְׁכְּבָא** as **דָּנָא מִשְׁכְּבָא**, "this tomb."

19 Here **מִשְׁכָּב** refers to grave (cf. Jastrow, 662b, 854a; ESh^{dic} 4, 1559a). Even-Shoshan does not list **קָבַר**, "grave," among the meanings of **מִשְׁכָּב** (ESh^{con} 2, 1337).

20 Cf. Bendauid 1, 98-99; 2, 444.

21 The longest series of nouns in the construct state in the Masoretic Text is **גְּבוּרֵי הַיָּל** **מְלָאכֵת עֲבוּרַת בֵּית הָאֱלֹדִים**, "qualified experts for the work of the service of the house of

(11:17) [...] טוֹף־טִיף עַל מַן, “(there is) a brook along [...]” — ALLEGRO^{pr}: “(at) the basin.” טִיף, cf. טִיפָא (A), “duct of overflow”; טִיף (MH), “receptacle for overflow,” also “dripping” of wine (Jastrow, 533a). The *yod* is not clear, being engraved very close to *pe*; it could also be a very small *nun*. ALLEGRO: טוֹף עַל, “scattered over”; טוֹף for נוֹטֵף (יֵן), “dropped” (usually of liquids), i.e., “scattered” loosely; cf. טִיף, “duct of overflow,” 7:15; or less likely for עֲטוּפָא, “wrapped up,” from עֲטַף.²² MILIK: ...עַל מַן, “(where is found) the platform for the portable stove, close by [...]” For טִיף, cf. BY 4, 1871.²³ LURIE: טִיף עַל, “piled up of.”²⁴ WOLTERS: טִיף עַל [...], “a little on [...]” טִיף is one of those words that Milik recognizes as Mishnaic, but “are mistaken readings.”²⁵ BEYER: טִיף עַל מַן עֲרָה, “there is a stone slab [upon a cave].”²⁶ VERMES: “is a channel over [...]”²⁷ WISE: “at the brook along the”²⁸ Rest of the scholars, including ALLEGRO^{rev}, agree with Milik.²⁹

עַל טוֹף־טִיף is followed by a letter fragment which may be a part of a *mem* or *bet* (MILIK^{dr}), or *mem*, *bet*, *samekh* (ALLEGRO^{dr}). It is followed by a lacuna of about ten letter spaces. The *ayin*, the first complete letter after the lacuna, is preceded by letter fragments that could be a *taw* and a *šin*, i.e., תשע, then is followed by מאות.

עַל טוֹף־טִיף is similar to עַד הַטּוֹף־הַטִּיף in Allegro's drawing (see #32, 7:14). Both are related to הַנֶּטֶף, “the Natoph,” as well as the alternates הַנֶּטֶף, “that drips,” and הַנֶּטֶף, “the rain water pool” (see #38, 9:1).

The Targumim may serve to clarify the meaning of טוֹף and טִיף; both belong to the root family of שִׁטַּף, שִׁטַּף, שִׁטַּף, from the bilateral root of טָף. The term פִּלְגָא (pl. פִּלְגִּים, pl. const. פִּלְגִּי) means “stream.” The Targumim usually render מֵיִם פִּלְגִּי as מֵיִם פִּלְגִּי (ד') and מֵיִם פִּלְגִּי, “streams of water(s).”³⁰ טִיף - טִיף, perhaps vocalized as טִיף, טִיף, טִיף, could be a Hebraized form of the Aramaic טִיפָא - טִיפָא or טִיפָא - טִיפָא. One can assume that the plural

God” (1 Chron. 9:13; see Ibn-Ezra on Lev. 13:59).

²² Allegro, 53, 167 n. 288; also 153 n. 158, 156 nn. 187 and 189.

²³ Milik, 296-97, 249 C-109; Milik^E, 142, 154.

²⁴ Lurie, 122-23 and n. 3.

²⁵ Wolters, 52-53; “Vocabulary,” 487.

²⁶ Beyer, 230, 232.

²⁷ Vermes, 377.

²⁸ Wise, 197. This is similar to this author's suggestion; see Lefkovits^{diss} 2, 860, 871-72.

²⁹ Allegro^{rev}, 26; “Iyyunim,” 130; Pixner, 357; Garcia Martinez, 463.

³⁰ Ps. 1:3, 119:136; Prov. 5:16, 21:1; Job 29:6. The singulars are טִיפָא - טִיפָא (masc.), “duct of overflow, channels” (Jastrow, 533a), and טִיפָא, “stream” (cf. טִיפָא in Syriac, AC 4, 57b).

forms are טַיִפִּים - טַיִפִּים (abs.), and טַיִפִּי - טַיִפִּי (const.). Based on the above, טַיִף, an unattested Hebrew form of the Aramaic טופאטיפא, has been rediscovered in the Copper Scroll. Thus, טַיִף עַל could mean "a brook along," while עַד הַטַּיִף, "toward the brook."

(11:17-12:1) כְּכָרִין שֵׁשִׁין 5 כֶּכְּרִין זָהָב כֹּחַ [...] " [...] (there are) nine hundred gold (pieces/shekels), 5 s(ilver) k(arsh, and) sixty (unspecified) talents" — ALLEGRO^{pr}: "[... ni]ne hundred [talents (?)] of gold, *kk* 5, sixty talents (i.e., כְּכָרִין שֵׁשִׁין 5 כֶּכְּרִין זָהָב כֹּחַ [ת]שַׁע מֵאוֹת זָהָב כֹּחַ 5 כְּכָרִין שֵׁשִׁין). ALLEGRO^{pr}: "talents ?" is crossed out. ALLEGRO: כְּכָרִין [?] תִּשְׁעַ מֵאוֹת זָהָב בְּכוּזִין כְּכָרִין שֵׁשִׁין, "nine hundred [talents of] gold; in juglets, sixty talents." ALLEGRO^{rev}: "nine hundred [vessels (?)], five talents of gold, sixty talents (of silver)," i.e., כְּכָלִין [כֶּסֶף כֹּחַ] תִּשְׁעַ מֵאוֹת זָהָב כֹּחַ 5 כְּכָרִין שֵׁשִׁין [?].³¹ MILIK: 5 כֶּכְּרִין זָהָב כֹּחַ 5 כְּכָרִין שֵׁשִׁין, "nine hundred [talents of silver], 5 talents of gold. Sixty talents." The last two words belong to the next item.³² LURIE: תִּשְׁעַ מֵאוֹת זָהָב כֹּחַ בְּכוּזִין כְּכָרִין שֵׁשִׁין, "nine hundred gold (coins), in jugs sixty talents."³³ WOLTERS: טַיִף עַל מְעָרָה בָּהּ [...] תִּשְׁעַ מֵאוֹת זָהָב כֹּחַ 5 כְּכָרִין שֵׁשִׁין, "nine hundred [...] : 5 talents of gold, sixty talents."³⁴ BEYER (with the previous phrase): כְּכָלִין [כֶּסֶף כֹּחַ] תִּשְׁעַ מֵאוֹת זָהָב כֹּחַ 5 כְּכָרִין שֵׁשִׁין, "there is a stone slab [upon a cave, in it there are] nine hundred [vessels], (and) 5 talents (about 108 kg) of gold (and) sixty talents (about 1290 kg of bronze)."³⁵ WISE: "[vessels totaling] nine hundred; five talents of gold coins; sixty talents of silver coins. Rest of the scholars agree with Milik.³⁶

There is disagreement among the scholars regarding: (1) the meaning of the term טַיִף; (2) the reconstruction of the lacuna; (3) whether the reading is 5 כֶּכְּרִין or כְּכָרִין; (4) where to separate the phrases; (5) whether these lines consist of one, two or three items. It should be added that Milik at several places correctly identifies the proper numerical signs, where as Allegro does not (e.g., 1:6, 4:5).

Any attempt to reconstruct the lacuna is largely a guesswork. Nevertheless, there may be some partial solutions.

A part of the lacuna belongs to the previous phrase, a part to the next. תִּשְׁעַ מֵאוֹת may refer to: (a) Distance, i.e., תִּשְׁעַ מֵאוֹת [אֲמוֹת], "(at a distance of) nine hundred [cubits]." (b) Vessels, i.e., תִּשְׁעַ מֵאוֹת [כְּכָלִין], "nine hundred

³¹ Allegro, 54-55; Allegro^{rev}, 26.

³² Milik, 297-98; Milik^E, 142.

³³ Lurie, 122-23 (there are several typographical errors). In the translation Lurie adds the word מִטְבָּעוֹת, "coins," an apparent restoration. However, in the assessment of silver and gold in the Scroll, Lurie accepts Allegro's calculations (Lurie, 6-7). Thus, מִטְבָּעוֹת may be an error for כְּכָרִין.

³⁴ Wolters, 52-55.

³⁵ Beyer, 230, 232.

³⁶ Pixner, 357; Garcia Martinez, 463; Vermes, 377.

[vessels]” (cf. Allegro^{rev}, Beyer); or תִּשְׁעַ מֵאוֹת [כָּלִי דָמַע], nine hundred [dema^c vessels]”; cf. כָּלִי כֶסֶף וְזָהָב שֶׁל דָּמַע ... כָּל שֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת וְתִשְׁעַ, “silver and golden dema^c vessels ... a total of six hundred and nine” (3:2-4). (c) Silver or gold pieces/shekels, i.e., תִּשְׁעַ מֵאוֹת [כֶּסֶף], “nine hundred [silver (pieces/shekels)]”; or תִּשְׁעַ מֵאוֹת [זָהָב], “nine hundred [gold (pieces/shekels)].” Often in the Masoretic Text, Talmudim, and Midrashim זָהָב and כֶּסֶף refers to silver and gold piece/shekel, respectively (see #1, 1:4; #59, 12:9). (4) כְּכָרִין [תִּשְׁעַ מֵאוֹת], “nine hundred [(unspecified) talents]”; cf. כְּכָרִין תִּשְׁעַ מֵאוֹת, “nine hundred talents” (see #3, 1:8); cf. Allegro, Milik, etc. (5) כֹּכ, i.e., [כֹּכ] תִּשְׁעַ מֵאוֹת, “nine hundred [kk]”; cf. כֹּכ 80, “80 kk” (10:14). It should be added that it is difficult to assume that 900 refers to כֹּכ or כְּכָרִין since the very next line contains both terms.

Accordingly, the first half of line 12:1, זָהָב כֹּכ 5 כְּכָרִין שִׁשִּׁין, is a separate phrase, meaning “5 karsh (and) sixty talents of gold,” where זָהָב refers to both כֹּכ and כְּכָרִין. Here כֹּכ must refer only to “karsh,” not “silver karsh”; cf. 17 כֶּסֶף וְזָהָב כֹּכ, “17 karsh of silver and/or gold” (8:6-7). Both כֹּכ and כְּכָרִין also occur in the phrase כֹּכ 60 זָהָב כְּכָרִין שִׁשִּׁין, “60 s(ilver) k(arsh) two talents of gold,” or “60 karsh (and) two talents of gold” (see #32, 7:16).

The entire lacuna belongs to the previous phrase. Accordingly, תִּשְׁעַ מֵאוֹת כְּכָרִין שִׁשִּׁין זָהָב כֹּכ 5 means, “nine hundred gold (pieces/shekels), 5 s(ilver) k(arsh), sixty (unspecified) talents.” This option has certain advantages: (a) זָהָב does not refer to both כֹּכ and כְּכָרִין. (b) כֹּכ can be an abbreviation for כֶּסֶף כְּכָרִין. (c) There is enough room in the lacuna for the missing part of the previous phrase. (d) כְּכָרִין שִׁשִּׁין refers to unspecified material; cf. אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת, “four hundred (unspecified) talents” (7:7). Moreover, it is unlikely that כֹּכ is an abbreviation for כָּלִי כֶסֶף, “silver vessels.”

The seven letters רִין שִׁשִּׁין are squeezed in between כֹּכ and בִּיאָתוֹ. The size of letters שִׁשׁ רִין are about half that of the rest of the letters of this line; the two final *nuns* are of regular shape, while the second *yod* is of normal size, although its shape is somewhat unusual. Apparently, the scribe originally wrote כֹּכ, leaving out about five square letter spaces, then wrote בִּיאָתוֹ. Thus, רִין שִׁשִּׁין must be a later correction, which supports the view that כֹּכ is not an abbreviation for כְּכָרִין (see Appendix A).

(12:1) בִּיאָתוֹ מִן הַכְּרִיזְהָמָע־רֶב — “Its entrance is from/to the city/w<e>st” — The word בִּיאָתוֹ, “its (masc.) entrance,” refers to the masculine בֵּית הַמִּשְׁכָּב, “tomb.” Therefore, מִבְּאֵר, “entrance of,” must be interpreted as the Mishnaic מְבוֹי, which often means “alley”; i.e., “In the alley of the watchman’s quarter of the tomb, ... its (i.e., the tomb’s) entrance is ...” On the other hand, בִּיאָתוֹ may refer to an unspecified hiding place, thus the meaning could be, “it’s (i.e., the hiding place) entrance is.”

Since in the Scroll *kaf* and *mem*, as well as *kaf* and *bet*, are often undistinguishable, הכרכ can be read as המרב for המַעֲרֵב, as the scholars do; cf. דמ for דַּמְעָה (see #54, 11:14).³⁷ In these cases the loss of *ayin* may indicate weakening of the gutturals. מִן הַמַּעֲרֵב, “from the west,” also means “to the west.” Regarding directions, see #4, 1:11; #10, 2:10; #19, 4:11. The advantage of the reading הכרכ does not need to be amended.

כָּרֶךְ (MH) and כָּרְכָא (A, e.g., Trg. 2 Sam. 20:19) mean “(fortified) city,” from the root כָּרַךְ, “to encircle.” However, some derive these terms from the Greek χάραξ, and from the Akkadian *kirhu*, “fort, fortified city.”³⁸ כָּרֶךְ is larger than an עִיר, “town, city.” E.g.,

One cannot (force his wife to) move מַעִיר לְעִיר (from town to town), וּמְכָרֶךְ לְכָרֶךְ (and from city to city). But in the same land one is allowed (to force his wife) to move מַעִיר לְעִיר (from town to town), וּמְכָרֶךְ לְכָרֶךְ (and from city to city), but not מַעִיר לְכָרֶךְ (from a town to a city) and not מְכָרֶךְ לְעִיר (from a city to a town; m. Ket. 13:10).

כָּרְכָא מִן הַכָּרֶךְ means “its (masc.) entrance is from the city” or “its entrance is toward the city”; likewise מִן הַמַּעֲרֵב means “its entrance is from the west” or “its entrance is westward.” Regarding מִן plus a direction, see #10, 2:10. Finally, כָּרֶךְ also occurs in the alternate reading of בְּבִיבְאֵי בְּכִיבָא בְּכִיבָא, “In/at/by the large drain of the city,” where the *waw* may be a short-headed *reš* (see #59, 12:8).

תַּחַת הָאֶבֶן הַשְּׁחֹרָא כּוּזִין וְכּוּזִין תַּחַת סֵף הַכּוּזָא הַכּוּזָא כְּכָרִין 42 (12:2-3), “Under the black stone (there are an undisclosed number of) jugs. Under the threshold of the burial niche (are) 42 (unspecified) talents” — The fourth word has been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO^{Pr} (connected to the next phrase): “strewn under the sill of the chamber” (i.e., בּוּזִין תַּחַת סֵף הַכּוּזָא). בּוּזִין, “divided,” thus “strewn”; cf. בּוּזָא (Isa. 18:2,7), בּוּזָא (MH), “divide”; rather than כּוּזִין (MH), “oil vessel used in the Temple.” The first letter is obscure, the scribe engraved the top and the left part of a *taw*, then wrote over it a *bet* or *kaf*. כּוּזָא (MH), “cavity, cave.” ALLEGRO (connected with the previous phrase): כּוּזִין, “juglets,” as בְּכּוּזִין in the previous line.³⁹ מִלִּיק, “nearby,” from יָד, “hand.” This is the first word of the next item.⁴⁰ WILMOT: for בִּידִין read

37 Allegro^{Pr}; Allegro, 55, 168 nn. 292-93; Allegro^{rev}, 26; Milik, 298, 229 B-10b, 231 B-16b, 234 B-19a; Milik^E, 142 (“on circling around” is a typographical error for “at its entrance”; cf. 2:12); Lurie, 122-23 and n. 5; Pixner, 357; Wolters, 54-55; Garcia Martinez, 463; Beyer, 230, 232; Vermes, 377. Bendavid (1, 98-99) says that the Scroll uses בִּיאָתוֹ (BH, Ezek. 8:5), rather than כְּנִיסָתוֹ (MH, “its entrance”). Sharvit notes that בִּיאָה appears only once in the Masoretic Text, but it is common in Mishnaic Hebrew (“Iyyunim,” 127-35).

38 AC 4, 322b; BY 3, 2518b, and n. 1; ESh^{dic} 3, 1103b.

39 Allegro, 55, 168 n. 295; Allegro^{rev}, 26.

40 Milik, 298-99; Milik^E, 142.

כוּוין (cf. Allegro).⁴¹ LURIE, WOLTERS, BEYER, and WISE follow Allegro, while PIXNER, GARCIA MARTINEZ, and VERMES agree with Milik.⁴²

According to the drawings of BAKER and ALLEGRO, this word can be read as כּוּוין (as Allegro) and כּוּוין.⁴³ In the drawing of MILIK there is an apparent ligature of the third and fourth letters that resembles a *dalet* (cf. Milik's בידן). This is one of those rare cases where Baker's drawing agrees with Allegro's, rather than Milik's.

כוּוין is the plural of כּוּו (probably double gender, MH), "jug." כּוּו is a variant of כּוּס (double gender, BH, MH; the plural כּוּסוֹת occurs in the Scroll, see #12, 3:3), "cup" (*zayin-samekh* interchange).⁴⁴ The oil vessel *koz* was used in the Temple; e.g., "the כּוּו is like a large wine cup" (m. Tamid 3:6). Its Aramaic cognate is כּוּוָא. E.g., King Ahasuerus used to drink כּוּוָא בְּכּוּוָא, "from the gold jug" (Targum Šeni Esth. 2:21), which is rendered in Hebrew by *Patšegen hakKetav* as בְּכּוּס שֶׁל זָהָב, "from the gold cup." The Talmud relates that Rabbi Ashi ordained in Husal in Babylon that כּוּוָא בֵּת, "the *koz* shall contain one quarter (of a liquid measure, a *log*)" (b. Hul. 107a).⁴⁵

כוּוין is the plural of כּוּה (fem., BA, QA, JA, MH), "cavity, small window." E.g., וְכוּין פְּתִיחָן לֵה בְּעִלְיָתָהּ נִגְדַּי יְרוּשָׁלַם, "and (Daniel) had windows open for him in his upper chamber facing Jerusalem" (Dan. 6:11, BA); כּוּין אֲטִמָּן, "narrow/sealed windows" (5Q15 1:ii:11), cf. וְחִלּוּנוֹת אֲטִמּוֹת and וְהַחֲלוֹנוֹת הָאֲטִמּוֹת and their Targum, וְכוּין סְתִימָן, "and narrow/sealed windows" (Ezek. 40:16 and 41:16, respectively);⁴⁶ כּוּוין כּוּוין עֲשָׂאָךְ, "(God) made you(r) body) full of cavities" (Sifri Ha'azinu 134).

If the first three words belongs to the previous phrase, then it reads as, 42 בִּיאָתוֹ מִן הַכְּרִיף הַמֵּצֵא רֶב תַּחַת הָאֵבֶן הַשְּׁחוּרָא, כּוּוין תַּחַת סֵף הַכּוּף הַכּוּף כְּכָרִין, "its entrance is from/to the city/west below the black stone. (There are) cavities under the threshold of the burial niche (there are) 42 (unspecified) talents."

41 "David J. Wilmot and the Copper Scroll," 21.

42 Lurie, 122-23; Wolters, 54-55; Beyer, 230, 232; Wise, 198; Pixner, 357; Garcia Martinez, 463; Vermes, 377.

43 The possible כּוּוין and כּוּוין (cf. Allegro^{PF}) seem to be unlikely. הַבּוּז, "the Buz" occurs in the Scroll (see #32, 7:14).

44 ESh^{dic} 3, 1029b; BY 3, 2279b-80a and n. 1; also CTL, 207-10; HR 3, 503; Allegro, 167-68 n. 290; Lurie, 123 n. 4. on the other hand, כּוּו may be a Hellenized form of כּוּס (cf. AC 4, 210; He'Arukh, 275b). The term הַכּוּו appears as an alternate reading in the Scroll (see #32, 7:14).

45 AC 4, 210; He'Arukh, 275b; Jastrow, 618a; ESh^{dic} 3, 1029b; BY 3, 2279b-80a and n. 1; CTL, 207-10; HR 3, 503-04; also Allegro, 167-68 n. 290; Lurie, 123 n. 4.

46 Cf. Rashi, Radak, *Mešudat David*, and *Mešudat Zion*. See also, F. Garcia Martinez, *Qumran and Apocalyptic* (1992), 198 n. 57.

On the other hand, if it is read as *תחת סף הכור־ה*, then it means "below the black stone (there are undisclosed number of) jugs; under the threshold of the burial niche (there are) 42 (unspecified) talents." Accordingly, the last two phrases are parallel expressions: (a) *תחת האבן השחורא כוזין*; and (b) *תחת סף הכור־הכור ככרין 42*. Regarding *תחת האבן השחורא*, see #47, 10:9; for *סף*, #2, 1:5; #53, 11:8; for *כור*, #59, 12:8; for *ככרין*, Appendix A.

Finally, this item is similar to two other items: *בבור־בבור שתחת החומא מן המזרח בשן הסלע ... ביאתו תחת הסף הגדול*, "In/at/by a/the cistern which is below the city-wall from/to the east in/at/by a/the peak of the rock ... its entrance is below the large threshold" (see #10, 2:10-12); and *בשית־בשית שבמלח־שבמלח מבצפֿונו ... ביאתא תחת הפנא המערבית*, "In/at/by a/the deep pit which is in (the) Melah from its north ... its entrance is below the the western corner" (see #13, 3:8-10).

ITEM 57

12:4 בהר גריזין תחת המעלה של השית העליונה

12:5 שדא אחת וכל כליה וכסף ככ 60

12:4 On Mount Gerizim below the steps of the upper deep pit,

12:5 (there is) a carrying chair with all of its components, plus silver of 60 s(ilver) k(arsh).

COMMENTARY

(12:4) **בְּהַר גְּרִיזִין** (const.) is the same as **בְּהַר שֶׁל גְּרִיזִים**, “On/at/by (the) Mount Gerizim”; cf. **בְּהַר עֵיבָל**, “on/at/by (the) Mount of Ebal” (Deut. 24:7, etc.), **בְּהַר אֶפְרַיִם**, “on/at/by (the) Mount of Ephraim” (Josh. 19:50, etc.).

גריזין is the reading of the scholars, except ALLEGRO^{Pr}.¹ The text has **גריזין**, *waw* instead of a *reš*, which is could be: (a) a scribal error; (b) a short headed *reš*; i.e., **גריזין**; (c) a short legged final *nun* in medial position; i.e., **גריזין** = **גריזין** = **גריזין** (*nun-reš* interchange; see #37, 8:14).

הַר גְּרִיזִין is a *plene* spelling of **הַר גְּרִיזִין**, like **נִקְרַת** for **נִקְרַת** (1:12).² It can be compared with the various spellings of **טַגְרִיזִים**, **טַגְרִיזִים**, **טַגְרִיזִים** in the Targumim,³ as well as **הַר גְּרִיזִים** in Mishnaic Hebrew. E.g.,

בֵּין שְׁעָבְרוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת הַיַּרְדֵּן וּבָאוּ אֶל הַר גְּרִיזִים וְאֶל הַר עֵיבָל שְׁבָשׁוּמְרוֹן שְׁבָצַד שְׁכָם שְׁאֲצֵל אֲלוֹנֵי מוֹרָה

When Israel crossed the Jordan (river) and they came to Mount Gerizim and to Mount Ebal which are in Samaria, which are near Sechem, which are beside the Oaks of More” (m. Soṭ. 7:5; referring to Deut. 11:30 and Gen. 12:6; cf. t. Soṭ. 8:9).⁴

1 Allegro^{Pr}: “In one of the beams” (i.e., **בְּהַר גְּרִיזִין**). **גְּרִיזִין** not clearly engraved; cf. **גְּרִיזִין** (A), “cut wood,” thus “beam (?)”. Allegro^{Pr}: “In Mount Gerizim.” Allegro, 55, 168 n. 298 (*waw* for *reš*); Allegro^{rev}, 26; Milik, 298-99 (dot above the *reš*, cursive *reš*), 274 D-69; Milik^E, 142, 154; Lurie, 123-24 and n. 1; Pixner, 357 and n. 49 (with a question mark); Wolters, 54-55; Garcia Martinez, 463; Beyer, 232; Vermes, 378; Wise, 198.

2 Thorion (165) says the vocal “i” in **גריזין** is spelled *plene* as in **נִקְרַת** and in **שילוח** (4:9, Lurie). He does not mention the Mishnaic and Targumic spellings.

3 Trg. Judg. 9:7; Josh. 8:33; TO Deut. 11:29, 27:12; TO in some ed.; TN Deut. 11:19; Frag. Deut. 27:15; TN Deut. 27:12,15; PsJ Deut. 11:29, 27:12; TO in some ed., respectively.

4 The words **בצד** and **שאצל** appear in the Scroll (see #27, 6:11; #30, 7:8).

In the Masoretic Text the vocalization, according to the School of Ben-Asher, is הַר גֵּרִיזִים, where the *reš* has a short *hiriq*, and the *zayin* a *dageš forte* (Har Gerizzim; Deut. 11:20, 27:12; Josh. 8:33; Judg. 9:7). However, according to the School of Ben-Naphtali, the *reš* has a long *hiriq*, and the *zayin* is *rafah*, הַר גֵּרִיזִים for הַר גֵּרִיזִים (cf. the English form Gerizim). In the Samaritan Pentateuch הַר גֵּרִיזִים is written as one word, and pronounced with a *zayin rafah* (i.e., הַרְגִּיזִים).⁵

For hundreds of years there was animosity between Jews and Samaritans, because the Samaritans objected to rebuilding the Second Temple. When the Jews captured the wall of Samaria and overcame the Samaritans (128 BCE), they established those days as a time of rejoicing. These events are recorded in Megillat Ta'anit (Scroll of Fasts), written in Aramaic, which is perhaps the first recorded segment of the Oral Torah. There it is written, בְּעֶשְׂרִין וְחֵדָּה יוֹם הַר גֵּרִיזִים דִּי לֹא לְמִסְפַּד, "In the twenty-fifth (day) in it (i.e., in the month Marḥešwan), capture of the wall of Samaria" (8:2); and בְּעֶשְׂרִין וְחֵדָּה יוֹם הַר גֵּרִיזִים דִּי לֹא לְמִסְפַּד, "In the twenty-first (day) in it (i.e., in the month Kislew), Day of Mount Gerizim, one should not to mourn" (9:2). Regarding Megillat Ta'anit, see "The Language of the Copper Scroll" in the Introduction; "Copper Scroll Hebrew" and "Authenticity of the Copper Scroll" in the Discussion.

Concerning the location of the biblical Mount Gerizim, the Talmudim state that according to Rabbi Judah it is located where the Kuthim (i.e., Samaritans) dwell (i.e., Sechem - Nablus), while according to Rabbi Eliezer, it is a mound erected by the Israelites near Gilgal at the time of the conquest of Canaan by Joshua (y. Soṭ. 7:3 [29a-b]; b. Soṭ. 33b; Sifri on Deut. 11:30).⁶ The latter view was adopted by the Christian church fathers.⁷ MILIK, PIXNER, BEYER, and WISE follow the first opinion, while ALLEGRO and LURIE the second one.⁸ Regarding Mount Gerizim, see also #47, 10:8.

(12:4) תַּחַת הַמַּעְלָהּ, "below the steps" — ALLEGRO^{pr}: "under the steps." ALLEGRO: "under the entrance." Cf. Syriac *ma'alletha*, "entrance," Aramaic *me'allatha*, "income," from עָלָה, "to enter." Or the *ma'alletha* is an error for הַמַּעְלָה, "the steps." ALLEGRO^{rev}: "under the as-

5 Z. Ben-Hayyim, "גרזים, הר גרזים" in *EB* 2, 554-58. See also M. Breuer, "הר גרזים" in *Lešonenu* 33 (1968/69), 318. Regarding the writing of הַר גֵּרִיזִים as one word, see S. Talmon, "A Masada Fragment of Samaritan Origin," *IEJ* 47 (1997), 225-30; Talmon mentions the first part on this item (226 n. 24 [העלינה] is a printing error for הַר גֵּרִיזִים).

6 See also, Z. Ben-Hayyim, "גרזים, הר גרזים" in *EB* 2, 554-58; Y.M. Grintz, "Gerizim, Mount," *EJ* 7, 436-38; "גרזים ועיבל" in *EH* 11, 302-05.

7 Eusebius, *Onomasticon* 64:19-20 (mentioned by Allegro and Lurie).

8 Milik, 261 D-69; Milik^E, 154-55; Pixner, 357 n. 49; Beyer, 232; Wise, 198; Allegro, 168 n. 298; Lurie, 123-24 n. 1.

cent.”⁹ MILIK: תחת המעלהא, “beneath the steps.” The scribe put an *’alef* after the *he*; cf. חריבה (1:1).¹⁰ LURIE: תחת המעלות, renders תחת המעלות, “under the steps.” It could mean “under the entrance.”¹¹ Regarding Allegro’s and Lurie’s suggestion, a noun cannot have two definite articles, ה- (H) and א- (A), although the latter might have already lost its determinate state in Palestine at the time the Scroll was written. THORION: in תחת המעלהא the vocal “a” is indicated by two letters; such spellings, as noted by Kutscher, occur in the Isaiah Scroll.¹² BEYER: תחת המעל (ה)א, “under the steps.”¹³ The rest follow Milik.¹⁴

מעלהא is a variant of מַעְלָה with an extra *’alef*, like the possible readings of חרובהא = חרובה, חריבהא = חריבה, Haruvah, Harevah, or “ruin,” and not a scribal error (see #1, 1:1). מַעְלָה (fem., pl. מַעְלוֹת), “step, stair,” from the root עלה, “to go up, ascend,” formed with a prefixed locative *mem*. The plural form occurs in the Scroll twice: תחת המַעְלוֹת, “below the steps” (1:2) and שתחת המַעְלוֹת, “which is below the steps” (2:1). The singular מַעְלָה could indicate that this deep pit had only one step, or it is a collective noun, i.e., “steps.” מַעְלָה should not be confused with מַעְלָה (masc.), “ascent,” from the same root.

In the Masoretic Text when מַעְלָה means step, it is always plural. E.g., ונגדם עלו על מַעְלוֹת עיר דָּוִד בַּמַּעְלָה לְחוּמָּה, “and in front of them, they went up by the stairs of the city of David, at the ascent of the (city) wall” (Neh. 12:37). The singular (i.e., one step) appears in Mishnaic Hebrew. E.g., ושָׁתִים עֶשְׂרֵה מַעְלוֹת הָיוּ שָׁם, רֹם מַעְלָה חֲצִי אַמָּה, “and there were twelve steps, the height of a step is a half-cubit” (m. Mid. 3:6).

(12:4) שֶׁל הַשִּׁית הָעֲלִיוֹנָא, “of the upper deep pit” — It is also possible to read as תחת המַעְלָהא שֶׁל הַשִּׁית הָעֲלִיוֹנָא, “the pit” (see #13, 3:8). תחת המַעְלָהא שֶׁל הַשִּׁית הָעֲלִיוֹנָא resembles the phrase נֶגֶד הַפֶּתַח הָעֲלִיוֹן, “opposite the upper entrance” (1:8). The feminine adjective עֲלִיוֹנָא shows that שִׁית is feminine, the same way as the masculine עֲלִיוֹן indicates that פֶּתַח is masculine (see #13, 3:8).

THORION suggests that the three nouns של השית העליונא may have been separated by של because המעלת השית העליונא would be ambiguous, whether העליונא would refer to מעלת or to שית.¹⁵

The cache listed in this item was hidden under the steps of the deep pit. Yet it is uncertain whether these steps lead up to or were within the pit.

9 Allegro, 55, 168 n. 299; Allegro^{rev}, 26.

10 Milik, 298-99, 227 B-3a, 247 C-93; Milik^E, 142, 155.

11 Lurie, 123-24 and n. 2.

12 Thorion, 166 and n. 10, 170. He refers to *LLBIS*, 139.

13 Beyer, 232.

14 Pixner, 357; Wolters, 54-55; Garcia Martinez, 463; Vermes, 378; Wise, 198.

15 Thorion, 170.

Moreover, הַשִּׁית הָעֲלִינָא clearly implies that in Mount Gerizim there were more than one pit; perhaps there was a lower pit.

The phrase שֶׁל הַשִּׁית הָעֲלִינָא ... בְּהַר גְּרִיזִין resembles the possible interpretation of בִּימָם בְּיָמֵי גִּרְזִין as בִּימָם בְּיָמֵי גְרִיזִין, where the *waw* is an error for a *reš*, a short headed *reš*, or short-legged final *nun* in middle position, plus the final *kaf* may be a scribal error for a final *nun*, "At/by (the) Pool of Gerizim." Consequently, one item mentions a deep pit, while the other a pool. Moreover, the shape of the letters of גִּרְזִין are analogous to גְּרִיזִין (see #47, 10:8).

In the summers of 1964 and 1966, Bull led an excavation at Tel er-Ras, on the northern peak of Mount Gerizim. Among others, a trench was discovered. Bull suggests that this is the "upper fosse" (הַשִּׁית הָעֲלִינָא) mentioned in this item. He also discusses the steps (מַעְלוֹת) leading up to Mount Gerizim. In addition, Bull discovered six cisterns.¹⁶ Although these were from a later period, there must have been cisterns at an earlier period too. Can the "Pool of Gerizim" and "the upper deep pit" of Mount Gerizim mentioned in the Scroll be from these earlier cisterns?

Bull's suggestion may be very important regarding the authenticity of the Copper Scroll. It may also support the view that the Jerusalem priestly circle controlled Mount Gerizim and used its hiding places to bury some of the treasures of the Temple. Based on this assumption, Mount Gerizim in the Scroll refers to the Samaritan site rather than to the small hill built by the Israelites at the time of Joshua.

(12:5) שְׂדָא אַחַת וְכָל כְּלִיָּהּ, "one carrying chair with all its (fem.) components," or "one box and all its (fem.) components" — This phrase is like שְׂדָת כֶּסֶף וְכְלִיָּהּ, "a silver carrying chair and its (fem.) components," or "a silver box and its components." For a detailed discussion, see #1, 1:3.

(12:5) 60 כֶּסֶף כֶּכ, "plus 60 k(arsh) s(ilver)" — Regarding the abbreviation כֶּכ, see #1, 1:3; Appendix A.

16 R.J. Bull and G.E. Wright, "Newly discovered Temples on Mt. Gerizim in Jordan," *The Harvard Theological Review* 58 (1965), 234-37; R.J. Bull, "The Excavation of Tell er-Ras on Mt. Gerizim," *BA* 31 (1968), 58-72.

ITEM 58

12:6 בפי המבוע של בית שמ כל<י> כסף וכלי זהב
12:7 של דמע וכסף הכל ככרין שש מאות

- 12:6 At the mouth of the spring of Beth Shem, (there are)
dedicated silver vesse<ls> and gold
12:7 vessels, plus a total of six hundred talents of silver.

COMMENTARY

(12:6) **בְּפִי הַמְּבוּעַ** (cost.) is the same as **בְּפִהּ שֶׁל הַמְּבוּעַ**, “at/by the mouth of the spring.” **פִּי** is the construct state of **פֶּה** (masc.), “mouth, opening.”¹ **מְבוּעַ** (masc., pl. **מְבוּעֵי־סוּן**, from the root **נבע**, “to bubble forth, flow,” with a prefixed locative *mem*) means “spring, fountain.” E.g., **וְתִשָּׁבֵר כַּד עַל הַמְּבוּעַ**, “and a pitcher is broken upon the fountain, and the wheel smashes into the cistern” (Eccl. 12:6), where **מְבוּעַ** is parallel to **בּוֹר**, both nouns appear in the Scroll.² **מְבוּעַ** also appears in the Dead Sea Scrolls (e.g., 1QH 8:16), Targumim and Midrashim,³ as well as in the Palestinian Talmud (e.g., y. ‘A.Z. 5:4 [23b]).⁴

בְּפִי הַמְּבוּעַ is like the phrases **בְּפִי גַל**, “at/by (the) mouth of the well” (see #4, 1:11); and **עַל פִּי יְצִיאַת הַמַּיִם**, “upon/at (the) mouth of the exit of the waters” (see #32, 7:14).

(12:6) **שֶׁל בֵּית שֶׁם/שָׁם/שָׁמ**, “of Beth Shem/Sham/Sam,” or **שֶׁל בֵּית שֶׁם**, “of the House, there (are)” — **בֵּית שֶׁם** has been interpreted as follows. ALLEGROP:

1 Several forms of **פֶּה** occur in the Scroll: **פִּי**, “the mouth of” (7:14, 8:8, 9:14); **מִפִּי**, “from the mouth of,” or **בְּפִי** (1:11); **פִּיהָ**, “its (fem.) mouth” (12:11), and **לְפִיהֶם**, “to their mouth” (2:12).

2 Allegro (169 n. 304) mentions this verse. Based on Punic, JPSⁱⁱ renders **גִּלְגַּל** as “jug.” Accordingly, not only **מְבוּעַ** and **בּוֹר**, but also **כַּד** and **גִּלְגַּל** are synonyms. The Midrash expounds on this verse: “Some say, **כַּדוֹ שֶׁל בָּרוּךְ עַל מְבוּעוֹ שֶׁל יִרְמְיָהּ** (the pitcher of Baruch on the spring of Jeremiah [i.e., Baruch’s ordeal came because of Jeremiah]); others say, **כַּדוֹ שֶׁל בָּרוּךְ עַל מְבוּעוֹ שֶׁל יִרְמְיָהּ** (the pitcher of Jeremiah on the spring of Baruch [i.e., Jeremiah’s ordeal came because of Baruch])” (Eccl. Rabbah 12:7).

3 E.g., Scripture says that in Elim there were **שְׁתֵּים עָשָׂר עֵינֹת מַיִם** (TO **תָּרִי עֶשֶׂר מְבוּעֵין**) (“twelve springs of water” (Exod. 15:27). This is expounded by the Midrash as, **שְׁנַיִם**, “(the) twelve springs corresponding to (the) twelve tribes of Israel” (Mekhilta’ Be’sallah Wayyassa’ 1:27; cf. PsJ, Frag.).

4 Sharvit does not mention that **מְבוּעַ מְבוּעָא** (A) occurs in the Palestinian Talmud and in

"House of the Lord (Shem)." ALLEGRO: "the Temple"; **בית השם** for **בית שמ**, "House of the Name." **בית שמ** of **מבוע** may be the same as the Golah Cistern of the Temple Court (m. 'Eruv. 10:14; m. Mid. 5:4). ALLEGRO^{rev}: "the Temple (?)." ⁵ MILIK: "Bet Sham" is **בית שאן** - **בית שן** in the Jewish writings, *Baithsam* and *Bethshan* in Greek sources, Scythopolis in the Greco-Roman period, modern Beisan, the north of the Jordan Valley. Cf. **בית הרן** (Beth-haran, Num. 32:36) and **בית הרם** (Beth-haram, Josh. 13:27). Since the definite article is missing, **בית שם** cannot mean "House of the Name (God)." ⁶ LURIE: **בית שם** is an unattested toponym. Milik's suggestion is erroneous, "there is no 'alef, and a clear *mem* cannot be interchanged with a *nun*." **בית שן** and **בית שאן** were two separate cities. Allegro's suggestion is also wrong. ⁷ GREENFIELD: "There is no reason to assume that Beth She'an was ever written with a *mem*: the alternate *m/n* was almost always *m > n*." ⁸ PIXNER: Beth Sham. Milik suggests Beth-She'an but since the last letter is a *mem*, it is "problematic but not impossible." If Milik's suggestion is correct and **מבוע** of this item is the spring of Ainon near Salim of John 3:22, then "this should be of great significance for a possible Essene background of John the Baptist." ⁹ WILMOT: for **שמ** restore **שם** (?). ¹⁰ WISE: Beth Shem is an unknown place name, it may be an error for Beth Shemesh in southwest Palestine associated with Samson. ¹¹ The rest of the scholars consider **בית שם** as a toponym. ¹²

There are several possible readings, vocalizations, and translations for these two words. Regarding **בית**, see #7, 2:3.

בֵּית שֵׁם, Beth Sham, could be a variant of **בֵּית שֵׁן**, Bet-shan (*mem-nun* interchange); cf. **בֵּית הָרֵן** and **בֵּית הָרֵם** (as quite rightly pointed out by Milik but challenged by Greenfield). Most scholars agree that both **בֵּית שֵׁן**, Beth-shan (2 Sam. 21:12), and **בֵּית שֵׁאָן**, Beth-shean (Josh. 17:11, etc.), refer to the same city in Menasseh. ¹³ The 'alef in **שֵׁאָן** may represent *plene* spelling; cf. **צִנְן**, Zenan (Josh. 15:37) and **צִאָנָן**, Zaanan (Micah 1:11), a city in Judah. ¹⁴

the Targumim ("Iyyunim," 132).

⁵ Allegro, 55, 169 nn. 304-05; Allegro^{rev}, 27.

⁶ Milik, 298-99, 229 B-12, 261-62 D-1, 299 "Addenda A 3Q15" (a); Milik^E, 142 ("Bet-Shan" is a typographical error for "Bet-Sham"), 155.

⁷ Lurie, 123-24 and n. 2 (the phrase, "of the second part of the name only one character is clear," must be a typographical error).

⁸ Greenfield, 139b-40a.

⁹ Pixner, 357 and n. 50; Milik, 262 D-1.

¹⁰ "David J. Wilmot and the Copper Scroll," 21.

¹¹ Wise, 198.

¹² Wolters, 54-55; Garcia Martinez, 463; Beyer ("an unknown place"), 232-33; Vermes, 378.

¹³ E.g., BDB, 112b **בית שאן** means "place of quiet"; Harkavy, 57b; SB, 104b; ESh^{con} 1, 330a.

¹⁴ SB, 710a; ESh^{con}, 3, 1844a; etc.

בֵּית שֵׁם, Beth Shem or “House/City of Shem,” may be an unattested toponym (cf. Lurie, Beyer). שֵׁם, Shem, is a personal name; cf. וַיֹּלֶד נֹחַ יֶפֶת וְשֵׁם וְחָם אֶת שֵׁם אֶת חָם וְאֶת יָפֶת, “and Noah begot three sons, Shem, Ham, and Japheth” (Gen. 6:10).

בֵּית שֵׁם, “House of God” or “Temple” (cf. Allegro), where שֵׁם means “Name,” referring to God. It will be discussed later.

בֵּית שָׁם = בֵּית סָם, “Beth Sam” or “House of Drug,” where שָׁם (with a *Sin*) may be a variant of סָם (cf. Sifre Deut. 11:18; b. Yoma 72b). סָם (masc., m. Giṭ. 2:3; pl. סָמִים, Exod. 30:7, etc.) means “drug”; and so its Aramaic cognate, סָמָא, “the drug” (e.g., PsJ Gen. 24:33). סָמָא is also a personal name. E.g., “Rav סָמָא (Samma) the son of Rav Ashi” (b. ‘A.Z. 50b). Since בֵּית and כְּפָר as first member of a compound toponym may interchange (see #43, 9:14-15), בֵּית שָׁם־סָם may be identical with כְּפָר סָמָא, “Village of Samma” or “Village of Drug” (t. Hul. 2:22).

An additional alternate reading, vocalization, phrase separation, and interpretation will be discussed later.

(12:6-7) כָּל־>וּכְלִי־> כֶּסֶף וּכְלִי־וְזָהָב שֶׁל דָּמַע, “dedicated silver vesse<l> and (dedicated) gold vessels,” or “a dedicated silver vesse<l> and a (dedicated) gold vessel” — The scholars emend כָּל כֶּסֶף, “all silver,” to כָּל־וּכְלִי, “(a) silver vessel(s),” to be parallel to the next hemistich, וּכְלִי־וְזָהָב, “and (a) gold vessel(s).”¹⁵ Cf. כָּל בֵּית הַכּוֹפֵה־הַכּוֹנֶה, “all the house of the burial niche,” that can be emended to כָּל־>בֵּית הַכּוֹפֵה־הַכּוֹנֶה, “the vessels of the burial niche” (see #59, 12:8); and הַכֹּל שֶׁל דָּמַע, “everything is dedicated,” to שֶׁל דָּמַע־> הַכֹּל, “the dedicated vesse<l(s)>” (see #4, 1:19).

The unusual spelling of כָּל־וּכְלִי instead of כָּל־וּכְלִי resembles the phrase (כָּל־ = כָּל) וְאַל יִשָּׂאֵב אֶל כָּל כֵּל, “but let him not draw (water) into any vessel” (CDC 11:1). Schiffman suggests that כָּל may be a variant or the original form of כָּל־ from which the plural כָּלִים evolved.¹⁶ In the Copper Scroll, as well as in CDC כָּל־וּכְלִי or כָּל־וּכְלִי could be defective spelling for כָּל־וּכְלִי or כָּל־וּכְלִי. There are seven cases in the Masoretic Text where in the *ketiv* the *yod* in final position is missing but supplemented by the *qeri*; e.g., יָדָעַתְּ

15 Allegro^{PF}: the different orthography of כָּלִי, “vessels,” may indicate singular and plural. Allegro, 55, 169 n. 306; Allegro^{rev}, 27; Milik, 298, 228 B-6a (כָּל־כֶּסֶף may be a singular construction); Milik^E, 142; Lurie, 125 and n. 5; Pixner, 357; Wolters, 54-55; Garcia Martinez, 463; Beyer, 232; Vermes, 378; Wise, 198.

16 Schiffman refers to Gesenius’ Rule 96 (*The Halakhah at Qumran* [1975], 102 and n. 117). Gesenius says that כָּלִי (in pause כָּלִי, with suffix כָּלִיךָ) is from the root כָּלָה, “to contain,” and that the plural כָּלִים is formed from כָּל, כָּלָה. According to König (ii, 63), it is shortened from *kilyim* (E. Kautzsch, *Gesenius’ Hebrew Grammar* [1910], 286). Ben-Yehuda (3, 2388b n. 1) accepts Olshausen’s suggestion that כָּלִים is from the singular כָּל. Thorion (165) considers כָּל as a misspelling for כָּלִי, rather than a defective form.

(*ketiv*) vs. יָדַעְתִּי (*qeri*), "I know" (Ps. 140:13; Job 42:2). These may be archaic defective spellings.¹⁷ Cf. אָנִי for אֲנִי, "I" (I.O.U. Note from the Bar Kokhba era, line 7); חָכַרְתִּי for חָכַרְתָּ, "I rented" (Murabba'at 24c:6).¹⁸

Since no amount is indicated, the construct noun כָּלִי can be either singular כָּלִי, "a vessel of" (cf. Milik), or plural כָּלִי, "vessels of" (cf. Allegro, Lurie, Pixner). Accordingly, כָּלִי <כֶּסֶף וְזָהָב שֶׁל דָּמַע means, "one dedicated silver vessel and one dedicated gold vessel," while כָּלִי <כֶּסֶף וְזָהָב שֶׁל דָּמַע means "(an undisclosed number of) dedicated silver vessels and (an undisclosed number of) dedicated gold vessels." If כָּלִי is a variant of the singular כָּלִי, then the first reading is preferable. Since there is no indefinite article in Hebrew, it is not necessary to indicate אֶחָד or אַחַת following a singular noun. Cf. אַמָּה, "one cubit" (4:14), שָׁם קָלָל בּוֹ סֵפֶר אֶחָד, "there (is) a *qalal* (vessel), in it (there is) one document" (see #25, 6:4-5); and שָׂדָא אַחַת, "one carrying chair" (12:5; see #1, 1:3).

Earlier the phrase שָׁם בֵּית שֶׁל was discussed as a single unit, where בֵּית is in the construct state (i.e., שָׁם בֵּית שֶׁל שֶׁמ). However, שֶׁמ may be the first word of the next phrase (i.e., שָׁם, "there"); if so, בֵּית is in the absolute state. Moreover, שֶׁל בֵּית can be read as one word, שְׁלִבֵּית, the contracted form of שֶׁל הַבַּיִת, "of the house." Accordingly, שָׁם כָּלִי <כֶּסֶף וְזָהָב שֶׁל דָּמַע could mean, "In/at/by the spring of the house, there are one dedicated silver vessel and one dedicated gold vessel," or "In/at/by the spring of the house, there are (an unspecified amount of) dedicated silver vessels and dedicated gold vessels." Cf. ... בֵּין שְׁנֵי הַבָּתִּין שְׁבַעֲמָק עֶכּוֹן, "Between the two houses which are in the Valley of Achor ... there are two pots full of silver (pieces/shekels)" (see #17, 4:6-8; in both items בֵּית שֶׁמ and שֶׁמ are followed by the description of the cache); and שָׁם קָלָל בּוֹ סֵפֶר אֶחָד, "there (is) a *qalal* (vessel), in it (there is) one document" (see #25, 6:4-5).

While הַמְּבּוּעַ שְׁלִבֵּית, "the spring of the house," does not identify any particular house, based on Mishnaic usage, הַבַּיִת, "the house," may refer to the Temple. Cf. בְּפָנֵי הַבַּיִת וְשֶׁלֹא בְּפָנֵי הַבַּיִת, "in presence of the Temple and not in the presence of the Temple," i.e., whether the Jerusalem Temple exists or not (m. Hul. 8:1). Accordingly, בְּפָנֵי הַמְּבּוּעַ שְׁלִבֵּית could mean, "In/at/by the mouth of the spring of the Temple" (cf. Allegro). It is uncertain whether this spring can be associated with the Golah cistern of the Mishnah (which is mentioned by Allegro as noted above).

(12:6-7) וְכֶסֶף הַכֹּל כְּכֶרֶן שֶׁשׁ מֵאוֹת, "plus a total of six hundred talents of silver" — ALLEGRO^{PT}: "and silver; the whole (being) six hundred talents." AL-

¹⁷ See Gordis, 96-97, 172 nn. 106-108.

¹⁸ See M. Broshi and E. Qimron, "A Hebrew I.O.U. Note from the Second Year of the Bar Kokhba Revolt," *JJS* 45 (1994), 287-90.

LEGRO: “and money, the whole being six hundred talents.” ALLEGRO^{rev}: “and silver, the whole being six hundred talents.”¹⁹ Thus, the silver and gold vessels plus the silver are measured together. MILIK: “and the sum of the silver is six hundred talents,” which is in addition of one silver and one gold vessel of this item; כלי is singular.²⁰ LURIE: “and the (total value of this cache) is six hundred talents of silver.”²¹ PIXNER: “all (in the value of) 600 talents.”²² GARCIA MARTINEZ: “in total: six hundred talents.”²³ BEYER: “And the silver of all (= the total silver mentioned in the Copper Scroll) is six hundred talents (about 12900 kg, it is rounded of and at least 1000 kg less than the total of each item).”²⁴ WOLTERS, VERMES, and WISE agree with Allegro.²⁵

There are problems associated with the phrase in question. (1) וְכֶסֶף, “and silver,”²⁶ seems to be superfluous, unless it is rendered as “and one silver (piece/shekel).” (2) It is unusual to assess silver and gold vessels together, since they have different values. (3) If וְכֶסֶף means that there are in addition to the vessels also one or more silver coins or shekels, again, it is unusual to assess them together. Consequently, the *waw* of וְכֶסֶף must serve to introduce a new phrase where הכל refers only to כֶּסֶף. This would mean that in addition to the unspecified amount of dedicated silver and gold vessels, there are 600 talents of silver. Cf. בּוֹר בַּן [ו] כְּלִין וְכֶסֶף כְּכָרִין שֶׁבַעֲיִן, “in [it] (i.e., in the pit) (there are an unspecified type and an undisclosed number of) vessels, plus seventy talents of silver”; (see #8, 2:5-6), and the alternate translation for כָּל־יֶזְכְּרִי <י> בֵּית הַכּוֹף־וְהַכּוֹף הַכֵּל מִשְׁקָל כְּכָרִין 71 מִנִּין עֲסָרִין, “(a) vesse<l>/vesse<ls> of the house of the burial niche, the total weight (is) 71 talents, (and there are) twenty (unspecified type of) vessels” (see #59, 12:8-9). Regarding כְּכָרִין, see Appendix A.

Finally, regarding the proper interpretation of this item, there are six unresolved issues: (1) whether שמ belongs to the previous or following phrase; (2) whether the reading is של בית or שלבית; (3) whether כל is instead of כלי or not; (4) whether כלי is singular or plural; (5) whether וכסף refers to one silver coin or a lot of silver; (6) whether הכל refers to the vessels and silver or to silver alone. All of these contribute to making it extremely difficult to gain a full understanding of this item.

19 Allegro, 55; Allegro^{rev}, 27.

20 Milik, 298; Milik^E, 142.

21 Lurie, 125 and n. 4. (There are several typographical errors in the translation.)

22 Pixner, 357 (“and silver” is missing; a typographical error).

23 Garcia Martinez, 463 (“and silver” is missing; a typographical error).

24 Beyer, 232.

25 Wolters, 54-55; Vermes, 378; Wise, 198.

26 This word is vocalized in the Masoretic Text as 18 times as וְכֶסֶף (e.g., Gen. 24:35), 11 times as וְכֶסֶף (e.g., Exod. 25:3), and three times as וְכֶסֶף (pausal form), e.g., וְכֶלִי זָהָב, “and gold and silver vessels” (2 Chron. 24:14).

ITEM 59

12:8 בביבא הגדולא של הבוך כל <י> בית הכוך
 12:9 הכל משקל ככרין 71 מנין עסרין

- 12:8 In the large drain of the Bezek, (there are)
 vesse <ls> of the house of the burial niche,
 12:9 a total weight of 71 (unspecified) talents (and) twenty
 (unspecified) minas.

COMMENTARY

(12:8) בביבא ובפיבא הגדולא של הבוך פלופל <י> ופל <י> בית הבית הכוף והפוך "In/at/by the large drain of the Bezek all (of the) house of the burial niche," or "In/at/by the large drain of the Bezek, (there is/are [a]) vesse <l(s)> of the house of the burial niche" — ALLEGRO^{fr}: In the duct of the Great Censer, (are) the vessels of the House of the Censer." ALLEGRO: בביבא הגדולא של הבוך, "In the Great Drain of the Basin: instruments of the House of the Basin." בייב (MH), "pipe gutter, canal, sewer," here is feminine; cf. 7:15, etc. כל כלי is as in 12:6. בוך, "vessel, dish" used for blood (m. Pes. 5:8), entrails (m. Tam. 4:3), and incense (m. Tam. 5:4). הבוך may be a pseudonym for המזבח ("the Altar"), "chosen perhaps for its similarity in sound," while בית הבוך may be "the area immediately surrounding the Altar"; cf. m. Tamid 1:4, 2:1. ALLEGRO^{ev}: "In the Great Drain of the Basin: vessels of the House of the Basin."¹ MILIK: בביבא הגדולא של הבוך כלבית (cursive *rešes*), "In the large gutter of ha-Baruk, (going) toward Bet ha-Baruk." ביבא is the feminine of בייב (MH, A), "drain, gutter, water conduit." בית הברוך, "the House of the Blessed one," is Kaphar Baricha (כפר בריכא, Hebrew ברוך), the modern Bani Na'im. "Blessed" refers to Abraham, and it "may be a popular name of Hebron, anticipating the later Arabic name (Madinat) el-Khalil, the Town of the (God's) Friend." Likewise, הברך refers to כפר בריכא in the Murabba'at inscription (42:3). כלבית (= כל+ל+בית), "near Beth," is like כלפיהם (= כל+ל+פיהם), "near their outlet," 9:12; cf. כלפי (MH), "opposite, against," כלצפון (4QHen^b 1. 8), and כלמדנה צפון (1Q Gen Apoc 21:20).² GREENFIELD: Milik attempts to create new Jewish traditions; Abraham is called אהוב, "beloved," rather than ברוך,

¹ Allegro, 55, 169 nn. 306, 308-11; Allegro^{ev}, 27.

² Milik, 298-99, 233 B-18e; 243 C-60; 255 C-177, 257 C-199, 269 D-35-36, 301, Ad-

“blessed.” The Murabba‘at text has הַכֶּרֶךְ, “the city,” rather than הַבֶּרֶךְ, “the blessed one.”³ LURIE: בְּבִיבָא הַגְּדוּלָּא שֶׁל הַבּוֹךְ כָּל בֵּית חֲנוּךְ, “In the large drain of Beth Hanok (there are hidden) all the censers.” בִּיב is בִּיבָא, which in addition to “drain, pipe,” also means a “movable clay stove,” as בּוּבִיא (A, = בִּיב, b. Shab. 29a). בּוֹךְ is בּוֹיֵךְ, a censor used in the Temple (m. Tamid 4:5; m. Pes. 5:5). בֵּית חֲנוּךְ is an unattested toponym. The scribe in his hurry mixed up the word order.⁴ Apparently Lurie reads as if were שֶׁל בֵּית חֲנוּךְ כָּל הַבּוֹךְ, where בּוֹךְ is a collective noun. However, the text cannot be read as חֲנוּךְ, unless it is emended. The second letter is a *bet/kaf*, rather than *nun*. PIXNER: “At the great drain of Ha-Bazak (on the way) to Beth-Habazak.” בּוֹךְ is identical with Bazak, 2 km. north-east of the fortress Gamla in Wadi Dalyot. Or (following Milik), הַבֶּרֶךְ כְּלִבִּית הַבֶּרֶךְ, “Ha-Barak (on the way) to Beth Ha-Barak.” Tell Barak is a place north of the Yarmuk river.⁵ WOLTERS: בְּבִיבָא הַגְּדוּלָּא שֶׁל הַכּוֹךְ כָּל-בֵּית הַכּוֹךְ, “In the big drain of the crypt: vessels of the crypt chamber.” כּוֹךְ (MH), “tomb, chamber, crypt,” rather than בֶּרֶךְ (as Milik). Elsewhere Allegro reads כּוֹךְ where Milik has בּוֹר (12:3). כּוֹךְ is “sepulchral chamber,” not “burial niche” in contemporary archaeology” (cf. Kutscher).⁶ GARCIA MARTINEZ: “In the large conduit of the burial chamber up to Beth-Hakuk.”⁷ BEYER: בְּבִיבָא הַגְּדוּלָּא שֶׁל הַכֶּרֶךְ כְּלִבִּית הַכֶּרֶךְ, “In the great canal of the fort, near the barrack.” כֶּרֶךְ and כּוֹךְ are indicated as Aramaism.⁸ VERMES: “In the great underground duct of the sepulchral chamber toward the house of the sepulchral chamber.”⁹ WILMOT: הַבֶּרֶךְ כְּלִבִּית הַבֶּרֶךְ, read and restore הַבּוֹר (כל) >בֵּית הַבּוֹר. WISE: “In the big pipe of the cistern, at the point where it joins the cistern.” The last two word, מְלִבִּית הַבּוֹר is the equivalent of מְבִית לַבּוֹר.¹⁰

Alternately the first phrase can also be read as בְּכּוֹכָא וּבְכּוֹכָא הַגְּדוּלָּא, “in/at/by the large burial niche.” כּוֹכָא = כּוֹכָה is an unattested feminine form of the masculine כּוֹכָא וּכּוֹךְ (MH), “burial niche”; it occurs earlier in the Scroll as an alternate reading (see #5, 1:13).

The phrase בְּכּוֹכָא וּבְכּוֹכָא הַגְּדוּלָּא, “in/at/by the large drain,” or בְּכּוֹכָא-הַגְּדוּלָּא, “in/at/by the large burial niche,” indicates that in this place there also existed a smaller drain or burial niche. Regarding בְּכּוֹכָא, a rarely used Mishnaic Hebrew feminine form of כִּיב (masc., MH), see #42, 9:11.

denda to D-35-36; Milik^E, 142, 155.

3 Greenfield, 140a.

4 Lurie, 125 and nn. 1-3 (there are some typographical errors in the translation).

5 Pixner, 357-58 and n. 51.

6 “Vocabulary,” 489, #36 (Kutscher’s study, is mentioned later); “Analysis,” 252; Wolters, 54-55.

7 Garcia Martinez, 463.

8 Beyer, 232-33.

9 Vermes, 378.

10 Wise, 198; “David J. Wilmot and the Copper Scroll,” 21, 25 n. 37.

While the drawings of the fourth and seventh words are not identical, it is possible to read both as: (a) הַבִּינֶה; (b) הַכּוֹף־הַכּוֹף, "the burial niche"; (c) הַבּוֹר or הַבּוֹרֶה for הַבֶּרֶךְ, "the knee"; (d) הַבּוֹר or הַבּוֹרֶה for הַבֶּרֶךְ = הַבְּרוּךְ, "the blessed one" (cf. Milik); (e) הַכּוֹךְ or הַכּוֹךְֶה for הַכֶּרֶךְ, "the city." In the last three cases the *waw* could be an error for a *reš*, a short-headed *reš*, or short-legged final *nun* in a medial position, plus a *nun-reš* interchange (for similar cases in the Scroll, see #38, 9:2). It should be added that בֶּרֶךְ could be an unattested masculine form of בִּרְכָה (fem.), "pool," which also occurs in the Scroll (see #11, 2:13), or it is an archaic spelling where the *he* is missing; cf. וְעַתָּה (*ketiv*) vs. וְעַתָּה (*qeri*), "and now" (Ps. 74:6); שָׁתָה (*ketiv*) vs. שָׁתָה "you place" (Ps. 90:8); etc., in the Masoretic Text.

בִּזְיָה may be a defective spelling of בִּזְיָה, "dish, censer" (MH, m. Tamid 4:3; בִּזְיָה, JA, TO Num. 7:14; cf. Allegro, Lurie), but here it is meaningless. Therefore, בִּיךְ must be a toponym (cf. Pixner's Bazak), perhaps named after the dish בִּזְיָה, or its inhabitants produced such vessels. Or better, בִּיךְ may be a variant of the city בִּזְיָה, Bezek (1 Sam. 11:8) a *kaf-qof* interchange (e.g., כּוֹבֵעַ vs. קוֹבֵעַ, "helmet"; see #41, 9:10). Following Eusebius (Onomasticon 54:8), Bezek has been identified as Khirbat Ibziq, located about twenty miles northeast of Sechem.¹¹

בֵּית הַכּוֹף־הַכּוֹף literally means "house of the burial niche." Several כּוֹכֵין (pl. of כּוֹף־כּוֹף, "niche") were hewn into the walls of a מַעְרָה, a man made "cave." בֵּית הַכּוֹף־הַכּוֹף may mean: (1) The site of burial niches. (2) A room in the cave having several niches. (3) The same as הַכּוֹף־הַכּוֹף. Frequently in Mishnaic Hebrew and Aramaic בֵּית, "house of," is added without changing its meaning; cf. מִנָּס vs. מִנָּס (see #5, 1:13; #7, 2:3). (4) בֵּית הַכּוֹף־הַכּוֹף is a synonym of בֵּית הַקְּבָר, "cemetery"; cf. Syriac גִּמְעָה (בֵּית), "tomb."¹²

The following describes the basic plan of a family tomb, the size of a כּוֹף־כּוֹף, "burial niche," and its relationship to the מַעְרָה, "(burial) cave" (regarding מַעְרָה, see #4, 1:11-12; #7, 2:3).

He who sells a place to his fellow for making a (family) קֶבֶר (grave) ... (the contractor) shall make תּוֹכָהּ שֶׁל מַעְרָה (the inside of the cave) אַרְבַּע אַמּוֹת עַל שֵׁשׁ (four by six cubits), וּפּוֹתֶיהָ לְתוֹכוֹ (and he shall open in it) שְׁמוֹנֶה כּוֹכֵין (eight niches), three from one side and three from the other side, and two opposite them (i.e., of the entrance). And the כּוֹכֵין (niches shall be), their length four cubits, and their height seven (handbreadths), and their width six (handbreadths). ... And (the contractor) shall make חֲצֵר עַל פִּי הַמַּעְרָה (a courtyard at the opening of the cave) שֵׁשׁ בְּשֵׁשׁ (six by six cubits), like the size of the bier and those who bury it. וּפּוֹתֶיהָ לְתוֹכָהּ שְׁתֵּי מַעְרוֹת (and he shall open in it two caves, one at

11 Another (Canaanite) city named Bezek (Judg. 1:4-5) might have been located in the vicinity of Jerusalem. See M. Avi-Yonah, "Bezek," *EJ* 4, 790; SB, 97.

12 Moreover, גִּמְעָה and גִּמְעָה (Tadmuric), גִּיחָה, גִּיחָה (בר), גִּיחָה (בר) of the Talmud, etc., all are related to כּוֹךְ. See, E.Y. Kutscher, "כוֹךְ and its Cognates," *EJ* 8 (1967), 273-79.

this side one at the other side. Rabbi Simeon says, “אַרְבַּע לְאַרְבַּע רוּחוֹתֶיהָ” (four [caves] to its four sides” (m. B.B. 6:8).

(An anonymous Tanna and Rabbi Simeon) used to say: “גֹּבְהָהּ שֶׁל מַעְרָה אַרְבַּע” (the height of a cave is four cubits), and the height of the כּוֹכִין (burial niches) is seven handbreadths plus a handbreadth לְכִיפָהּ (for the dome).” He who makes חָצֵר עַל פִּי הַמַּעְרָה (a courtyard at the opening of the cave), shall make (it) six by six (cubits, which is equal to) the size of a bier on one side and the size of a bier on the other side; וּפּוֹתֵחַ לְתוֹכָהּ שְׁתֵּי מַעְרוֹת (and he shall open in it two caves) (t. B.B. 6:22-23).¹³

The possible reading of the phrase כל בית הכּוֹר can be vocalized and/or interpreted as follows.

כָּל בֵּית הַ—, “the entire house of the niche.” The idiom כָּל בֵּית הַ— is commonly used in Mishnaic Hebrew.¹⁴ E.g., כָּל בֵּית הַגִּיתוֹת תְּפוּסָה אַחַת, “the entire house of the wine presses is one entity” (t. Ter. 3:7).

כָּל בֵּית הַכּוֹר הַכּוֹר = כָּל בֵּית הַכּוֹר הַכּוֹר, “everything (what is) in the house of the burial niche,” i.e., its entire content. Frequently the preposition *bet*, especially in front of בֵּית, is missing; e.g., שִׁבְיַת הַכֶּרֶם = שִׁבְיַת הַכֶּרֶם, “which is in/at/by the Beth-cherem (= the House of the Vineyard)” (see #46, 10:5); שְׁמֹנֶה אַחִים = שְׁמֹנֶה אַחִים, “which is in (the) east of Ahim” (see #33, 8:2).

כָּל בֵּית הַכּוֹר, literally “as to (the) house of the burial niche,” i.e., “near/toward the house of the burial niche.” כָּל בֵּית (cf. Milik) consists of the compound preposition כָּל—, “as/like to,” plus בֵּית, “house of.” Cf. כֶּלְאֲחֵר יָד (MH, JA), literally “as/like to back of hand,” i.e., “in an unusual manner” (e.g., m. Shab. 10:3).

כָּל בֵּית הַכּוֹר, the same as the non-construct states of: (a) כָּל בֵּית, “a vessel of the house of the burial niche”; or (b) כָּל בֵּית הַכּוֹר, “a vessel which is in the house of the burial niche.”

כָּל בֵּית הַכּוֹר, the same as the non-construct states of: (a) כָּל בֵּית, “vessels of the house of the burial niche”; or (b) כָּל בֵּית הַכּוֹר, “vessels which is in the house of the burial niche.”

In the last two options, כָּל is either considered defective (i.e., כָּל, without *yod*), or a variant of כָּל, as in the phrase, כָּסֶף וְכֶלֶאֱחֵר, “(a) dedicated silver vessel(s) and (a) dedicated gold vessel(s)”

¹³ Many of these terms occur in the Scroll.

¹⁴ Biblical Hebrew usually employs אֲתָאֵת, while the Targumim use הַיְתִית, the direct object marker; e.g., וְאֵת כָּל בֵּית כָּלִי, and its Targum, וְאֵת כָּל בֵּית מְנוּחֵי, “and all the house of his implements” (Isa. 39:2); וְאֵת כָּל בֵּית הַגָּדוֹל, and its Targum, וְאֵת כָּל בֵּית הַגָּדוֹל, “and all the great house,” or “and all the house of the great man,” and its Targum, וְאֵת כָּל בְּתֵי רַבְרַבִּיָּא, “and all the houses of the great men” (Jer. 52:13). Regarding the possible meaning of גָּדוֹל as “great man, leader,” cf. כִּי מֶרְדֵּכַי, “For Mordecai the Jew second to King Ahasuerus, and the leader of the Jews” (Esth. 10:3).

(see #58, 12:6-7). It can also be compared to כְּלֵי בֵּית הַדֵּב וְשֵׁל גֵּת (some versions have כְּלֵי שֵׁל בֵּית הַדֵּב וְשֵׁל גֵּת), "the vessels/implements of the oil press and/or (the vessels/implements of the) wine press" (m. Toh. 10:8; see *Hilufei Girsat*, Kehati); other possible reading for this Mishnah is, כְּלֵי בֵּית הַדֵּב וְשֵׁל גֵּת, "a vessel/implement of the oil press or wine press."¹⁵

If the first problem word is read as הַכּוֹר or הַכּוֹךְ for הַכּוֹרֶה, "the city," then the reading would be, בֵּית הַכּוֹרֶה (= הַכּוֹרֶה) כָּל הַבַּיִת, "In/at/by the large drain of the city, (the) content (of the) house of the burial niche"; or כָּל הַכּוֹרֶה (= הַכּוֹרֶה) כָּל הַבַּיִת, "In/at/by the large drain of the city (there are) vesse<ls> of the house of the burial niche."

(12:9) הַכֹּל מִשְׁקַל כִּכָּרִין 71 מָנִין עֶסְרִין, "a total weight of 71 (unspecified) talents (and) twenty (unspecified) minas" — This is the reading of the scholars¹⁶ except LURIE, who suggests that the scribe working in haste mixed up the word order. Lurie renders, "their number is twenty, their weight (together with the silver pieces which are in the vessels) is seventy-one talents."¹⁷ Thus, Lurie rearranges the text as, 71 כִּכָּרִין, הַכֹּל מִשְׁקַל 71 כִּכָּרִין, and assumes that these vessels contain silver.

Regarding the word כִּכָּרִין, ALLEGRO's drawing has כיכרין, *plene* spelling for כִּכָּרִין (see Appendix A). Neither Allegro nor Lurie note this extra *yod*.

In the phrase in question the connective *waw*, "and," is missing but understood. Thus, it means הַכֹּל מִשְׁקַל כִּכָּרִין 71 וּמָנִין עֶסְרִין, "a total weight of 71 (unspecified) talents and twenty (unspecified) minas." There are several such cases in the Scroll (see #32, 7:16).

כָּל־בֵּית הַכּוֹרֶה הַכֹּל מִשְׁקַל כִּכָּרִין 71 מָנִין עֶסְרִין resembles the phrase כָּל־בֵּית הַכּוֹרֶה הַכֹּל מִשְׁקַל כִּכָּרִין שֶׁבַע־עֶשְׂרִי, "a silver carrying chair with its implements, a weight of seventy talents." Both contain the terms כִּכָּרִין, מִשְׁקַל, and כָּל־ (see #1, 1:4). Although "silver" is not specifically mentioned in this item, one may assume that these were silver vessels.

מָנִין (= מִנָּה, pl. of מִנָּה, "mina") appears in the Scroll only here. In the Masoretic Text מִנָּה occurs once, while מִנִּים four times (1 Kgs 10:17; Ezra 2:69; Neh. 7:70-71).

וְהַשֶּׁקֶל עֲשָׂרִים גֵּרָה עֲשָׂרִים שְׁקָלִים חֲמִשָּׁה וְעֶשְׂרִים שְׁקָלִים עֲשָׂרָה וְחֲמִשָּׁה שְׁקָל הַמָּנָה
יְהִי לָכֶם:

15 Neusner translates, "An implement of the olive press and of the winepress" (*The Mishnah — A New Translation* [1988], 1058).

16 Allegro^{PF}; Allegro, 55; Allegro^{rev}, 27; Milik, 298; Milik^E, 142 ("20 minas" is a typographical error for "twenty minas"); Pixner, 357; Wolters, 54-55; Garcia Martinez, 463; Beyer, 232-33; Vermes, 378; Wise, 198.

17 Lurie, 125 (שְׁבַע־מִנִּים instead of the numeral "71" and the missing comma after עֶסְרִים are typographical errors).

And the shekel (shall be) twenty gerahs. Twenty shekels, twenty five shekels, (and) fifteen shekels shall be your mina (Ezek. 45:12).¹⁸

Based on Rabbinic sources, the following explanation can be offered for this difficult verse. The sanctuary (or sacred) weights were double of the common ones; and there were old and new monetary systems. The old sanctuary mina had fifty sanctuary shekels or hundred common shekels. At the time of Ezekiel the measurements were increased by one sixth "from outside" (i.e., one sixth of 60 is 10, and $50 + 10 = 60$). Thus, the new sanctuary mina contained 60 sanctuary or 120 common shekels. The sanctuary weights mentioned in this verse are 20 shekels or one third of the new mina, 15 shekels or one fourth of the new mina, while 25 shekels is half of the old mina. All together are 60 shekels which make a new mina.¹⁹

Two parallel biblical verses and their Targumim support the validity of the above calculations. *וְהָבָה מִנָּהן דְּהָבָא* and *שְׁלֹשָׁת מִנִּים זָהָב*, "three minas of gold" (1 Kgs 10:17), vs. *שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת זָהָב*, "three hundred gold," and *תְּלַת מֵאוֹת* *סֵלָעִין דְּדִהָבָא*, "three hundred sela's of gold" (2 Chron. 9:16). Thus, one can deduce that: (1) Since the text refers to Solomon's Temple, *מִנִּים* must refer to the sanctuary mina. (2) Since *מִנִּים* is rendered as *מִנָּהן*, "minas," the audience for this Targum was familiar with this term. (3) *מִנִּים* is the same as *מֵאוֹת*, "hundreds," and *מִנָּה* as *מֵאוֹה*, "hundred," as in Mishnaic Hebrew (m. Ket. 1:2). (4) If *זָהָב* is mentioned with a number, *סֵלָע* or *שֶׁקֶל* is implied.

In the post-biblical era a *sela*^c had the value of a biblical shekel. Usually the Targumim (as well as Talmudim and Midrashim) render *שֶׁקֶלִים* - *שֶׁקֶל* as *סֵלָעִין* - *סֵלָע*, although their true cognates are *תְּקֵלִין* - *תְּקֵל* (*šin-taw* interchange).²⁰ E.g., the Targum of *אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת שֶׁקֶל כֶּסֶף*, "four hundred silver shekels," is *אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת סֵלָעִין דְּכֶסֶף* (TO, PsJ, Frag., TN), "four hundred silver sela's" (Gen. 23:16).

In the Masoretic Text where shekel is implied but not written, usually the Targumim provide that information. E.g., *עֲשָׂרָה זָהָב מִשְׁקָלָם*, "ten gold (are) their weight" (Gen. 24:22), is *מִתְקֵל עֲשָׂר סֵלָעִין דְּדִהָבָא מִתְקֵלְהוֹן*, "weight of ten sela^c of gold are their weight" (TO); *מִתְקֵל עֲשָׂר סֵלָעִין דְּדִהָבָא סָכּוּם*, "weight of ten sela^c of gold are their total weight" (PsJ); *אַלְף כֶּסֶף*, "one thousand silver" (Gen 20:16), is *אַלְף סֵלָעִין דְּכֶסֶף* (TO, PsJ, Frag.), and *אַלְף דְּסֵלָעִין דְּכֶסֶף* (TN), "one thousand silver sela's." Thus, *וְזָהָב* or *כֶּסֶף* with

18 The first part of this verse simply states that a shekel consists of twenty gerahs. However, the second part is complicated. Rashi explains that the sum of $20 + 25 + 15$ shekels, i.e., 60 shekels is equal to one mina.

19 See the Targum, and Rashi, Radak, *Mešudat Zion* on Ezek. 45:12; and Rashi and Tosaphot on b. Bek. 5a-b.

20 There are exceptions. E.g., the Targum of *וּמִשְׁקַל הַשָּׂרִיּוֹן חֲמֵשָׁת אֲלָפִים שֶׁקֶלִים נְחֹשֶׁת* is *וּמִתְקֵל שָׂרִיּוֹנָא חֲמֵשָׁא אֲלָפִין תְּקֵלִי נְחֹשָׁא*, "and the weight of the coat of mail (was) five thousand shekels of copper" (1 Sam. 17:5).

ITEM 60

12:10 בשית שבינה בצפון כחלת פתחא צפון
 12:11 וקברין על פיה משנא הכתב הזא
 12:12 ופרושה ומשחותיהם ופרוט כל
 12:13 אחד ואח[ד]

- 12:10 In the deep pit which is in Janoah, in the north of
 Kahelet, its entrance is hidden,
 12:11 and graves (are) upon its opening, (there is) a copy of
 this document
 12:12 with its explanation, with their measurements and
 specification for
 12:13 each and ev[ery] (item).

COMMENTARY

(12:10-11) בְּשִׁית־בְּשִׁית שְׁכִינָה־שְׁכִינָהּ בַּצִּפּוֹן כְּחֹלֶת פֶּתַח־צִפּוֹן וְקִבְרִין עַל פִּיהָ, "In/at/by a/the pit which is in (the) Janoah in (the) north of Kahelet, its entrance is hidden/north(ward), and graves (are) upon its opening" — ALLEGRO^{pr}: "In the Shith of the Sanctuary ([or] settlement), in the North, in the hole of the gate to the North, and buried by its mouth" (i.e., בְּשִׁית, "divine presence, royal dwelling" i.e., the sanctuary of the Qumran Temple; the *yod* hardly can be seen, it is a small stroke at the top of the *nun*. Or שכונה, "settlement, group of buildings." Much depends on the meaning of שית (cf. 9:14). כחלת from חלל, cf. Arabic *bahḥalt*, "hole." ALLEGRO^{pr}: "In the pit ([or] foundation) nearby, towards the North, in the hole opening to the North, and buried by its mouth." ALLEGRO: בשית שכינה בצפון בחלה פתחא צפון וקברין על פיה, "In the Pit (*Shith*) adjoining on the north, in a hole opening northwards, and buried at its mouth." *Shith* is the technical term for the pit under the altar (m. Me'ıl. 3:3; m. Mid. 3:2f); cf. the cave beneath the *Sakhra*; etc. קבורין (pass. part. masc. pl.), cf. חפורות (9:2). ALLEGRO^{rev}: "In a pit adjoining on the north, in a hole opening northward, and buried at its mouth."¹ MILIK^{org}: בשית שכנה בצפון בחלה פתחא צפון וקברין על פיה, "In the pit nearby, towards the north in a hole opening toward the north near the graves."² MILIK: בשית

1 Allegro, 55, 169-70 nn. 313-18; Allegro^{rev}, 27.

שבצח בצפון כחלת פתחא צפון וקברין על פיה, "At the tunnel in the Smooth Rock to the north of Kohlit, which opens towards the north and which has tombs at its entrance." שית, cf. m. Mid. 3:3; b. Suk. 53a. צח is preferable to ינח.³ GREENFIELD takes "strong exception" to Milik's interpretation of צח.⁴ LURIE: בשית שכינה בצפון כחלת פתחא צפון וקברין על פיה, "In the nearby pit (or cave) in the north of Kohalit, of which entrance facing north, it is buried ... and in it."⁵ PIXNER: "In the underground passage that is in Şehab (בשית שבצבה) north of Kohlit (צפון כחלת) with its opening to the north and with tombs at its mouth." Probably Şehab is Tell Shihab (with Wadi Shihab), which lies east of the confluence of the three rivers that form the Yarmuk."⁶ WOLTERS: בשית שכנה בצפון כחלת פתחא צפון וקברין על פיה, "In the cavern of the Presence on the north of Kohlit — its opening is north and tombs are at its mouth." Wolters originally followed Pixner's version. He rejects the possible reading of בשית שכנה, "In the cavern of Shebnah."⁷ Wolters renders בשית שכינה as Allegro in his preliminary reading. BEYER: בשית שכינה בצפון כחלת, "In the cavity, which is in Janoh (10 km southeast of Garizim) in the north there is a *kaholet* ('black object') (and) its entrance is in the north and there are graves directly in front of its opening."⁸ WILMOT: for בשית שבצח בצפון read and restore בשית שבצפון. WISE: "In the dry well that is at the north of Kohlit, with an opening on the north and graves by it mouth."⁹ GARCIA MARTINEZ agrees with Pixner, while VERMES follows Milik.¹¹

The first word can be read either as בְּשִׁית־בְּשִׁית, "in a/the deep pit," or בְּשִׁית־בְּשִׁית - בְּשִׁית־בְּשִׁית, "in a/the pit" (see #13, 3:8). The second word consists of the relative and preposition שֶׁ- plus a noun. The Mishnaic Hebrew pattern ... שֶׁ-ב is common in the Scroll; e.g., שֶׁבְּמִלְחָה שֶׁבְּמִלְחָה, ...

2 BA 19 (1956), 63; SVT 4 (1957), 22. Cf. A. Dupont-Sommer, *The Essene Writings From Qumran* (1961), 390-91; S. Roland, Jr., "Dead Sea Scrolls Tell of Treasure," *The New York Times*, June 1, 1956, p. 21, c. 2. It should be noted that originally Milik considered the last item as #62, while in the official edition it is #64.

3 Milik, 298-99, 234 B-19h, 240 C-22 241 C-38, 274 D-71, 275 D-75; Milik^E, 142.

4 Greenfield, 139b.

5 Lurie, 126 and n. 1 (either Lurie renders בשית על פיה as קבור ... ובו, or there is a typographical error).

6 Pixner, 358 and n. 52. Likewise, Pixner identifies Şehab "with Tell Shihab is on the northern slope of the Yarmuk." נחל הגרול (10:3-4) is associated with the Yarmuk River (336, 350 n. 28, 353-54 n. 39, 360). Pixner (336) spells Yarmuk and Yarmok; Şehab and Tel Shihab are typographical errors for Şehab and Tell Shihab, respectively.

7 "Analysis," 252; Wolters, 54-55; "The Last Treasure," 420; "The Shekinah in the Copper Scroll," 382-91.

8 Beyer, 232-33.

9 "David J. Wilmot and the Copper Scroll," 21.

10 Wise, 198.

11 Garcia Martinez, 463; Vermes, 378.

“in a/the deep pit which is in (the) Melah” (3:8); **בְּשׁוֹחַ בְּשִׁיתָּ בְּשִׁיתָּ**, “in a/the pit which is in (the) north of Kahelet” (9:14).

The next symbol is either a ligature of *yod* plus *nun* or a *šade*, followed by a *he/het/taw*, then by a *bet/kaf* that may be the first letter of the third word or the last of the second word. The fourth word is **כַּחֲלֵת**, Kahelet. Accordingly, the third and fourth words can be either **בְּצִפּוֹן כַּחֲלֵת** or **צִפּוֹן כַּחֲלֵת**, “(in/at/by [the]) north of Kahelet.” Regarding **כַּחֲלֵת**, see #4, 1:9; for geographical directions, #4, 1:11; #10, 2:10; #14, 3:11-12; #19, 4:11.

The following are some possible readings, vocalizations, and translations for the first phrase of this item.

בְּשִׁיתָּ בְּשִׁיתָּ שְׁבִינֹחַ שְׁבִינֹחַ בְּצִפּוֹן כַּחֲלֵת, “In/at/by a/the deep pit which is in (the) Janoah in (the) north of Kahelet” — Although rejected by Milik, the second word may well be **שְׁבִינֹחַ**,¹² a defective spelling of **שְׁבִינֹחַ**, “which is in (the) Janoah.” Two cities are named **יְנוֹחַ** in the Masoretic Text, one by border of Ephraim and Menasseh, and one in Asher (i.e., in Galilee).

And the border of (Ephraim’s) inheritance **מִזְרָה** (eastward) was Atroth-addar **עַד בֵּית חוֹרֵן עָלֶיּוֹן** (up to Upper Beth-horon). And **הַגְּבֹל הַיָּמָנִי** (the western border) went out (to) Michmethath on the north, and the border turned eastward to Taanath-shilo, and passed along it **מִמִּזְרָה יְנוֹחַ** (from/to east of Janoah). And (the border) went down from **יְנוֹחַ** (Janoah) to Ataroth and to Naarah, and touched **בִּירְיָחָה** (in Jericho), and went out to the Jordan (Josh. 16:5-7).

In the days of Pekah King of Israel came Tiglath-pileser of Assyria and captured Ijon, and Abel-bath-maacah, and **יְנוֹחַ** (Janoah), and Kedesh, and Hazor, and Gilead and Galilee, the entire land of Naphtali, and deported (its inhabitants) to Assyria (2 Kgs 15:29).

As can be seen, in Joshua the name is spelled as **יְנוֹחַ**, Janohah, yet the Targum renders it **יְנוֹחַ**. The *Pa’ol* (masc.) and *Pe’olah* (fem.) formations are often used with geographical names; e.g., the two cities of **זְנוֹחַ**, Zanoah (Josh. 15:34,56), the mountain and city **תְּבוֹר**, Tabor (Josh. 19:22; see #7, 2:3; #43, 9:14-15). Cf. **נֶטֶפַח**, Netophah (Ezra 2:2; Neh. 7:26), vs. **נָטַף**, Natoph in the Scroll (see #38, 9:1). Most scholars consider **יְנוֹחַ** to be the name of both cities, while some list them as having two distinct names.¹³

The Talmud mentions **אָבָא יוֹסִי בֶן יוֹחָנָן אִישׁ יְנוֹחַ**, “Abba Yose ben Johanan, a native of Janoah” (y. Kil. 2:4 [7a]), the same as **אָבָא יוֹסִי בֶן חָנִין אִישׁ יְנוֹחַ**, “Abba Yose ben Hanin, a native of Yani/Yoni” (t. Kil. 2:1,4).¹⁴ **יְנוֹחַ** may be a Hellenized form of **יְנוֹחַ** (silent *het*). Janoah of Galilee is

12 See Lefkovits^{diss} 2, 925, 927, 929-31. This reading was later used by Beyer.

13 For the first group, e.g., ESh^{con} 2, 882a; for the second, e.g., BDB, 629b. According to Mandelkern (2, 1440d), there was only one **יְנוֹחַ**, and it was located at the border of Menasseh and Ephraim. In addition, some toponyms have two forms; e.g., **יָהָז**, Jahaz, vs. **יָהֲזָה**, Jahzah, both are rendered by the Targum as **יָהָז** (Jer. 48:34 and 48:21, respectively).

14 See Zuckerman’s *Tosephta*, 75, note to lines 3, 15.

the modern Yanoah - Yanuah, while of Ephraim is Khirbet Yanun.¹⁵

Janoah could be located in the Galilee which prior to the destruction of the Second Temple had a dense Jewish population. However, Joshua lists Janoah, Upper Beth-horon, and Jericho together. The Scroll mentions Horon (9:7) and Jericho (5:13), also indicates that Kahelet was near Jericho. Since Janoah in the Scroll is located north of Kahelet, it may well be in Ephraim.

לְהַחֲזִיק בְּשִׁיתֵי הַיָּדָה הַשְּׂמִינִי, "In/at/by a/the deep pit which is in (the) Jonah/Dove in (the) north of Kahelet" — שְׂמִינִי or שְׂמִינִי, defective of שְׂמִינִי or שְׂמִינִי, "which is in (the) Jonah," where יָדָה (fem.) means "dove" (e.g., Gen. 8:8).¹⁶ Also, יָדָה is the name of a prophet (Jon. 1:1), and several Amoraim (e.g., b. Hul. 43b).¹⁷ The Congregation of Israel is compared to the יָדָה (cf. Ps. 56:1 and its Targum; as well as in the various exegeses on Song 1:16). It is conceivable that a place named Jonah existed in Palestine, where perhaps doves were bred primarily for sacrifices.¹⁸

לְהַחֲזִיק בְּשִׁיתֵי הַיָּדָה הַשְּׂמִינִי, "In/at/by a/the deep pit which is in (the) Noah in (the) north of Kahelet" — The *yod* after the *bet* in שְׂמִינִי may represent a Tiberian *šewa'* or *patah*; cf. שְׂמִינִי for שְׂמִינִי and שְׂמִינִי for שְׂמִינִי (see #43, 9:14; #46, 10:5). נֹחַ, Noah, is a personal name (Gen. 5:29). Perhaps there existed such a place in Palestine. This resembles the possible interpretation of שֵׁם בֵּית as Beth Shem or House/City of Shem (Shem was the son of Noah; see #58, 12:6).

לְהַחֲזִיק בְּשִׁיתֵי הַיָּדָה הַשְּׂמִינִי (= שְׂמִינִי הַשְּׂמִינִי), "In/at/by a/the deep pit which is at/by (the) marsh north of Kahelet" — The ligature in the second word is read as a *šade* (cf. Milik). שְׂמִינִי is written with a single *bet*, i.e., שְׂמִינִי or שְׂמִינִי; cf. שְׂמִינִי for שְׂמִינִי, "which is in the house of" in the Scroll (see #46, 10:5). The singular שְׂמִינִי (fem.) occurs twice in the Masoretic Text (Job 8:11, 40:21), and the plural once in the phrase, בְּצִמְצִימוֹ (Ezek. 46:18), "its (masc.) swamps and its (masc.) pools" (Ezek. 46:18).

15 SB, 325a; Y. Aharoni, *Carta's Atlas of the Bible* (1974), 122a, 110 map 172 4 ה and 7 ר, 52 map 71, 94 map 147; "יָדָה" in EB 3, 704; S.E. Loewenstamm, "יָדָה" in EB 3, 704-05; M. Avi-Yonah, "Janoah, Janah," EJ 9, 1277-78; ETGL 1, 19; A. Hyman, *Toledot Tanna'im we'Amoraim* (1910) 2, 728b-29a.

16 The masculine יָדָה occurs both in Talmudic Hebrew and Aramaic; e.g., b. San. 25b.

17 יָדָה could be a variant of יָנָי - יָנִי, Yannai. E.g., Yannai - Jannaus King of Judea (b. Kid. 66a); and name of several Amoraim (e.g., b. Meg. 32a).

18 Cf. "When the days of her (i.e., a new mother's) purification are completed, whether for a son or for a daughter, she shall bring to the priest at the entrance of the tent of meeting a lamb in its first year for a burnt offering, וְגֵן יִנְה אוֹ תֵר לְחֻטָּאת (and a young dove or a turtle dove for a sin offering). ... "But if she cannot afford a sheep, בְּנֵי יִנְה אֶחָד לְעֹלָה וְאֶחָד לְחֻטָּאת (she shall take two turtle doves or two young doves, one for a burnt offering and the other for a sin offering); and the priest shall make atonement on her behalf, and she shall become purified" (Lev. 12:6,8). The Halakhah of the bird offerings can be found in the tractates Zevahim (Sacrifices), Qinnim (Bird-nests), Sheqalim (Shekels), and Hullin (Non-sacred things).

בְּשִׁיתֵיבְשִׁית שְׁבָעָהבִּשְׁבָּעָה צָפוֹן כְּחֶלֶת
in/at/by (the) Şehab (a toponym) north of Kahelet” (cf. Pixner) — The assumed vocalization of צָהָב is like זָהָב, “gold.” זָהָב means “to shine (like gold)”;
וּכְלֵי נְהֹשֶׁת מְצֻבֵּה טוֹבָה שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר מִמֹּדֵת כֶּהָב, “and two fine polished copper vessels, as precious as gold” (Ezra 8:27, *hapax legomenon*); מִפְּנֵי
שֶׁנֶּחֱשָׁתָן מְצֻהֵיב, “because their copper shined as gold” (m. Mid. 2:3). Likewise, the adjective זָהָבִים means “gold colored”; e.g., שְׁעָרֵי צָהָב, “gold hair” (Lev. 13:30,32). צָהָב is related to זָהָב, a *zayin-šade* interchange. Perhaps this assumed place was named after “gold,” or the area had a golden color; cf. the toponym דִּי זָהָב, Di-zahab or “Abounding in Gold,” in the in the Wilderness (Deut. 1:1).²⁰ It can also be compared with גֵּיא נָּהָר, Pure Valley (see #47, 10:9); and with the verse, מִצִּפוֹן זָהָב יָאֵתָה, “Out of the north comes golden pureness” (Job 37:22; see *Mešudat Zion*).

19 בִּץ, "swamp" (Jer. 38:22), is a masculine form of בִּצָּה (fem.; cf. Rashi, Radak, *Mesudat Zion*). In Aramaic is בִּצְאָא (Trg. Job 8:11; Trg. Ezek. 47:11); in Mishnaic Hebrew מִי בִּיצִים means "waters of swamps" (e.g., m. Par. 8:1). בִּצָּה - בִּיצָּה is related of בִּצְעַע (MH, fem., pl. בִּצְעִים; e.g., t. San. 3:4). Rashi renders בִּצָּה, בִּיצָּה, and בִּצְעִים in Old-French as מרשק, *maresc*, which is in French *marais*, *marésage*, "marsh, marshland, swamp, mire" (Greenberg, 68, 163, 207, 278 n. 219; Catane, 102a, 110b, 113b, 116a; Gukovitzki, 69).

21 The נְתִינִים, Nethinim (pl. of נֶתִי, Nethin), were slaves “given” to the Sanctuary to serve the Levites who, in turn, assisted the priests. They lived in בֵּית הַנְּתִינִים, “the House of the Nethinim” in the Ophel, in the eastern fortification of Jerusalem (Neh. 3:26,31, 11:21).

an inscribed silver temple services bowl (5th cent. BCE, unearthed in Tel el-Mahsuta, Egypt). Moreover, it appears as *Ṣi-kha-a* in Akkadian.²²

בְּשִׁית בְּשִׁית שְׁבַצְחוֹ שְׁבַצָּה בְּצִפּוֹן כְּהֶלֶת, "In/at/by a/the deep pit which is at/by (the) Ṣaḥ/Pure/Dry (Place) in (the) north of Kahelet" — The adjective צָח, "pure," is from the root צַחַח, "be dazzling." It is a synonym and variant of יָךְ (adj.), "pure," from the root יָכַךְ, "be bright, clear, pure" (*sade-zayin* and *het-kaf* interchanges); cf. וְכֹהֵן נָזִירֵיהֶם מְשֻׁלָּג צֹחַ מִחֶלֶב, "(Jerusalem's) Nazirites were purer than snow, they were whiter than milk" (Lam. 4:7). Perhaps צַח here is a toponym, Ṣaḥ/Pureness or Pure Place, if so, it can be compared to יָךְ גִּיא, Pure Valley (see #47, 10:8). Moreover, צָח may be related to צָחָה, "parched" (adj.), cf. צָחָה צָמָא, "parched with thirst" (Isa. 5:13); or צַח may be a variant or a shortened form of the noun צָחִית (probably masc.), both from the root צַחַח, "to be dry." E.g., צָחִית סֶלֶע, "smooth/barren rock" (Ezek. 26:4; cf. Milik); בְּצָחִיחִים (*qeri*, בְּצַחֲחִים, *ketiv*), "in the bare areas" (Neh. 4:7); צָחִיָּה (fem.), "dry or desolated land" (Ps. 68:7, its Targum is צָחִיחִין). צַח can be compared to צָחָחוֹת (fem. pl.), "scorched areas" (Isa. 58:11; the singular seems to be צָחָחָה).

If "Ṣiah north of Kahelet" was the living quarter of the clan of Ziha, this suggests that the Nethinim were entrusted with safekeeping of the detailed copy of the Copper Scroll. But, why should a clan of 'obscure origin' be entrusted with the safe keeping of such an valuable document? The Nethinim, like the priests, Levites, and Israelites, were taken into Babylonian captivity. The following facts establish their loyalty to the Temple. (a) They returned to Jerusalem in relative large numbers, while only few Levites did (cf. Ezra 8:15-19). (b) They were among the signatories of the Decree of Nehemiah prohibiting intermarriages with non-Israelites (Neh. 10:29-31). (c) They, like the Kohanim and Levites, were exempt from taxation by the Decree of Artaxerxes (Ezra 7:24). The Nethinim were descendants of the Gibeonites, who deceived Joshua at the time of the conquest of Canaan. Joshua, realizing their trickery but being bound by an oath, enslaved them to the Holy Assembly (Josh. Ch.9). Later King David restored Joshua's decree (b. Yev. 79a). Since Scripture forbids Canaanites to "enter the Congregation of the Lord," the Rabbis viewed the Nethinim as second class citizens. They were forbidden to intermarry with Kohanim, Levites, or Israelites (m. Qid. 4:1; m. Yev. 8:3). Yet there were tendencies to elevate the status of the Nethinim to the level of the Israelites (b. Yev. 79b), and that they will be 'cleansed' in the Messianic age (t. Qid. 5:4). One can hypothesize that the Nethinim allied themselves with the Sadducees (most of them were priests), thus compelling the Pharisees to publicize their obscure origin. It is noteworthy to mention the Ugaritic *spr ynm*, "List of the *ynm*," that enumerates the families of the *ynm* (pl. of *ym*; UT, 204). Levine equates the *ynm* with the Nethinim, and notes that one of the *ynm* families, *bn y hgy*, "sons of *hgy*," had practically the same name as two Nethinim families, בְּנֵי הַגָּבָה, "sons of Hagabah," (Ezra 2:45; Neh. 7:48), and בְּנֵי הַגָּב, "sons of Hagab" (Ezra 2:46), who returned with Zerubbabel to Jerusalem from Babylon. Levine suggests that the Nethinim were an international group of cult personnel "who had attached themselves to the Israelites at an early period" ("The Netinim," *JBL* 82 [1963], 207-12; "Gibeonites and Nethinim," *EJ* 7, 552-54; *UT*, 415-16 [#1169]).

22 S. Ahituv, "צִיחָא, צָחָחָה" in *EB* 6, 708-09.

Synagogue.²⁵ This is similar to the possible readings of שבינח vs. שבצח.

פְּתִיחָא is either variant spelling of פְּתִיחָה, “its (fem.) opening/entrance” (‘alef instead of a [mappig] *he*, third pers. fem. sg. poss. suffix), or פְּתִיחָא = פְּתִיחָה = פְּתִיחוֹ, “its (masc.) opening/entrance” (‘alef instead of a *he*, the archaic spelling for the third pers. masc. sg. poss. suffix; see #13, 3:9; #33, 8:2). In either case, פְּתִיחָא refers to שִׁית, “deep pit,” which seems to be feminine in the Scroll, and it is masculine in Mishnaic Hebrew (see #13, 3:8). Cf. פְּתִיחוֹ, “its (masc.) opening/entrance,” which refers to תֵּל (masc.), “mound, tell” (see #4, 1:11; #25, 6:2-3). Also, בִּיאָה (fem.), “entrance,” a synonym of פְּתִיחָה (masc.), “opening/entrance,” appears in the Scroll, בִּיאָתָא = בִּיאָתָה, “its (fem.) entrance,” or בִּיאָתָא = בִּיאָתָה = בִּיאָתוֹ, as well as בִּיאָתוֹ, “its (masc.) entrance” (see #4, 1-11; #10, 2:12).

צָפוֹן occurs twice in line 12:11, and both can be read as צָפוֹן, as the scholars do. Accordingly, the first establishes that יְנוּחַ is located north of Kahelet, while the second makes known that the deep pit’s opening is to the north. On the other hand, the first צָפוֹן could be read as צָפוֹן, “it is concealed, hidden” (*Qal* pass. part. masc. sg. of the root צָפַן, “to hide, conceal”). This would indicate that the deep pit’s entrance is hidden by the graves. Cf. וְצָפוֹן לְצַדִּיק חֵיל חוּטָא, “and the wealth of the sinner is hidden for the righteous” (Prov. 13:22). The terms צָפוֹן, חֶפְזוֹ (1:7), חֶפְזוֹ (see #12, 3:6), and the alternate חֶבְזָה = חֶבְזָה (1:2, Lurie), are synonyms.

There are similarities between the first half of this item and the phrase בְּבוֹרֵי בְּבוֹר הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁבְּחֶצֶר הַפְּרָסְטִלּוֹן בִּירְכּוֹבֵנוֹר בְּרָקְעוֹ סְתוּם בְּחוֹלְיָהּ בְּחוֹלְיָהּ גִּגְד הַפֶּתַח הָעֵלְיוֹן, “In/at/by the great cistern which is in the court of the Peristyle at/by a/the side/canal of its bottom concealed in the circular-wall opposite the upper entrance” (see # 3, 1:6-8). Both employ the noun פְּתִיחָה, and have passive participles (צָפוֹן, סְתוּם), while בּוֹר and שׁוֹחַטְשׁוּשִׁית are synonyms.

קְבָרִין is the plural of קֶבֶר, “grave” (masc.; see #14, 3:11). עַל פִּיהָ, “upon/at its (fem.) mouth/opening,” refers to the שִׁית (apparently feminine in the Scroll), “deep pit,” like פְּתִיחָא refers to the entrance of the deep pit. Cf. וְגַם עַל פִּיהָ מְקֻלְעוֹת, “and upon its opening there are carvings” (1 Kgs 7:31); כְּוֹרֶת שֶׁהִיא בְּתוֹךְ הַפֶּתַח וּפִיהָ לְחוּץ, “A beehive which is in the midst of the entrance with its opening toward the outside” (m. Oh. 9:1); הָעוֹשֶׂה חֲצֵר עַל, “He who makes a courtyard at the opening of the burial cave” (t. B.B. 6:23). Regarding פֶּה, see #32, 7:14.

(12:11-13) מְשֻׁנָּא הַכֶּתֶב הַזֶּה וּפְרוּשָׁהּ וּמִשְׁחוּתֵיהֶם וּפְרוּט כָּל אֶחָד וְאַחֶד [ד] (there is) a copy of this document with its explanation, with their measurements and specification for each and ev[ery] (item) — ALLEGROP: “(is) a copy of this document, and ‘that set aside,’ and ‘consecrated portions,’ and H[ere]m offerings,” and an inventory of everything, and other[thing(s)]” (i.e., מְשֻׁנָּא

25 S. Wosner, *Še’elot uTešuvot Ševet halLevi* 5 (1982/3), 7a, Siman 8, Par. 2.

[וּאֶחָד] (הַכְּתָב הַזֶּה וּפְרוּשָׁה וּמִשְׁחֻתֵּיהֶם וְחֵן) מִפְּרִיט כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד]. Apparently Allegro reads פְּרוּשָׁה, “separated” (pass. part. fem.). ALLEGRO²⁶: “a copy of this document with explanations, measurements and all details” (cf. Milik’s original version). ALLEGRO: הַכְּתָב הַזֶּה וּפְרוּשָׁה וּמִשְׁחֻתֵּיהֶם מִפְּרִיט כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד], “a copy of this document with an explanation, and their measurements, and an inventory of each thing and oth[er things].” פְּרִיט (pass. part. const. from the root פָּרַט, “to divide, specify”), cf. פִּרְטָא (A), “detailed statement, inventory.” Perhaps the master copy of which the Copper Scroll is only an extract. וּפְרוּשָׁה, “with an explanation,” cf. פִּירוּשׁ (MH), and פְּרוּשָׁה (BH, Esth. 4:7, 10:2). FREEDMAN (in Allegro’s notes): כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד], “each and every thing.”²⁶ MILIK^{orig}: כֹּל [כֹּל] וּפְרוּשָׁה וּמִשְׁחֻתֵּיהֶם וּפְרוּט כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד], “there is a copy of this document with explanations, measurements, and all details.” MILIK: כָּל וּפְרוּשָׁה וּמִשְׁחֻתֵּיהֶם וּפְרוּט כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד], “a copy of this document, with the explanations, measurements and a detailed account of each (treasure)” or “and a detailed inventory.” פְּרוּשָׁה is a feminine formation of the masculine פְּרוּשׁ (“explanation”) like דָּג (Jon. 2:1,11) vs. דָּגָה (Jon. 2:2, “fish”). פְּרוּט, a substantive participle, rather than פְּרִיט. Cf. פִּרְטָא (MH, JA), “specification”; פִּרְטָא - פִּרְטָא (A), “inventory.”²⁷ LURIE: הַכְּתָב הַזֶּה וּפְרוּשָׁה וּמִשְׁחֻתֵּיהֶם מִפְּרִיט כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד], “a copy of this document and in it are the explanations, and the distances concerning each and every one (of the treasures which are hidden in this scroll).” The word “distances” refers to the distances between one cache to the other.²⁸ PIXNER: “the duplicate copy of this document (מִשְׁנָא הַכְּתָב) and their measurements (וּמִשְׁחֻתֵּיהֶם) and details of each and everything (וּפְרוּשָׁה וּפְרוּט כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד).” This seems to be the original document with more details written on perishable leather. Therefore, it was necessarily to make a shorter copy containing just the essentials.²⁹ SHARVIT: מִשְׁחֻתֵּיהֶם (MH), “their measurements”; מִשְׁחָה means “measurement,” while מִשְׁחָה, “measuring rope.” Ben-Hayyim notes that in the Samaritan Aramaic the two forms are interchanged. פְּרוּט (MH), either a noun or a passive participle; cf. פִּרְטָא (BH, noun) and פִּרְטָא (BH, verb); פִּרְטָא (MH,

26 Allegro, 55, 170 nn. 320-23 (פְּרוּט is a typographical error for פְּרִיט); Allegro^{rev}, 27. Wolters points out that D.N.F. at the end of n. 323 are the initials of David Noel Freedman, and that both Allegro and Freedman had the copyright of the first edition (“The Last Treasury,” 428 and n. 38). In addition, n. 278a on p. 165 also bears the initials “(D.N.F.).”

27 BA 19 (1956), 63; SVT 4 (1957), 22 (וּמִשְׁחֻתֵּיהֶם for מִשְׁחֻתֵּיהֶם) [כֹּל] for [כָּל], and [וְאֶחָד] for [וְאֶחָד], are typographical errors; Milik, 298-99, 233 B-18e, 254 C-153-54, 256 C-196-97; Milik^E, 142.

28 Lurie, 126 and n. 4. Apparently, פְּרִיט is rendered as עַל, “upon, concerning,” or the word is not translated (typographical error). There are several typographical errors, the *dalet* of וְאֶחָד should be bracketed; the *mem* is missing from מִשְׁחֻתֵּיהֶם.

29 Pixner, 358 and n. 53 (הַמִּשְׁנָא is a typographical error for מִשְׁנָא).

verb). Allegro reads פריט.³⁰ WOLTERS: משנא הכתב הזא ופרושה ומשחותיהם: [ד] ואח[ד] ופרוטכל אחד ואחד, "a duplicate of this document, and the interpretation, and 'their oils', and the *protokollon* of the one and the other." פרושה refers to the explanation of the Copper Scroll "in the sense of the *interpretative key*," written in "in a kind of code," and the key is in the duplicate which includes the real meaning of the fantastic values and the mysterious Greek letters. משחותיהם means "their portion(s)," "their anointing(s)," "their oils," or "their consecrated priestly portions." "Their" refers to the Aaronic priests. מְשָׁחָה - מְשָׁחָה also means "sacred material" (Lev. 7:35; Num. 18:12-13; Exod. 40:15). ומשחותיהם refers to some specific part of the priestly dues, such as כלי דמע, חרם, mentioned in the Scroll. פרוטכל or פרוטכל[ון] is the Greek *protokollon* ("protocol"), "the first leaf glued to a manuscript" which may contain the content of the document. The protocol of the Copper Scroll is blank. פרוטכל may refer to what is written on the copy but left out from the Copper Scroll, and it might have contained important codes indicating how to retrieve the hidden treasures.³¹ Wolters' פרוטכל resembles the modern Hebrew coinage of פְּרוֹטִי-כָל instead of פְּרוֹטוֹקוֹל from the Greek *protokollon*, "protocol."³² MANDEL (reads as Milik): "A duplicate of this document, and its list (of treasures), their measurements and the amount of each one"; or more likely, "A duplicate of this document: the specification (of each treasure), their measurements and the amount of each one." It depends whether ופרושה belongs to the previous or the next phrase. פרוש in the Hebrew of the Qumran and Tannaic period means "specification, designation, explicit mention." The first letter of ופרושה is a *waw explicativum* (BH); The *he* ending, although it is problematic, must be viewed as a defective spelling of the Aramaic singular pronominal suffix. Mandel refutes Wolters' explanation.³³ GARCIA MARTINEZ: "a copy of this text and its explanation and its measurements and the inventory of everything, item by item."³⁴ BEYER: [ד] ואח[ד] כל ופרוט כל ומשחותיהם ופרושה >ם, "there is a duplicate of this writing, and namely 'their' (= the hidden objects) distribution and their stated distances and the list of every item." כתב is an Aramaism.³⁵ Beyer, apparently based on the next word, emends the

30 "Iyyunim," 130 and n. 26, 133 and n. 51a (there are some typographical errors); "He'arah le'Iyyunim," 150 and nn. 2-4. Sharvit refers to Z. Ben-Hayyim, *The Literary and Oral Tradition of the Hebrew and Aramaic amongst the Samaritans* (1957, in Heb.), 266-67, n. to line 37.

31 "The Last Treasure," 420-24; "Vocabulary," 492-93 and n. 68; "History," 295; "Analysis," 252; Wolters, 54-55.

32 Cf. ESh^{dic} 5, 2143a, 2151b.

33 P. Mandel, "On the 'Duplicate Copy' of the Copper Scroll (3Q15)," *RQ*, 16 (1993), 69-70, 72-76 and nn. 22-36.

34 Garcia Martinez, 463.

35 Beyer, 232-33.

singular possessive suffix into plural. VERMES: “a copy of this writing and its explanation and the measurements and the details of each item.”³⁶ WISE: “a copy of this inventory list, with explanations and measurements and full detail for each and every hidden item.”³⁷

מִשְׁנָה = מְשָׁנָה (BH, MH, masc., const. מְשָׁנָה, from the root שָׁנָה, “to repeat”) has several meanings: לֶחֶם מְשָׁנָה, “double bread” (Exod. 16:22); כֹּהֵן מְשָׁנָה, “second to (the high) priest” (2 Kgs 25:18); מְשָׁנָה הַמֶּלֶךְ, “viceroys of the king” (2 Chron. 28:7); בִּירוּשָׁלַם בְּמִשְׁנָה, “in the second part of Jerusalem” (2 Kgs 22:14; 2 Chron. 34:22); מְשָׁנָה, “copy (of a document)” (Deut. 17:18; Josh. 8:32).³⁸ מְשָׁנָה תוֹרָה refers to Deuteronomy, since before his death Moses repeated the Torah to Israel. E.g., “One does not read (in public) at the (annual) gathering (in Jerusalem) only מְשָׁנָה תוֹרָה (Deuteronomy)” (Sifri, Šofetim 35).³⁹ מְשָׁנָה should not be confused with the feminine מִשְׁנָה, “Mishnah,” from the same root.⁴⁰

כָּתַב (LBH, BA, MH, masc., from the root כָּתַב, “to write”) means “document, writing, letter, character.” E.g., כָּתַב בְּשֵׁם הַמֶּלֶךְ, “for a document which has been written in the name of the king” (Esth. 8:8); כְּכִתְּבֵי סֵפֶר מֹשֶׁה, “according to the Scroll of the book of Moses” (BA, Ezra 6:18); בְּתִבְיֵי הַקֹּדֶשׁ, “the Holy Scriptures” (m. Shab. 16:1); תוֹרָה שֶׁבְּכָתֵב, “the Written Torah and the Oral Torah” (b. Shab. 31a). It also occurs in Ben Sira (45:19). כָּתַב seems to be an Aramaic loanword. כָּתַב occurs earlier in the Scroll, כָּתַב חֶרֶת עַל הָאֶבֶן, “an incised script upon the stone (monument)” (8:4-5); and it is possible to read five times כְּתִבָּן, “their documents,” instead of בְּתִכָּן “in/among them” (see Appendix E). סֵפֶר, “document, book,” a synonym of כָּתַב, appears twice in the Scroll (6:5, 8:3).⁴¹

הַכָּתֵב הַזֶּה is like הַשֵּׁטֶר הַזֶּה, “this bill,” in a Hebrew I.O.U. Note from the Bar Kokhba era (twice, lines 9 and 10).⁴²

In the Masoretic Text פָּרַשׁ, “to explain, declare,” occurs three times in Hebrew, e.g., לְפָרֹשׁ לָהֶם עַל פִּי ה', “that it might be declared to them accord

36 Vermes, 378.

37 Wise, 198.

38 According to M. Tzevat, מִשְׁנָה in Deut. 15:18 and Jer. 16:18 cannot mean “twice as much.” Based on the term *mištanu* which occurs four times in the Alalakh text, Tzevat concludes that “here and there and in the corresponding form from Alalakh it means ‘equivalent, double, *quid pro quo*’” (“Alalakhiana,” *HUCA* 29 [1958], 125-26).

39 Deuteronomy is an Anglicized form of the Latin Deuteronomium, which originates from the Greek Τὸ Δευτερονόμιον, “The Second Law.” It is a translation of תוֹרָה מְשָׁנָה.

40 E.g., שָׁנִי חֲכָמִים בְּלִשׁוֹן הַמִּשְׁנָה, “The sages taught in the language of the Mishnah” (ʿAvot - Qinyan Torah 6:1).

41 מִכְתָּב (e.g., Ezra 1:1) is also a synonym of כָּתַב. A similar term, מִכְתָּב, means “engraving tool”; e.g., הַכָּתֵב וְהַמִּכְתָּב וְהַלּוּחוֹת, “the script, and the engraving tool, and the (two) tables (of the ten commandments)” (m. ʿAvot 5:8).

42 See M. Broshi and Qimron, E., “A Hebrew I.O.U. Note from the Second Year of the Bar Kokhba Revolt,” *JJS* 45 (1994), 287-91.

ing to the Lord" (Lev. 24:12), and once in Aramaic, נִשְׁתַּוְּנָא דִּי שְׁלַחְתּוּן עֲלֵינָא, מְפָרֵשׁ קָרִי קְדָמִי (Ezra 4:18). The Targum of פָּרֵשׁ is אֲתַפְּרֵשׁ (TO, PsJ, Frag., TN). פִּירוּשׁ - פָּרֵשׁ (MH, masc.), "explanation, defined," is an antonym of סִתָּם, "undefined" (cf. סִתָּמוֹ, "concealed," 1:7). E.g., סִתְּמֵן מוֹתֵר וּפְרוּשֵׁן אָסוּר, "those undefined are permissible, but those defined are forbidden" (m. 'A.Z. 1:5). Its Aramaic cognate is פִּירוּשָׁא - פְּרוּשָׁא (e.g., TO Num. 30:7).

כִּבְשָׂה is the same as פֶּשֶׁר (metathesis); cf. כִּבְשָׂה (masc., Lev. 4:32) - כֶּשֶׁב (fem., 2 Sam. 12:3), vs. כֶּשֶׁב (masc., Lev. 3:7) - כִּשְׁבָּה (fem., Lev. 5:6), all mean "lamb, ewe-lamb." The verbal form of פֶּשֶׁר means "to interpret, explain," while its nominal form "interpretation, explanation." E.g.,

But I (Belshazzar) have heard that you (Daniel) are able פִּשְׁרִין לְמַפְּשֵׁר (to provide interpretations) and to resolve problems. Now, if you will be able כְּתָבָא לְמִקְרָא וּפְשִׁירָה (to read the writing and its interpretation) make known to me ... (BA, Dan. 5:16).

In addition, פֶּשֶׁר מִלֵּיא (Eccl. 8:1),⁴³ its Targum, פִּירוּשׁוֹ שֶׁל דָּבָר (t. Ta'an. 2:10), all mean "interpretation of a thing." Likewise, פֶּשְׁרוֹ (possessive of פֶּשֶׁר), "its interpretation" is common in Dead Sea Scroll Hebrew (e.g., Hab. Com. 1:1).⁴⁴

Since מִשְׁנַת הַכֶּתֶב הַזֶּה is masculine, the proper vocalization is וּפְרוּשָׁה = וּפְרוּשׁוֹ, "and its (masc.) explanation," i.e., and the document's explanation. It is the archaic masculine suffix ה־, rather than וּפְרוּשָׁה, "and its (fem.) explanation" (see #13, 3:9). Moreover, the phrase וּפְרוּשָׁה הַזֶּה resembles the following verses.

וְכָתַב לוֹ אֶת מִשְׁנֵה תוֹרָה הַזֹּאת עַל סֵפֶר (and he shall write for himself a copy of this Torah upon a scroll) in front of the Kohanim (and) the Levites (Deut. 17:18).⁴⁵

אֶת מִשְׁנֵה וַיִּכְתֹּב שָׁם עַל הָאֲבָנִים (And there [Joshua] inscribed on the stones) אֶת מִשְׁנֵה תוֹרַת מֹשֶׁה (a copy of the Torah of Moses) אֲשֶׁר כָּתַב לְפָנֵי בְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל (that [Moses] had written for the children of Israel (Josh. 8:32).⁴⁶

In these verses the verbal forms of כָּתַב, "to write," refer to מִשְׁנֵה תוֹרָה, "a copy of the Torah." In the Scroll כָּתַב is a noun, כָּתַב חֶרֶת עַל הָאֲבָן, "(there

43 Ibn-Ezra comments that פֶּשֶׁר is an Aramaic word; Rashi and *Mesudat Zion* refer to its usage in Daniel. Its Hebrew cognate is פֶּתַר (e.g., Gen. 41:15), a *šin-taw* interchange.

44 Regarding פֶּשֶׁר, see F.F. Bruce, "Peshet," *EJ* 13, 331-33.

45 Rashi, based on the Talmud (b. San. 21b-22a), comments that a king must write two copies of the Torah, one for his own use, and the other to be deposited in his treasury; i.e., מִשְׁנֵה means "two"; cf. Rashbam on this verse.

46 מִשְׁנֵה תוֹרַת מֹשֶׁה is explained as "the commandments" (Sa'adiah Ga'on quoted by Radak); "the language of the Torah and its explanation upon the general rule" (Radak); "the whole Torah" (Ralbag); "Deuteronomy" (*Mesudat David*).

is) an incised script upon the stone (monument)” (8:4-5). Cf. **כְּתַב אוֹת אַחַת** **כְּתַב** **אוֹת אַחַת**, “one wrote a character next to the writing; one wrote upon the writing” (m. Shab. 12:5). Furthermore,

King (Belshazzar) spoke and said to the sages of Babylon, “Whoever shall read **כְּתַבָּה דְּנָה וּפְשָׁרָה** (this script and its interpretation) and tell me, shall wear royal purple with a chain of gold on his neck, and shall rule over one third of the kingdom. Then all the king’s sages came in, but they could not **לְמַקְרֹא** **כְּתַבָּה** **לְמַקְרֹא** (read the script and its interpretation) tell to the king (Dan. 5:7-8).⁴⁷

הַכְּתָב הַזֶּה וּפְרוּשׁוֹ can be translated into Hebrew as **הַכְּתָב הַזֶּה וּפְרוּשׁוֹ**, exactly as **הַכְּתָב הַזֶּה וּפְרוּשׁוֹ** of the Scroll.⁴⁸

The following are additional possible vocalizations and explanations for the word and/or phrase in question.

מִשְׁנָא הַכְּתָב הַזֶּה וּפְרוּשָׁה, “(there is) a copy of this document and/with an exact account” — **וּפְרוּשָׁה**, the second *waw* may represent a Tiberian *qamas*; cf. **הַבְּאוֹת** for **הַבְּאוֹת** (see #1, 1:2). **פְּרֻשָּׁה** (fem., from the root **פרש**), appears twice in the Masoretic Text: **וְנָתַתְּ פְּרֻשַׁת הַכֶּסֶף**, “and the exact sum of the money,” and **וּפְרֻשַׁת גְּדֻלַּת מְרֹדַכַּי**, “and the complete account of the greatness of Mordecai” (Esth. 4:7 and 10:2, respectively); cf. Allegro’s note.

מִשְׁנָא הַכְּתָב הַזֶּה וּפְרוּשָׁה, “(there is) a copy of this document and it is explained” — **פְּרוּשָׁה** means “it is explained” (*Qal* pass. part. fem. sg. of the root **פרש**, “to explain”).

מִשְׁנָא הַכְּתָב הַזֶּה וּפְרוּשָׁה, “(there is) a copy of this document and it is separated” — **פְּרוּשָׁה** means “it is separated” (*Qal* pass. part. fem. sg. of the root **פרש**, “to separate”). Regarding this item, the last two suggestions seem to be irrelevant. Also, one would expect the masculine **פְּרוּשׁ**, like **סְתוּמָה**, **חֲפֹר**, **חֲפֹר**, **חֲפֹר** in the Scroll, since it must refer to masculine **הַכְּתָב הַזֶּה** **חֲפֹר**, **חֲפֹר** in the Scroll, since it must refer to masculine **הַכְּתָב הַזֶּה**.

וּמִשְׁחֻתֵּיהֶם and **וּמִשְׁחֻתֵּיהֶם**, “and their measurements” (both vocalizations are possible) — There is a lacuna almost at the end of this word, but part of the right side of the *he* and most of the left side of the *mem* can be recognized. Although this reading is almost certain, another suggestion will be discussed later. Logically, “and their measurements” refers to those hidden objects where no (or limited) information about measurements are given in the Scroll, but can be found in its detailed copy.

וּמִשְׁחֻתוֹ and **וּמִשְׁחֻתוֹ**, “and/with its (masc.) measurements,” are possible

47 The *’alef* in the *ketiv* is instead of a *mappiq he*, for similar cases in the Scroll, see #13, 3:9. It can also be vocalized as **וּפְשָׁרָה**, “and the interpretation” make known to the king.

48 **כְּתַבָּה דְּנָה וּפְשָׁרָה** does not occur in the Masoretic Text, but the Aramaic **כְּתַבָּה דְּנָה וּפְשָׁרָה** appears in additional two cases (Dan. 5:15,24), as well as **כְּתַבָּה דְּנָה** (Dan. 5:25). Moreover, the usual Targum of **מִכְתָּב** (a synonym of **כְּתָב**), is **כְּתָב** - **כְּתָבָה** (e.g., Exod. 32:16, TO, PsJ; Isa. 38:9).

readings for the first seven letters (the rest will be discussed later). These defective spellings can be compared with תַּחְתּוֹ, "below it (masc.)," and מְשׁוּלוֹ ... שְׁבָשׁוּלוֹ, "which is a the lower part of ... from its base," in the Scroll (see #25, 6:5; #38, 9:1), as well as the form and spellings of לְמִשְׁפַּחְתּוֹ and לְמִשְׁפַּחְתּוֹ, "for his (masc.) families" (Num. 11:10 and 2:34, respectively). The expression "and/with its (masc.) measurements" must refer to מִשְׁנָא הַזֶּה הַכֶּתֶב (masc.), "the copy of this document," i.e., the copy contains the (exact) measurements of the listed caches.

Both feminine nouns מִשְׁחָה and מִשְׁחָה are derived from מִשַּׁח, a fusion of two roots: מִשַּׁח, "to anoint," and מָשַׁח, "to measure"; both can be found in Hebrew (BH, MH), Aramaic, Arabic, and Akkadian. In the Masoretic Text מִשְׁחָה twenty-one times means "anointment" (e.g., Exod. 25:6), while twice "measurement, portion, size." on the other hand, מִשְׁחָה occurs only three times, once it is a (feminine) infinitive form (לְמִשְׁחָה בָהֶם), "to anoint with them," Exod. 29:29), and twice is a noun, which like מִשְׁחָה can mean either "anointment" or "(anointed or priestly) portion."

וּמִשְׁחַת בְּנָיו (This is the [priestly] portion of Aaron) וְזֹאת מִשְׁחַת אֶהְרֹן (and the portion of his sons) from the fire-offerings of the Lord" (Lev. 7:35).⁴⁹

The Lord spoke to Aaron: And I, behold, I have given you אֶת מִשְׁמַרְתִּי תְרוּמָתִי (the safeguard for My elevated gifts), לְכֹל קֹדֶשִׁי בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל (of all the holy gifts of the Israelites) I have given them to you לְמִשְׁחָה (as a [priestly] portion), as well as to your sons for an everlasting ordinance" (Num. 18:8).

וּמִשְׁחַת אֶת אֲבִיהֶם (And you [Moses] shall anoint them, as you anointed their father), and they will minister Me. וְהָיְתָה לָהֶם מִשְׁחָתָם (And it will be that their [anointed] portion shall be theirs) due to an everlasting priesthood for all their generations (Exod. 40:15).⁵⁰

In Aramaic מִשְׁחָה means "size, measure"; e.g., the Targum of מִדָּה אֶחָת is

49 The rendering מִשְׁחָה as "portion" follows Sa'adiah Ga'on's translation (J. Kapah, *Peruṣei Rabbeinu Sa'adiah Ga'on 'al haTorah* [1984], 112); see also Yehoash's *Notes on the Bible* (1949), 29; SB, 512b; Harkavy, 422b-23a; BY 4, 3366b; ESh^{con} 2, 1335a; ESh^{dic} 4, 1552b; etc. מִשְׁחָה in this verse has been rendered as: "consecrated portion" (BDB [603], JPSⁱ); "perquisites" (and noted that literally "'anointment,' i.e., occurring from anointment," JPSⁱⁱ); "portion of the anointing" (Koren); "[portion] ... were anointed" (Kaplan); "[anointment] portion" (*Tanakh*); etc. These reflect the comments of Rashbam and Ibn-Ezra, that Aaron and his sons received these portions as a reward for their anointment.

50 Most translators render מִשְׁחָה as "anointing." In Numbers some render as "portion"; e.g., "consecrated portion" (BDB, 603b, noting "possible error of pointing"); "appointed portion" (Harkavy, 422b); "consecrated portion" (JPSⁱ); "perquisite" (JPSⁱⁱ); "portion" (Yehoash; BY 4, 3366b), etc. On the other hand, a few lexicographers render in Exod. 40:15 and in Numbers as "portion" (e.g., SB, 512b-13a; ESh^{con} 2, 1335a; ESh^{dic} 4, 1552b). See also the previous note. The usual Targum of מִשְׁחָה and מִשְׁחָה are רְבוּת, רְבוּתָא, רְבוּתָא (fem.), which is rendered by Jastrow (1440) as "greatness, dignity, office, anointment." This is in line with the traditional Torah commentators.

מִשְׁחָא קֶדָּא, “one size” (1 Kgs 6:25). The Mishnaic Hebrew מְשִׁיחָה (fem.), “(measuring) rope” (e.g., m. Kel. 21:3), מְשׁוּחַ (masc.), “surveyor” (pl. מְשׁוּחוֹת, m. Kel. 14:3), as well as מִשַּׁח, “to measure” (TH, e.g., y. Kil. 6:1 [23a]), may be Aramaic loanwords. מִשַּׁח, “measure!” or “a measure, distance” (masc.), appears twice in the Scroll (see #29, 7:6; #38, 9:1).

Probably the homonyms of מִשַּׁח have identical forms. The suggested possible vocalizations can be compared with similar cases in the Masoretic Text.

מְשִׁחָה has the same nominal pattern (פִּלְעָה) as מִנְחָה (fem., BH, MH, A), “present, tribute, grain-offering” (213 times in the MT; from the root מנח, which is in Arabic means “to lend, give a gift”);⁵¹ and שִׁפְחָה (fem.), “concubine” (63 times in the MT; from the root שפח, “to bind, attach”). These can also be compared with the noun מְשִׁפְחָה (fem.), “family” (303 times in the MT; also from the root שפח).⁵²

וּמִשְׁחֹתֵיהֶם consists of the connective ו-, מִשְׁחֹת (pl. const.), and -יהם (pl. third pers. masc. poss. suffix); while מִשְׁחֹתַי consists of ו-, מִשְׁחֹת, and -י (sg. third pers. masc. poss. suffix). Since the usage of -יהם is like -יכם (pl. second pers. masc. poss. suffix), וּמִשְׁחֹתֵיהֶם resembles וּמִנְחֹתֵיכֶם, “and your (masc. pl.) grain-offerings” (Amos 5:22), שִׁפְחֹתֵיכֶם, “your (masc. pl.) concubines” (1 Sam. 8:16), בְּמִשְׁפְּחוֹתֵיהֶם, “for their (masc.) families” (1 Chron. 6:45).⁵³ Also cf. לְפִיהֶם, “at their (masc.) orifice” (see #42, 9:12). וּמִשְׁחֹתַי can be compared with the word מִשְׁפְּחוֹתַי, “his families” (Num 2:34).

51 BDB, 585a. On the other hand, מנח may be related to the roots נוח - נחה, “to rest” (cf. BY 5, 3094a nn. 1-2), and even to מנה, “to count, assign” (cf. SB, 475b).

52 Based on the same patterns, the forms are: מִשְׁחָה - מִנְחָה - שִׁפְחָה - מִשְׁפְּחָה (sg.), מִשְׁחָת - מִנְחָת - שִׁפְחָת - מִשְׁפְּחָת (sg. const.), מִשְׁחֹת - מִנְחֹת - שִׁפְחֹת - מִשְׁפְּחֹת (pl.), מִשְׁחֹת - מִנְחֹת - שִׁפְחֹת - מִשְׁפְּחֹת (pl. const.).

53 In addition, there is a shortened form of the masculine plural third person possessive suffix, -ם; e.g., בְּמִשְׁפְּחוֹתָם, “in their families” (1 Chron. 4:38). Accordingly, the shortened form of the word under discussion is וּמִשְׁחֹתָם. Both forms are used in the Hebrew Masoretic Text (see ³Avi-⁴Ezer on Gen. 35:20), in the Dead Sea Scrolls (often with an extra *he* at the end; see, E. Qimron, *The Hebrew of the Dead Sea Scrolls* [1986], 62-62). The usual masculine forms are as follows. Mishnaic Hebrew: -הם, -יהם, -הן, and -יהן; e.g., מִנְחֹתֵיהֶן, “their grain-offerings” (m. Sot. 3:6). Biblical Aramaic: -הם, -הון; e.g., שְׁמֵהֶם, “their name” (Ezra 5:10); וּמִנְחֹתֵהוֹן וְנִסְכֵּיהוֹן, “and their grain-offerings and their libations” (Ezra 7:17). Targumim: -הון and -יהון; e.g., וּמִנְחֹתֵהוֹן וְנִסְכֵּיהוֹן, “and their grain-offerings and their libations” (TO, Num. 29:18). One can argue that usage of the Hebrew long form was influenced by Aramaic. On the other hand, some grammarians distinguish between these forms, claiming that meanings in the third person masculine forms are: מִשְׁפְּחָתוֹ, “his family,” i.e., one man has one family (e.g., Lev. 25:10); מִשְׁפְּחָתָם, “their family,” i.e., several men have together one family (e.g., 1 Chron. 4:27); מִשְׁפְּחוֹתַי, “his families,” i.e., one man has several families (Num. 2:34); מִשְׁפְּחוֹתָם, “their families,” i.e., each of several men has one family (e.g., Num. 1:18); מִשְׁפְּחוֹתֵיהֶם, “their families,” i.e., each of several men has several families (e.g., 1 Chron. 6:45). See S. Hannau, *Binyan Šelomoh* (1708), 46a-46b, who is referring to E. Levita’s *Sefer habBahur* (*Ma’amar* 3, *Iqqar* 12, *Siman* 3), and other Talmudic sources.

מִשְׁחָה has the same nominal pattern (פִּלְעָה, the first *qamaš* is short) as חֶכְמָה (fem.), "wisdom" (153 times in Hebrew and 8 times in Aramaic in the MT; from the root חכם, "to be wise"), and חֲרָבָה (fem.), "desolation, ruin" (41 times in the MT; from the root חרב, "to dry, desolate").⁵⁴

וּמִשְׁחָתוֹתֵיהֶם consists of וּמִשְׁחָתוֹתֵיהֶם, while וּמִשְׁחָתוֹתַי of וּמִשְׁחָתוֹתַי. Similar forms are: מִחֲרָבוֹתֵיהֶם, "from their ruins" (Ps. 109:10), and חֲרָבָתִי, "its (masc.) ruins" (Ezra 9:9).

וְ[ש]מ = וְ[ש]מ, "and [the]re" — Since enough room remains for a *šin* between the corrected fragments before and after the lacuna, וְ[ש]מ is a reasonable restoration. The almost *dalet/reš* shaped letter fragment in front of the lacuna can be read as a long-headed *waw*; cf. מִשְׁרָלוּ ... שְׁבִשְׁרָלוּ for מִשְׁוֹלוּ ... שְׁבִשְׁוֹלוּ, "which is a the lower part of ... from its base" (see #38, 9:1). וְ[ש]מ, "and [the]re," starts a new phrase. שָׁם, "there," occurs in additional two or three times in the Scroll (see #17, 4:8).

The next word can be read as פָּרוּט, וּפְרוּט, וּפְרוּט, and פְּרוּט. The root פֶּרַט (MH), "to chose, explain, separate," is related to פָּרַד (BH, MH), "to separate, explain" (*dalet-tet* interchange; cf. יָרַד [BH, MH] - יָרַט [BH], "to descend"), as well as to פָּרַשׁ, "to explain, separate" (*tet-šin* interchange; cf. חָרַט - חָרַשׁ, "to engrave, cut"; see #34, 8:4).⁵⁵

פָּרוּט (*Pa'ul*) and פְּרוּט (A, *Pe'il*; both *Qal* pass. part. masc. sg.) means "detailed, explained, separated." The plural masculine פְּרוּטוֹת is found in the *Piyyut*, הַפְּרוּטוֹת אֲצוּרוֹת, "the detailed ones are hidden," i.e., some commandments are detailed in Scripture, but remain mysterious (such as the red heifer; *Silluq* of Parašat Parah by Rabbi E. Kallir). Cf. פְּרוּטָה (MH, *Pe'ulah*, fem.; e.g., m. Qid. 1:1) and פְּרוּטָא (JA, *Pe'ilah*; e.g., b. B.B. 166a), "small coin"; also the passive forms in the Scroll: חֲבוּאָה, "hidden" (1:2, alt.), חָפוּר, "hidden, buried" (4:7, etc.), סְתוּמָה, "concealed" (1:7), צָפוּן, "hidden" (in this item), חָפְצָה or חָפְצָה, "pool" (5:6, 11:12), חֲרוּבָה or חֲרָבָה, "ruin" (1:1), חֲרוּצָה or חֲרִיצָה, "ditch" (5:8), etc. Moreover, the related פָּרוּד (BH, MH) means "separated"; e.g., וּכְנַפֵּיהֶם פָּרוּדוֹת מִלְמַעְלָה, "and their wings are separated above" (Ezek. 1:11); וְנִמְצָא עַל גִּב פְּרוּדִים, "it is found above separated pieces" (m. Toh. 9:9). Regarding the *Pa'ul* - *Pe'ulah*, and *Pe'il* - *Pe'ilah* forms, see #1, 1:1.

⁵⁴ Based on the same patterns, the forms are: חֲרָבָה - חֶכְמָה - מִשְׁחָה (sg.), חֲרָבוֹת - חֶכְמוֹת - מִשְׁחָתוֹת (pl. const.), חֲרָבוֹת - חֶכְמוֹת - מִשְׁחָתוֹת (pl. const.).

⁵⁵ In the verse חֲרָבוֹת - חֶכְמוֹת - מִשְׁחָתוֹת, "Those who are playing with the flute" (Amos 6:5; cf. Targum), חֲרָבוֹת seems to be from a different root (cf. BY 6, 5162-64; 5162a, n. 6; ESh^{dic} 5, 2150-51). However, Rashi, Radak, *Mešudat David*, *Mešudat Zion*, Malbim (on Amos 6:5); Ibn-Ezra and Malbim (on Lev. 19:10), consider it to be from the same root. In addition, פָּרַט (masc.) is an "individual grape fallen to the ground at the time of the harvest" (Lev. 19:10; cf. m. Pe'ah 7:3). Actually, פֶּרַט belongs to the large root-family פָּרַא, פָּרַד, פָּרַשׁ, פָּרַשׁ, פָּרַט, פָּרַח, פָּרוּ, פָּרַה, פָּרַה (perhaps from bilateral root פָּר), all connote "separating, breaking," etc. (cf. SB, 697-703).

יְפָרוֹט (*Qal*), יִפְרִיט = יִפְרֹט (*plene, Nif'al*), and יִפְרִיט (*Hif'il*, all imperf. third pers. sg. masc.) mean “it (masc.) will be detailed/explained/specified” or “it (masc.) is detailed/explained/specified.” E.g., פּוֹרֵט וְאוֹכֵל, “he separates (a fig) and may eat (it)” (m. Ma'as. 2:6; see Bertinoro; cf. Sifra on Lev. 19:10; *Qal*); הוֹאִיל וְנֶאֱמְרוּ שְׁבוּעוֹת בְּתוֹרָה סֵתָם וּפְרֹט אַחַת מֵהֶם, “although swearing is stated undefined in the Torah, but one of them is explained” (Sifri Naso' 8; *Qal*); בָּאִים כָּל מַעֲשָׂיו וְנִפְרָטִים לִפְנָיו, “his deeds are coming (by themselves) and are detailed in front of him (against his will)” (Sifri Ha'azinu 133; *Nif'al*); עַד שִׁפְרוֹשׁ לָךְ הַכְּתוּב and עַד שִׁפְרוֹט לָךְ הַכְּתוּב, “unless Scripture explicitly states” (Mekhila' Mišpatim Neziqin 5 and Sifri Num. 24, respectively). Also, וּמִשָּׁם יִפְרָד, “and from there it (masc.) separates” (Gen. 2:10; *Nif'al*); וּבִן עֲצוּמִים יִפְרִיד, “and he selects between the mighty ones” (Prov. 18:18; *Hif'il*); וּכְצִפְעֵנִי יִפְרֹשׁ, “and like a serpent extricates (its venom)” (Prov. 23:32; *Hif'il*).⁵⁶

וּפְרִיט, “and it is explained/specified/separated,” where the second *šere* is indicated by a *yod*. פִּרֵּט = פִּרֹּט = פִּרֵּט is like פִּרֵּשׁ - פִּרֹּשׁ - פִּרֵּשׁ (*Pi'el*, perf. sg. third pers. masc.), “it is separated, specified, explained, defined, etc.”; e.g., פִּרֵּשׁ בְּחֻנָּה ... פִּרֵּשׁ בְּדִנְיָאֵל, “it is explained in (in prayer of) Daniel ... it is explained in (prayer of) Hanna” (t. Ber. 3:6). Also, ... טְלִית מַכָּאן וּמַכָּאן, “a garment ... when it is separated from here and there” (t. Kel. B.B. 5:10; *Pi'el* act. part. masc. sg.); a variant reading is בְּמִפְרֹשׁ with a *šin*.⁵⁷

וּפְרֹט, the *waw* may represent a long Tiberian *qamaṣ*, i.e., וּפְרֹט; cf. הַבּוֹאֵת for הַבָּאוֹת (see #1, 1:2). פִּרֵּט (MH, masc.) means “specification, explicit statement.” E.g., “Rabbi Ishmael says, ‘(In the Torah ... if the sequence is) כָּלֵל וּפְרֵט וּכָלֵל (generalization and specification and generalization), you must rule according to הַפְּרֵט (the specification)’” (Sifra Petiḥa); מִהַּ הַפְּרֵט, “as the explicit is explained as animals, so (is the case with) all animals” (b. B.Q. 54b; referring to Deut. 5:14). In addition, the Aramaic פִּרְטָא (masc.) and פִּרְטָאָא - פִּרְטָאָא (fem.) mean “detailed statement, inventory” (as mentioned by Milik and Allegro). E.g., “Nebuzaradan ... sent שְׁטַר פִּרְטָאָא (a document of inventory) to his home” (b. Giṭ. 57b; cf. b. San. 96b).

The restoration of [וְאֵת] in the phrase כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד, “each and ev[ery] (one),” is essentially certain; cf. כָּל חֵד וְחֵד (m. Ber. 6:6); כָּל חֵד וְחֵד (TA, b. Men 38b). The idiom ... כָּל ... וְ, “each and every,” is common in Late

⁵⁶ יִפְרִיט (*Hif'il*) occurs in Middle Age Hebrew (cf. BY 6, 5164b; ESh^{dic} 5, 2151a). Since two closely related roots, פִּרַד and פִּרֵשׁ, have *Qal* (פִּרַד - פִּרֵשׁ), *Nif'al* (נִפְרַד - נִפְרֵשׁ), and *Hif'il* (הִפְרַד - הִפְרֵשׁ) forms, the occurrence of הִפְרִיט in the Scroll is plausible.

⁵⁷ See Zuckerman, *Tosephta*, 595 and n. to line 24; also Jastrow, 1224b, 1230a (there is no evident reason for Jastrow's suggested reading of בְּמִפְרֹם, “when it is torn,” from the root פִּרַם, “to tear open”).

Biblical Hebrew and in the Targumim. E.g., **וּבְכָל מְדִינָה וּמְדִינָה וּבְכָל עִיר**, its First Targum, **וּבְכָל פִּילְכָה וּפִלְכָה וּבְכָל קְרָא וְקְרָא**, and Second Targum, **וּבְכָל מְדִינָתָא וּמְדִינָתָא וּבְכָל קִירִיתָא וְקִירִיתָא**, “and in each and every province and in each and every city” (Esth. 8:17).⁵⁸ It should be added that Milik’s original reading of **[כּוּל]** (*plene*) is as good as **כָּל** – **כָּל** (defective), since usually the *plene* form is found in the Dead Sea Scrolls.

Based on the aforementioned discussion, the last phrase of the Scroll can be read, vocalized, and translated as follows.

וּפְרִיט כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד [ד], “and it is explained/specified/separated each and eve[ry] one.”

וּפְרִיט כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד [ד], “and it is explained/specified/separated each and eve[ry] one.”

וּפְרִיט כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד [ד], “and it is explained/specified/separated each and eve[ry] one”; i.e., and in the copy of the Scroll each item is explained.

וּפְרִיט כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד [ד], “and the specification of each and eve[ry] (item),” i.e., the copy of the Scroll contains specifications for each item.

וּפְרִיט כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד [ד], “and [the]re it will be (or it is) detailed/-explained/specified each and every one.”

וּפְרִיט כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד [ד], “and [the]re it will be (or it is) detailed/-explained/specified each and every one.”

וּפְרִיט כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד [ד], “and [the]re it will be (or it is) detailed/-explained/specified each and every one”; i.e., and in the copy of the Scroll each item is detailed (or explained, specified).

Finally, all these suggested readings resemble the phrase **וְהַדְּבָרִים עֲתִיקִים** וְהַדְּבָרִים עֲתִיקִים, “and (these are) ancient sources, and each and every one is explained in its (proper) place” (Sifri Num. 78; cf. Sifri Zuta ad loc.; 1 Chron. 4:22; b. B.B. 91b).

58 The idiom ... כל has been discussed by various scholars; e.g., S. Gewirtz, “Of Syntax and Style in the ‘Late Biblical Hebrew’ — ‘Old Canaanite’ Connection,” *JANES* 18 (1986), 25-29.

DISCUSSION

THE COPPER SCROLL AND THE DEAD SEA SCROLLS

The discovery of the Dead Sea Scrolls have raised several important questions, such as: Who were the Qumranites who lived near the Qumran caves? Did they belong to the Essenes? Were some or all the Dead Sea Scrolls written by the Qumranites? Did all sectarian documents originate from the same source? How could a small community produce such a large library? Why would the Jerusalem priesthood tolerate a sectarian community living nearby that opposed its leadership? Who owned the Qumran caves? Definitive answers to these challenging questions cannot be given, but analysis of the historical setting provides a basis for offering meaningful hypotheses.

Most scholars refer to the Qumranites as being Essenes,¹ yet one cannot be sure of the accuracy of this claim. Certainly, the biblical texts of Qumran were not created by the Qumranites, although they may have amended them.

The sectarian texts seem to originate from various groups that may include the Essenes. Many of them were composed by opponents of the Jerusalem priestly leadership. Therefore, it is preferable to call the composers of the Dead Sea Scrolls *sectarians of Qumran*, although they may not have had any connection with the contemporary residents of the Qumran area.

The caves in the area between the Dead Sea and Jerusalem, including those at Qumran, might have been controlled by the Jerusalem priesthood and used as repositories (*genizot*, sg. *genizah*) for no longer useful, damaged, or uncanonical Scriptures and religious objects (such as *Tefillin*, *Mezuzot*), documents, as well as sectarian writings. About one-third of the Dead Sea Scrolls are of sectarian origin, and almost a third are various biblical texts² which deviate from the Masoretic Text (the latter was accepted by the Tannaim, the successors to Pharisees). Since most of these contain the name of God, it would have been blasphemous either to keep or to destroy such writings, thus they had to be committed into a *genizah*. This may indicate why no definitive Pharisaic or Sadducean texts were uncovered in Qumran. Perhaps such texts were not considered heretic by the Jerusalem leadership.³ Accordingly, the

1 See, for example, H. Stegemann, "The Qumran Essenes," *The Madrid Qumran Congress* 1 (1992), 83-165.

2 About 33% or 249 of the manuscripts can be classified as sectarian, and 29% or 223 as biblical texts (all books are represented except Esther). See L.H. Schiffman, *Reclaiming the Dead Sea Scrolls* (1995) 33-35, 163-64.

3 This is the opposite of the suggestion offered by Shanks (*The Mystery and Meaning of the Dead sea Scrolls* [1998], 141).

Qumran caves, like the the caves, pits, aqueducts, graves, etc., mentioned in the Copper Scroll, might have been under the jurisdiction of the Jerusalem priesthood. Perhaps the last keeper(s) of the Copper Scroll hid this important document in Cave 3 shortly before or after the destruction of the Temple.

Sukenik was the first to study and recognize the importance of the Dead Sea Scrolls. He suggested that the Qumran caves served as *genizot*, and that the scrolls are of Essene origin. Sukenik compared the content of the caves with that of the Cairo Genizah.⁴ That the scrolls are of Essene origin is widely accepted, although the term "Essene" does not occur in any of them.⁵

Del Medico renewed the idea that the Qumran caves served as *genizot*.⁶ Yet some of his explanations concerning the Halakhah of what must be committed to *genizah*, seem to be unfounded.

Driver also considers that the caves served as *genizot*, and cites various Rabbinic sources to support this notion. Driver concludes that the material "might have been concealed as potentially dangerous from a political or a theological point of view or as the treasured possessions of a religious and political group which ran the risk of extinction."⁷

De Vaux vehemently opposes the view that the caves in Qumran served as *genizot*. Some of the caves where habitable, while others could have served the Qumran inhabitants as storage sites for provisions and hiding places. De Vaux identifies the Qumranites as Essenes.⁸

Rengstorf suggests that the Qumran manuscripts have no connection with the Essenes or other sectarian groups. The manuscripts originated from the (Temple) library of Jerusalem and were brought to the Qumran caves for safekeeping during the Jewish revolt.⁹

Tov says that since some Qumran caves were used as dwellings, Del Medico's suggestion is not plausible. Also, the view that denies any connection between the Dead Sea Scrolls and the Qumran community, or that the scrolls

4 *Megillot Genuzot* 1 (1948), 10; 2 (1950), 20; *The Dead Sea Scrolls of the Hebrew University* (1955), 22-24. It should be noted that sectarian texts were not destroyed in the post-talmudic era. For example, the famous Cairo Genizah, located in the attic of the Ezra Synagogue (built in 882) in Fostat in Old Cairo, Egypt, was used for a thousand years, and was rediscovered mainly by Solomon Schechter in 1896. It contained circa 250,000 pages of historically very valuable material from various sources, such as Rabbinic, Karaite, sectarians from the Second Temple era (such as Ben-Sira, the Damascus Covenant). The most ancient document, *זכרון ערות*, is from Fostat from the year 750 (A.M. Habermann, "Genizah," *EJ* 7, 404-07; *גְּנִיזָה* in *EH* 11, 82-86; Y. Horowitz, "גְּנִיזָה" in *EH*, Supplement 1, 786-87). Regarding *genizah*, see #2, 1:5; #25, 6:4; #33, 8:3; #54, 11:9.

5 See L.H. Schiffman, *Reclaiming the Dead Sea Scrolls* (1995), 79.

6 "The Riddle of the Scrolls" (1958), 28-33.

7 *The Judaean Scrolls* (1965), 382-93.

8 *Archaeology and the Dead Sea Scroll* (1973), 55-57, 103-104. See also, "Initial Discovery Reports" in the Introduction.

9 *Hirbet Qumrân und die Bibliothek vom Toten Meer* (1960), 24-40, 57-64.

were brought from other places, such as the Temple library, are equally unacceptable. Tov believes that, "The only possible explanation of the presence of the texts in the caves is that at a time of crisis the covenanters brought their scrolls there for safety, and that some of them lived there for a time."¹⁰

Schiffman concludes that the document *Miqsat Ma'aseh hatTorah*, "Some Rulings Pertaining to the Torah" (MMT or 4QMMt), proves that the Qumranites were members of an offshoot group of Sadducees (discussed later). This undermines the accepted theory that the Qumranites were Essenes.

Even if the Dead Sea Scrolls originated from the sectarians who supposedly were the inhabitants of Qumran, it does not exclude the possibility that the Copper Scroll belonged to the Temple. One might then speculate as to why the Scroll was discovered at Qumran. Perhaps a covert sectarian, a disappointed or excommunicated priest or Levite who had access to this secret document joined the Qumran sectarians, took the Scroll with him, and deposited it with the sect's leadership. The sectarians opposed the 'wicked priesthood' of Jerusalem and waited for the appropriate time to capture the Temple. One can even suggest that sizing the Scroll would not be considered a sinful act of theft. On the contrary, it could represent a pious deed, for it would preserved part of the sanctified wealth of the Temple from the hands of the wicked priests or Roman officials.

One can be hypothesize that the authors of the anti-Jerusalem priesthood documents did not live in the Qumran area. If the Qumran caves were *genizot* controlled by the Jerusalem priesthood, then the question as to why Jerusalem would tolerate a strong sectarian community nearby that opposed its leadership, obviously falls away.

Clearly, it is impossible to assign the authorship of the Copper Scroll with certainty to any specific group. Internal evidence points toward the priestly leadership of the Temple of Jerusalem as the most likely source. See also, "Historicity of the Copper Scroll."

REFLECTION ON THE OPENING OF THE SCROLL

Two bronze rolls, a large and a small, which together make up the Copper Scroll, were found next to each other in Qumran Cave 3. Originally, the Scroll consisted of three sheets riveted together, each having four columns. The large roll contained Sheet 1 (Columns 1-4) and Sheet 2 (Columns 5-8), while the small roll Sheet 3 (Columns 9-12).

Baker first opened the small roll by making seven longitudinal cuts, thereby creating eight segments. Later he opened the larger roll by fourteen longitudinal cuts producing fifteen segments, bringing the total to 23 segments.

Milik presents a diagram indicating the three sheets, the twelve columns,

10 "Hebrew Biblical Manuscripts from the Judaean Desert," *JJS* 39 (1988), 9-10.

and the 23 segments. This diagram is made from left to right, therefore, to have the proper idea about the layout of the Scroll segments, one must use its mirror image. Milik notes that the first segment has no script, serving as a protective page. This piece can be seen in front of the first column in the drawings of Baker and Milik, however, Allegro's does not indicate it.¹¹

Allegro was an expert photographer. He took copious photographs before, during, and after the opening process. Surprisingly, he reproduced only a few of these in his books.¹² Presently, most of Allegro's original negative films and photographs are housed at the Manchester Museum in England. Most of his photographs were published circa eight years after his death.¹³

The following description of the 23 cuts is based on Allegro's drawings, on the photographs received from the Archaeological Museum of Amman (probably made from Allegro's photographs), on the photographs made from the original negatives of those published by Milik, and on Milik's diagram.¹⁴

Cut 1 is in front of Column 1. The first segment contains no script.

Cuts 2 and 3 pass through Column 1.

Cut 4 is between Columns 1 and 2, yet it cuts through lines 1:11 and 1:14.

Cut 5 passes through Column 2.

Cut 6 is between Columns 2 and 3.

Cut 7 passes through Column 3.

Cut 8 is between Columns 3 and 4, it is close or touches lines 4:12-14.

Cut 9 passes through Column 4.

Cut 10 passes through Column 5.

Between Cuts 9 and 10 there is a riveted section that connected Sheets 1 and 2.

Cut 11 is between Columns 5 and 6.

Cut 12 is between Columns 6 and 7.

Cut 13 passes through Column 7.

Cut 14 is between Columns 7 and 8, it touches lines 8:5-6.

Between Columns 8 and 9 were Sheets 2 and 3 riveted together. Here broke the roll into a larger and a smaller ones.

Cut 15 passes through Column 9.

Cut 16 passes through Column 10.

Cut 17 is between Columns 10 and 11, but cuts through line 10:5, and touches lines 10:3 and 10:13.

11 Milik, 215, xlv, xlviii; Allegro, 32. It should be noted that in "Allegro's Provisional Translation and Notes on the Copper Scroll" the small roll (i.e., Columns 8-12) is indicated as Columns I-IV, since at the opening Allegro could not know that this was the last part of the Scroll. The larger roll is indicated as Columns I-VII.

12 Allegro 23 pl. 2; 25 pl. 3a; 26 pl. 3b; 28 pl. 4; Allegro^{rev}, after p. 66, pls. 3-6, 9-10.

13 *The Allegro Qumran Collection*, ed. by G.J. Brooke, 1996. See also, G.J. Brooke, "The Allegro Qumran Photograph Collection," *The Provo International Conference on the Dead Sea Scrolls* (1999), 13-29.

14 See "Approach in this Study" in the Introduction.

Cut 18 passes through Column 11.

Cut 19 is between Columns 11 and 12.

Cuts 20 and 21 pass through Column 12.

Baker reports that nearly 300 photographs were made while opening the rolls. Photographs were made of the outer surface of the rolls before each of cuts, and inside after the cutting. Baker's drawings were prepared from the photographs of the inner surfaces. The outside photographs were made only to ascertain the location of each segment. This was a serious error.

It is most surprising that Baker states: (1) "It is believed that no letter has been made unrecognizable by the sawing." (2) Only 5% of the 3000 symbols of text are missing, and "in all cases the loss is due to damage sustained prior to the attempt at opening." (3) In the drawings "only 2% of the remaining symbols have been marked as doubtful."¹⁵

Unfortunately, these statements have proven to be inaccurate. (1) There are many cases where Allegro indicates that a certain letter is on the cut, while Milik does not (which is discussed later). (2) The text consists of circa 3000 symbols, and more than 100 symbols are missing due to numerous lacunae. (3) Many more than 60 of circa 3000 symbols of the Scroll are doubtful.

Finally, it appears that those responsible for the opening process were in rush, they did it in a secret manner, and Kuhn was not asked to participate. Even his valuable method of reading the reverse side first was not utilized.¹⁶ Thus the significance of Kuhn's pioneer work was not recognized.¹⁷

THE DRAWINGS

Three sets of drawings of the Copper Scroll have been published, those by Baker, Milik, and Allegro. The drawings for each item in Lurie's work are poor copies of Allegro's, and thus are not reliable.¹⁸

15 "Notes on the Opening of the 'Bronze' Scrolls from Qumran," *BJRL* 39 (1956-57), 51-52, 54; "Notes on the Opening of the Copper Scroll from Qumran," *DJD III*, 206-10.

16 See "The Unopened Rolls" in the Introduction.

17 The results could have been superior, if before opening the rolls and after cleaning the outside surface, extensive photographs would have been taken. The extruded letters could then have been copied. After applying a special protecting glue, rubber based impressions could have been made of the outside surface. This process could have been carried out before each cut. Likewise, after finishing the cuttings, cleaning the inner surfaces, and applying the special protecting glue, rubber based impressions could have been made of the inner surface of every segments. Finally, both sets of impressions could then been flattened. As a result, the entire outside surface before cutting, and inner surface after cutting would have been accurately preserved. Since the letters are extruded on the outside, practically every letter, especially those that were damaged or destroyed by the cutting process, could have been properly recorded. These two set could have been compared with each other, with the photographs, and with the drawings. Although this would have substantially slowed down the opening process, it might have avoided many serious difficulties in reading the text later.

There are significant differences between the drawings of Milik and Allegro. The former are revised versions of those prepared by Baker at the time of the opening of the rolls. Since Milik published Baker's drawings, one can closely follow Milik's additions and corrections. Each of the three drawings consists of two continuous sketches, one for the first two sheets, and one for the third sheet. Milik's drawings show each column as a separate entity. Both Baker's and Milik's drawings indicate lacunae, rivet-holes, chipping, and end of the sheets, but neither cuts nor cracks are shown.

Allegro's drawings were prepared by the Jordanian artist Muhanna Durra, the son of Said Durra, then Director of Antiquities in Jordan.¹⁹ These drawings indicate lacunae, cracks, chipping, rivet-holes, end of sheets, and 21 cuts made by Baker. The cracks and cuts are indicated with dotted lines. Some of the cracks, chipping, and even lacunae might have occurred after Milik's drawings were completed.²⁰ This implies that deterioration of the Copper Scroll segments started within a short time after the cut opening.

The cuts, as well as many of the cracks and chipping indicated in Allegro's drawings can be substantiated by the photographs made from Milik's negatives, the set of photos received from the Archaeological Museum of Amman (which are apparently copies of Allegro's pictures), and the photographs of the Zuckermans.²¹

Furthermore, the sample scripts in Cross' paleographical study seem to be closer to Allegro's than to Milik's drawings, although it is part of Milik's *editio princeps*.²² This suggests that Cross prepared his own drawings.

18 See "Approach Used in this Study" in the Introduction.

19 Allegro, 6. This is a clear indication that the Jordanians encouraged Allegro to publish his book, *The Treasury of the Copper Scroll*.

20 The text has a total of 181 lines. Cuts pass through lines as follows (cuts that pass through a vacant space are disregarded). 97-98 lines have one cut, 25 have two cuts, while line 1:11 has three cuts. Only Columns 7 and 8 have no cuts, and only nine out of 21 cuts do not touch the text. In addition, there are about 70 cases where cracks pass through the script. Regarding chipping, the drawings differ. Allegro's indicate chipping at the bottom left corner of Segment 8 (middle of Column 3), and at the bottom right corner of Segment 9 (left to the middle of Column 4), which cannot be seen in the drawings of Baker and Milik. The right bottom of Column 2 (Segment 6) Milik's has a relatively deep chipping, while Allegro's indicate only a number of cracks. The same area has a problematic reading. This suggests that some Scroll restoration may have occurred during the time between the drawings of Milik and Allegro (see #11 2:14). Regarding rivet holes where the sheets were riveted together, the drawings also differ. Baker's and Milik's indicate nine holes where Sheets 1 and 2 (Columns 4 and 5) were riveted together, while Allegro's only seven. Between Sheets 2 and 3 (Columns 8 and 9), Baker's and Milik's indicate at the left margin of Column 8 five holes, while the right margin of Column 9 has six or seven holes. Allegro's drawings have no holes at the left side of Column 8, and only four holes at the right margin of Column 9.

21 See "Approach used in this Study" in the Introduction.

22 "Excursus on the Palaeographical Dating of the Copper Document," Milik, 218.

There are many cases where a letter *in toto* or in a part is on the cut or crack, as can be seen in Allegro's drawings. Milik indicates some of these by dotted letters, some by clear letters, while some are not indicated at all. Baker's drawings are important, since if compared with Milik's, one can see Milik's corrections and additions. Occasionally Baker's drawings are consistent with Allegro's. Certainly, where the appearance of the three drawings are identical, the rendition is accurate.

The following is a list of cases where the drawings of Allegro and Milik basically differ due to cuts or cracks. It refers only to those where a letter or part of it is on the cut or crack,²³ but does not include the numerous cases where the cut or crack passes through a letter.

- (1:1) תה — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the left leg of the first *taw* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: clear *taw*.
- (1:4) ככרין — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the *reš* is in an angular position, the *yod* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: a small *reš-yod* ligature.
- (1:7) אלגרו^{dr}: סתום, the *waw* is on the cut, final *mem*; MILIK^{dr}: סתום, short *waw*, regular *mem*.
- (1:8) תשע — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the left leg of the *taw* is practically on the cut, it has no foot; MILIK^{dr}: clear *taw*.
- (1:9) כחלת — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the left leg of the *het* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: clear *het*.
- (1:10) אלגרו^{dr}: השבוע or השביעי, the *waw* or *yod* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: השבע or השבעי, no *waw* or *yod*.
- (1:11) הצפון — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the *waw* is on the cut, clear final *nun*; MILIK^{dr}: dotted *waw*, dotted final *nun*.
- (1:12) אלגרו^{dr}: הטביל, after the *lamed* there is a cut, the other side has several crack, but no lacuna. MILIK^{dr}: הטבילה, only the right leg and a part of the top of the *he* can be seen due to a narrow lacuna.
- (1:13) בשיא or בשוא — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the *waw* or *yod* is on a crack; MILIK^{dr}: dotted *waw* or *yod*.
- (1:14) גבה — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the right leg of the *he* is on a crack; MILIK^{dr}: clear *he*.
- (1:14) ארבעין — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the final *nun* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: relatively clear final *nun* at the edge of the column.
- (2:7) השער — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the leg of the *reš* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: clear *reš*.
- (2:8) אלגרו^{dr}: תשע סרא, the right side of the *samekh* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: תשעסרא, one word, clear *samekh*.
- (2:9) ככרין — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the *yod* is practically on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: dotted *yod*.
- (2:10) החומא — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the right side of the *mem* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: clear *mem*.

23 Some of these are indicated by Allegro (135 n. 8; 138 nn. 30, 36; 140 n. 49; 142 n. 72; 152 n. 144; 157, nn. 195, 198; 163 n. 248; 168 n. 300).

- (3:4) ALLEGRO^{dr}: מאות, the right leg of the *taw* is practically on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: clear *taw*.
- (3:9) ALLEGRO^{dr}: ולבושי, the final *nun* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: לבושי, no *waw*, no final *nun*.
- (4:2) בבואתך — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the right side of the first *bet* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: the right side of the first *bet* is damaged.
- (4:12) שבעינ — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the left vertical line of the *šin* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: clear *šin*.
- (4:14) ALLEGRO^{dr}: the numeral consists of two vertical lines, but at the left side of the lacuna one can detect a part of another vertical line, i.e., 1+1+1; apparently the left bottom edge where this column was cut chipped away. MILIK^{dr}: clear numeral 10+1+1.
- (7:6) ALLEGRO^{dr}: עסרין, the leg of the *reš* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: עסר, damaged *reš*, no *yod*, no final *nun*.
- (7:11) ALLEGRO^{dr}: המשטח, clear *het*, its right leg is on a crack; MILIK^{dr}: המשמרה, a *reš-he* ligature.
- (7:12) חפור — ALLEGRO^{dr}: clear *waw* on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: clear *waw*.
- (7:12) שבע — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the right side of the *‘ayin* is on a crack; MILIK^{dr}: clear *‘ayin*.
- (7:14) הכוז or הבוז — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the leg of the *zayin* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: clear *zayin*.
- (7:15) שלוש — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the *waw* is on a crack; MILIK^{dr}: clear *waw*.
- (8:9) ALLEGRO^{dr}: 1+1+1+1+1+1+1 ככ, the first two numerals after ככ are on cracks. MILIK^{dr}: 1+1+1+1 ככ, there is more than a letter-size space between ככ and the first numeral.
- (8:12) צפון — ALLEGRO^{dr}: there are cracks on both sides of the final *nun*; MILIK^{dr}: the middle of the final *nun* is dotted.
- (9:2) ALLEGRO^{dr}: בשועה or בשיעה, the *waw* or *yod* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: בשעה, no *waw* or *yod*.
- (9:3) ALLEGRO^{dr}: איסתרין, the *yod* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: אסתרין, no *yod*.
- (10:4) הגדול — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the leg of the *dalet* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: the leg of the *dalet* is dotted and crosses the left foot of the previous *gimmel*.
- (10:12) תחת — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the right leg of the second *taw* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: clear *taw*.
- (10:13) עסרה — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the left leg of the *he* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: clear *he*.
- (11:3) עמוד — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the leg of the *dalet* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: clear *dalet*.
- (11:7) חרמ — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the left leg of the *het* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: the left leg of the *het* is dotted.
- (12:4) תחת — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the left leg of the *het* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: the left leg of the *het* is dotted.
- (12:4) השיח — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the *yod* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: lower part of the *yod* is dotted.
- (12:7) וכסף — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the left side of the *samekh* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: clear *samekh*.

- (12:9) Numeral 1 — ALLEGRO^{dr}: it looks like a *waw* on the cut or touching it; MILIK^{dr}: a very short vertical line.
- (12:10) שבינה — ALLEGRO^{dr}: a *yod-nun-waw* ligature followed by a cut, and after it there is another *waw*, the two *waws* could be two legs of a *he/het/taw*, which remained unconnected on the top; MILIK^{dr}: a *yod-nun* ligature that looks like a *šade*, and followed by a *he/het/taw*.
- (12:10) פתחא — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the left part of the *pe* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: relatively clear but unusual *pe*.
- (12:11) ALLEGRO^{dr}: הכתבו, the *waw* is on the cut; MILIK^{dr}: הכתב, no *waw*.
- (12:12) כל — ALLEGRO^{dr}: the upper part of the *lamed* is on a crack, next to the letter there is a lacuna; MILIK^{dr}: only the lower part of the *lamed* can be seen before the lacuna.

Occasionally it is easier to read the drawings of Allegro than those of Milik; e.g., Allegro^{dr}: כסף, the *samekh* is connected by an almost vertical line with the final *pe*; Milik^{dr}: כונף or כונף, where a thin almost vertical line is attached to the left side of the *waw*, and a ligature of *nun* and final *pe* (Milik reads כסף; see #17, 4:8).

Based on the above, one can conclude that often Allegro's drawings are superior to those by Milik and Baker. Yet some of the cracks indicated in Allegro's drawings might have occurred after Milik's drawings were completed. On the other hand, one must be careful when reading a letter 'into' a cut or crack; e.g., Allegro's drawing can be read as הכתבו, but this word cannot have a *waw* at the end, it must be like the reading of Milik's drawing, הכתב, since the next word is הוצא, unless its is scribal error (see #60, 12:11).

COPPER SCROLL HEBREW

During the Second Temple era many Jews in Judea still spoke a Mishnaic-like Hebrew. Among them were the Pharisee scholars who preached their interpretation of the Torah amidst the common people. On the other hand, the Sadducees strictly adhered to the literal interpretation of the Torah. Although they represented the upper echelon of the society, were better educated, and many priests and highpriests were members of their group, still they might have used the same Hebrew dialect as the Pharisees in their everyday correspondence. This is supported by the fact that some of the controversies between the Pharisees and Sadducees are recorded in Mishnaic Hebrew.²⁴ It should be also noted that Aramaic became the *lingua franca* at that time.

According to Schiffman, MMT is a letter written by the founders of the Qumran sect to the priestly leaders of Jerusalem justifying their separation. He says that "in the early Hashmonean period when the Temple was

²⁴ E.g., m. Yad. 4:6-8. Also cf. the controversy between the Pharisees and Boethusians in t. Yad. 2:20. See also #51, 11:3.

managed and its ritual conducted in accord with Pharisaic views. The Hashmoneans made common cause with the Pharisees. This was done in order to cleanse the Temple of the excessive Hellenization that they blamed to a great extent on the Sadducean priests who had become, in their view, overly Hellenized." Accordingly, the Qumran sectarians were a splinter group of the Sadducees, and apparently had less in common with the Pharisees.²⁵

The language and grammar of the Copper Scroll and MMT resemble Mishnaic Hebrew. If MMT was written by an ex-Sadducee, it supports the notion that the Sadducees, like the Pharisees, used a sort of Mishnaic Hebrew for their everyday communication. The Copper Scroll seems to originate from the priestly leadership of Jerusalem (whether Sadducee or Pharisee). This may explain why the Copper Scroll, a non-religious text, was written in a dialect resembling Mishnaic Hebrew, rather than Late Biblical Hebrew, like most non-biblical Dead Sea Scrolls. Thus, both MMT and the Copper Scroll may originate from members or ex-members of the priestly circle of Jerusalem. Later, a similar dialect was employed by the scribes of the Bar-Kokhba letters, as well as by the editors of the extensive Tannaic literature.

These suggestions do not conflict with the fact that there are undeniable similarities between the Copper Scroll and Megillat Ta'anit (Scroll of Fasting). The latter was written by Pharisees before the destruction of the Temple. It is a proto-Mishnaic Mishnah collection, and considered to be the first text of the Oral Torah put into written form. Megillat Ta'anit is written in Tannaic Palestinian Aramaic. Its style is in the form of list that resembles that of the Copper Scroll.²⁶ Both Megillat Ta'anit and the Copper Scroll seem

25 "New Light on the Pharisees, Insight from the Dead Sea Scrolls," *BR* 8 (1992), 54. See also Schiffman's other works, such as "The New Halakhic Letter (4QMMT) and the Origins of the Dead Sea Sect," *BA* 53 (1990), 64-72; "The Significance of the Scrolls, The Second Generation of Scholars—or Is It the Third?—Offers a New Perspective on the Texts from the Qumran Caves," *BR* 6 (1990), 23-24; "התפתחויות בחקר — מלחמת המגילות" in *Cathedra* 61 (1991), 14-15; *Law, Custom and Messianism in the Dead Sea Sect* (1993), 34. Also, S. Goranson, "Pharisees, Sadducees, Essenes, and 4QMMT," *BA* 53 (1990), 70-71. Contra to Schiffman's view see, J.C. VanderKam, "The People of the Dead Sea Scrolls, Essenes or Sadducees?" (and the inlet "Tracking The Law in The Mishnah and in a Qumran Text"), *BR* 7 (1991), 42-47.

26 Megillat Ta'anit is frequently quoted in the Talmudim (e.g., m. Ta'an. 2:8). It contains an opening sentence, twelve *mišnayot*, one for each month of the lunar year, and a concluding sentence. It lists 36 days of happy events of the Second Temple era when the Rabbis forbade fasting and/or eulogizing the deceased. Both the Aramaic Megillat Ta'anit and the Hebrew Copper Scroll employ non-contracted and contracted 'teens' (see Appendix B). Also, Megillat Ta'anit names Kislev 21 as "the day of Mount Gerizim," in memory of the destruction of the Samaritan Temple by John Hyrcanus. See H. Lichtenstein, "Die Fastenrolle," *HUCA* 8-9 (1931/32), 257-351; B.Z. Lurie, ed., *Megillat Ta'anit* (1964); Steinsaltz, *Megillat Ta'anit*, 1-8; J.D. Eisenstein, "מגילת תענית" in *OY* 6, 94b-96a; N.N. Glatzer, "Megillat Ta'anit," *EJ* 11, 1230-31; "מגילת תענית" in *EH* 22, 148-49; A. Tal, *The Language of the Targum of the Former Prophets* (1975), 68; M. Bar-Ilan, "מקורה של מגילת תענית"

to originate from the Second Temple leadership. All this points to a common historical time frame for these two documents.²⁷

UNIQUENESS AND CHARACTERISTIC OF THE DOCUMENT

The Scroll consists of three copper sheets, each containing four columns. Comparing the layout and the script of the three sheets, it appears that the scribe of the third sheet was not familiar with the first two sheets.

There are differences among the columns, and among the sheets. The second half of Column 1, Column 11, and Column 12 have more characters per line than the rest of the text. Greek letters are found only on Sheet 1.²⁸ Sheet 1 has an empty space before Column 1, while Column 12 reaches at the very end of Sheet 3. Column 12 is the widest one, the characters are smaller and the lines are more condensed than in the rest of the Scroll, while about one third at the end was left empty. Perhaps the scribe was not informed where the text will end, otherwise he would have engraved larger size characters, made the lines narrower, and with more lines to the column. Also, the words in Column 12 are more carefully separated than those of the rest of the text.

Concerning the size of the characters, Sheet 2 seems more uniform than Sheets 1 and 3. Sheet 2 is also the narrowest in width. The last item of Sheet 2 (#37, 8:14-16) has somewhat smaller characters than Sheets 1 and 3. Line 8:14 has more characters than any other line of this sheet, line 8:15 occupies less than the first two thirds of the line, while line 8:16 about the last two third of the line. Therefore, this item seems to be a later addition. Moreover, three items start at the bottom of a column and continue on the next one; all on Sheet 3.²⁹ The rest of the columns end with an item.

Careful study of the subject leads one to a number of important conclusions regarding the Copper Scroll and its text. Such as:

- (1) Several times the scribes engraved ככ, which was later emended to ככרין, probably by a different individual, presumably so that the original engraver should not be aware of the extent of the hidden wealth (see Appendix A).

in *Sinai* 98 (1985/86), 114-37. Thus Jerusalem controlled Mount Gerizim, and this may be the reason why some of the wealth listed in the Scroll was hidden there (see #57, 12:4).

27 Somewhat similar views are expressed by Bar-Ilan (123 n. 35).

28 Sheet 1 has Columns 1-4 of 20 items or 57 lines; Sheet 2 has Columns 5-8 of 17 items or 60 lines; and Sheet 3 has Columns 9-12 of 23 items or 64 lines. Columns 1-2 have 15 lines; Column 3, 13 lines; Columns 4-6, 14 lines, Columns 7-8, 16 lines; Columns 9-11, 17 lines, and Column 12, 13 lines. The shortest line (1:15) consists of two letters and a lacuna of one square letter in size, based on the drawings of Baker and Milik, while according to Allegro's, it consists of two letters and a letter fragment bordering a lacuna. The longest line (12:4) consists of 32 Hebrew characters.

29 Items #44, 9:17-10:2; #50, 10:17-11:1; #56, 11:16-12:3.

- (2) To keep the content secret, the compilers purposely chose Hebrew, the language known to a relatively limited number of Jews, rather than Aramaic, the vernacular of Jews and gentiles alike at that time.
- (3) The compilers probably selected engravers who did not know Hebrew, to conceal its content from the scribes themselves.³⁰ Perhaps the uneducated engravers copied the document from a master copy, which was not identical with the copy mentioned at the end of the Scroll. Or perhaps the text was dictated to scribes from a master copy or from the copy mentioned at the end of the Scroll (see #60, 12:11-13). This might account for the surprising number of scribal errors, inconsistencies, and an orthography that is considerably influenced by Aramaic.³¹
- (4) Several scribes were involved in engraving the Copper Scroll, a fact reflected in the script. This could have been done intentionally so that one scribe should not be aware of the inscriptions of the other. This possibility fits well with the cryptic nature of this document.
- (5) The Scroll was originally made of three sheets, each containing four columns. Quite possibly each scribe saw only one or part of one sheet.
- (6) The last item reports only where the detailed copy of the Scroll is hidden, but not any treasure. This indicates the end of the text. Yet based on the letter and line sizes, as well the condensed nature of the lines and the empty space of five lines or so, of the last column, shows that the scribe was not informed of the length of the text in advance, otherwise he would used a larger type, and narrower lines.
- (7) The compilers and/or scribes might have expected to add additional words or symbols.
- (8) The seven sets of Greek letters allude to the secret nature of the Scroll (see Appendix C).

Clearly, all these features indicate that the key goal of the compiler(s) was to limit the information to as few individuals as possible.

30 That there existed copyists who could not read the text they were copying can be seen clearly from the Halakhah, which states regarding a scribe for Torah, Tefillin, and Mezuzah, וְאִינוּ רְשָׁאֵי לִכְתּוֹב אֶלָּא אִם כֵּן יוֹדֵעַ לִקְרוֹת, "and he is not permitted to write unless he is capable of reading" (Sof. 1:12).

31 Thorion (175-76) suggests that the engraver copied the text from a skin or papyrus draft, and since he could not read, he mixed up the letters such as *bet* for *kaf* etc. Sussmann came to a similar conclusion concerning the artist who made the Rehob mosaic inscription. He argues that since it is more difficult to set the small stone pieces to make *dalet* than *reš*, *zayin* and *nun* than *waw* and *bet*, there is no alternative than to assume that the artist did not know Hebrew, did not understand the draft, which might not have differentiated well between similar shaped letters ("כתובת הלכית מעמק בית-שאן" in *Tarbiz* 43 [1974/75], 96-97 and nn. 53-54). Regarding the Rehob inscription, Elisha Qimron says that often the scribes did not care to correct minor mistakes. To prove his point, Qimron mentions the Copper Scroll and other inscriptions which contain similar scribal errors ("כמה הערות לקריאתה," *כתובתה ולשונה של כתובת רחוב* in *Tarbiz* 45 [1975/76], 154-55).

HISTORICITY OF THE COPPER SCROLL

There are several major questions concerning the historicity of the Copper Scroll. Is the Scroll a genuine document? Could the wealth listed in the Scroll have been real? If yes, to whom did it belong? Who authored the Copper Scroll, a remarkable document cataloguing these considerable assets?

Originally Milik, de Vaux, Harding, and Cross suggested that the Copper Scroll was written by the Essenes of Qumran and that it lacked historical validity.³² To this group can be added Mowinkel,³³ Silberman,³⁴ Rodrigues,³⁵ and Moraldi.³⁶ Later Milik and de Vaux proposed that the Scroll was prepared by a crank before 100 CE. Milik, de Vaux, Harder, and Cross who participated in the discovery and/or contributed to the *editio princeps* of the Scroll, represent this 'official' view.³⁷

Zeitlin questions Milik's suggestion that the Copper Scroll was written by a semi-literate crank. According to him, the Dead Sea Scrolls originate from the Middle Ages, therefore, have no connection with the Essenes.³⁸

Other scholars consider the Copper Scroll as a genuine document. However, they disagree as to who created it, to whom the wealth belonged, and whether to accept the wealth at face value.

Originally Kuhn³⁹ and Allegro⁴⁰ suggested that the Copper Scroll was produced by the Essenes of Qumran, and it describes their wealth. Dupont-Sommer agrees with this view.⁴¹ Similarly, Pixner ascribes ownership to numerous Essene groups throughout Palestine.⁴² However, Kuhn⁴³ and Allegro altered their views, and concluded that the Copper Scroll belonged to the Second Temple of Jerusalem. Allegro assumes that the Zealots hid the roll at the end of the Jewish-Roman war.⁴⁴ To the group affirming the his-

32 "The Copper Document from Cave III, Qumran," *BA* 19 (1956), 60-64.

33 "The Copper Scroll — An Apocryphon?" *JBL* 76 (1957), 261-65.

34 "A Note on the Copper Scroll," *VT* 10 (1960), 77-79.

35 "Aspectos linguisticos do documento de cobre de Qumran (3Q15)," *Biblos. Revista da Faculdade de Letras* 39 (1963), 329-423.

36 *I manoscritti di Qumrān* (1971), 713-14. Wolters notes, "Rodrigues and Moraldi are heavily dependent on Milik" ("Apocalyptic," 150 n. 56), and that Rodrigues "is almost slavishly dependent on Milik" ("Vocabulary," 484 n. 12).

37 See "The Official Release" in the Introduction.

38 "The Dead Sea Scrolls ... The Copper Scrolls ..." *JQR* 47 NS (1956/57), 245-68.

39 "Les rouleaux de cuivre de Qumran," *RB* 61 (1954), 193-205.

40 *Dead Sea Scrolls*, 184.

41 *The Essene Writings from Qumran* (1961), 379-93; "על מגילת-הנחושת 3,15 מקומרן" in *Report, Third World Congress of Jewish Studies, Jerusalem* (1965), 92-93.

42 Pixner, 331-40.

43 "Der gegenwärtige Stand der Erforschung der in Palästina neu gefundenen hebräischen Handschriften," *THLZ* 81 (1956), 541-46.

44 Allegro, 120-30; Allegro^{rev}, 15-16, 147-59; *The Chosen People* (1971), 134; *The Dead Sea Scrolls and the Christian Myth* (1979), 27-28; etc.

toricity of the Copper Scroll can be added a number of scholars, such as Roth,⁴⁵ Bardtke,⁴⁶ Rengstorff,⁴⁷ Bruce,⁴⁸ Driver.⁴⁹

Rabin says that if the Copper Scroll is only a story, the originators would not invoke them laboriously on an expensive material, like copper, and deposit a second copy somewhere else. The type of the languages is due the verbatim report of eyewitnesses. It belonged to the Temple of Jerusalem.⁵⁰

Gevaryahu proposes that the Copper Scroll is a list of Temple treasures hidden in the expectation that the troubled time will soon pass. These were hidden before the destruction of the Temple by the order of the overseers of the Temple treasures.⁵¹

Lehmann suggests that the treasure listed in the Scroll are Temple taxes, contributions, and offerings collected after the destruction of Jerusalem, which according to the Talmud, must be hidden until the Temple is rebuilt. These and their hiding places are recorded in the Scroll from 70 CE until Emperor Nerva (r. 96-98 CE) discovered and confiscated them. The huge Roman Nerva coin with the inscription *Fisci Judaici Calumnia Sublata*, "The insult of the Jewish taxes have been annulled," commemorates this event.⁵²

Lurie accepts the view that during the short reign of Bar-Kokhba a Third Temple existed in Jerusalem. He suggests that the Copper Scroll describes the assets of that temple.⁵³

Laperrousaz believes that the Copper Scroll belonged to the followers of Bar-Kokhba.⁵⁴ This is somewhat similar Lurie's view.

Golb challenges the 'official' theory of Qumran-Essene origin of the Dead Sea Scrolls. If the Copper Scroll is an authentic Essene document, it would

45 *The Historical Background of the Dead Sea Scrolls* (1958), 44-45, 67; "A Solution to the Mystery of the Scrolls," *Commentary* 24 (July-December 1957), 323.

46 *Die Handschriftfunde am Toten Meer* (1958), 176-81.

47 *Hirbet Qumrân und die Bibliothek vom Toten Meer* (1960), 26-28, 59-60.

48 *Second Thoughts on the Dead Sea Scrolls* (1964), 26-28.

49 *The Judaean Scrolls* (1966), 30-36.

50 "The Copper Scroll," *The Jewish Chronicles*, June 15, 1956, 19; "The Historical Background of Qumran Hebrew," *SH* 4 (1958), 146 and n. 6.

51 "העדות לרשימת המטמונים שבמגילת הנחשת לאור מקורות תלמודיים" in *Report, Third World Congress of Jewish Studies* (1965), 94-95. Regarding Gevaryahu, see "Tribute to Professor Haim Gevaryahu," *Dor le-Dor*, 10 (1981/82), 71-73.

52 "Identification," 97-105; the same as *על סמך מונחיה של 'מגילת הנחשת'* in *Report, Third World Congress of Jewish Studies* (1965), 94-95. Regarding Gevaryahu, see "Tribute to Professor Haim Gevaryahu," *Dor le-Dor*, 10 (1981/82), 71-73.

53 "Identification," 97-105; the same as *על סמך מונחיה של 'מגילת הנחשת'* in *Report, Third World Congress of Jewish Studies* (1965), 94-95. Regarding Gevaryahu, see "Tribute to Professor Haim Gevaryahu," *Dor le-Dor*, 10 (1981/82), 71-73.

54 "Identification," 97-105; the same as *על סמך מונחיה של 'מגילת הנחשת'* in *Report, Third World Congress of Jewish Studies* (1965), 94-95. Regarding Gevaryahu, see "Tribute to Professor Haim Gevaryahu," *Dor le-Dor*, 10 (1981/82), 71-73.

54 *Qoumran, L'établissement essénien des bords de la mer Morte* (1976), 131-47.